# Neural Eigenfluid Bases: Spectral Objectives, Gauge, and Topology

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**Abstract**

Neural eigenfluids represent incompressible flow with a continuously queryable spectral basis. Differential lifts and potential boundary traces build physical admissibility into the spatial coordinates, while geometry-local orthogonalization and Rayleigh minimization learn their ordering. We connect potential and velocity learning through the classical compatible positive-spectrum pairing and derive a spectral-variance relation that explains how the two objectives weight approximate modes. Gauge selection gives a lower-derivative potential formulation, and a boundary-constrained Dirichlet loss learns the independent harmonic circulation fields of multiply connected domains. Together, these coordinates support full-mass projection and autonomous Galerkin evolution with reusable operators. At $K = 1024$ retained modes, both learned objectives sustain sub-percent velocity error in periodic vortex merger. Across six directly sampled random fields around obstacles, potential bases improve initial energy capture and final accuracy over equal-capacity Laplacian controls while reducing the state dimension by roughly three orders of magnitude. Random large-vortex comparisons identify when harmonic completion and lift conditioning matter. Three-dimensional tests separate spatial representation from coefficient-evolution error and connect increasing capacity to improved reconstruction. Preassembled quadratic operators execute the same reduced generator with millisecond-scale coefficient updates; their offline cost determines the number of repeated queries needed to recover preparation. Neural eigenfluids thus provide physical spectral coordinates for continuous spatial evaluation and reusable reduced fluid computation.

## 1 Introduction

Repeated flow queries arise in interactive simulation, initial-condition exploration, and geometric design. Reduced-order models (ROMs) make these queries affordable by evolving a small set of spatial coordinates. The basis determines which motions the reduced state can express, how physical constraints enter the model, and which computations can be reused. A useful fluid basis should therefore connect spatial structure to dynamics: its coordinates should remain physically interpretable as they are evaluated at new locations and combined into new initial states. We pursue this connection through a continuous neural representation of a fluid spectrum.

Fluid model reduction has developed along both data-driven and operator-driven routes. Snapshot-based methods extract a compact span from simulated flows: Treuille et al. (2006) demonstrated interactive reduced fluid dynamics, including coupling to moving obstacles, and Kim and Delaney (2013) combined subspace integration and cubature to re-simulate variations of a high-resolution sequence. These methods exploit the structure of a flow collection to reduce spatial evaluation and recurrent computation. Spectral methods instead

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define coordinates through a differential operator. Laplacian Eigenfluids (De Witt et al., 2012) associate spatial scales with eigenvalues and give viscous decay a modal interpretation; model-reduced variational simulation connects this construction to geometric structure and harmonic fields (Liu et al., 2015). An operator-defined span is organized by differential energy independently of a chosen trajectory. Its fluid constraints and circulation coordinates provide a natural structure to preserve in a learned representation.

Neural fluid models provide several complementary forms of reuse. Deep Fluids learns a parameterized velocity generator and latent evolution from simulation data (Kim et al., 2019). DeepONet and Fourier Neural Operators learn mappings between function spaces (Lu et al., 2021; Li et al., 2021), while Geo-FNO incorporates learned domain deformations for general geometries (Li et al., 2023). These approaches learn how a family of physical inputs maps to flow solutions. Learning spatial coordinates supplies another reusable object: once a geometry-specific basis and its operators are prepared, initial conditions can share them through an explicit coefficient state. This separation makes the quality of the spatial representation and the accuracy of the reduced dynamics individually measurable.

Coordinate-based neural fields supply continuous spatial values and derivatives. Periodic activations support differentiable signals (Sitzmann et al., 2020), and Fourier features improve high-frequency representation (Tancik et al., 2020). Variational learning then chooses fields according to an operator: the Deep Ritz method minimizes physical energies (E and Yu, 2018), Spectral Inference Networks learn multiple eigenfunctions through stochastic optimization (Pfau et al., 2019), and neural Rayleigh methods address engineering eigenproblems (Rowan et al., 2025). Shape Space Spectra extends variational eigenfunction learning to parameterized shapes, using geometry-local reordering and causal orthogonalization to handle changing spectral order (Chang et al., 2025). Fluid eigenfields bring additional structure to this problem. The trial space must express incompressibility, wall impermeability, equivalent potential representatives, and the independent circulation allowed by topology.

Physical constraints can enter the neural representation directly. Neural Conservation Laws (NCL) constructs divergence-free fields through differential lifts of antisymmetric potentials (Richter-Powell et al., 2022); constrained neural basis methods likewise use divergence-free trial spaces for incompressible problems (Cheng et al., 2026). Neural Kinematic Bases (NKB) learns direct-velocity coordinates with losses for smoothness, divergence, wall alignment, and orthogonality, supporting mesh-free flow fitting and animation (Liu et al., 2025). We combine differential admissibility with operator-based spectral selection. A scalar streamfunction in two dimensions or a vector potential in three generates divergence-free velocity, its boundary trace imposes impermeability, and geometry-local orthogonalization separates the coordinates. Rayleigh minimization orders these admissible fields without flow snapshots in the spectral loss. The NKB experiments provide a matched-budget architecture comparison within the same Galerkin assessment.

Potential-space learning offers a lower-derivative route to these coordinates when its gauge is selected consistently. Constant streamfunctions and admissible curl-free vector fields leave velocity unchanged while changing the potential mass norm. Selecting a representative makes normalization and energy minimization well defined. On compatible canonical spaces and boundary domains, the classical differential lift pairs the exact positive potential and velocity spectra (Arnold et al., 2006). We derive the spectral-variance difference between their Rayleigh objectives for approximate modes. This relation links finite-capacity accuracy to the objective's weighting of spectral content. The auxiliary-solver study connects differentiable representative selection to source-space resolution and operator consistency.

Topology supplies an independent circulation sector. Hodge theory identifies harmonic velocities that carry circulation around obstacles (Arnold et al., 2006). Their physical role is developed by spectral variational ROMs (Liu et al., 2015), Fluid Cohomology (Yin et al., 2023), and Hodge-based neural operator learning (Zheng et al., 2026). We learn harmonic measures using fixed boundary traces and a Dirichlet energy, then lift them to velocity fields. Positive modes and harmonic coordinates together express vortical motion

and independent obstacle circulation. Their allocation within a fixed total dimension exposes a practical distinction: harmonic completion makes the represented space topologically complete, while its energy benefit depends on how strongly the particular flow occupies that sector.

Our contributions are threefold:

1. **Physically constrained neural eigenfluid coordinates.** A continuous geometry-conditioned representation combines differential lifts, impermeable traces, and geometry-local spectral orthogonalization. Geometry-specific Galerkin operators support autonomous coefficient dynamics and spatial resampling.
2. **Potential-space spectral learning with gauge selection.** We formulate learning on canonical potential representatives, apply the classical compatible positive-spectrum pairing, and derive the spectral-variance difference between potential and velocity losses.
3. **Neural circulation coordinates.** A boundary-constrained harmonic loss supplies the independent topological sector. Fixed-budget allocation and matched lift-conditioning comparisons connect these coordinates to energy capture and flow evolution.

The experiments connect each structural choice to a measurable consequence. Periodic vortex merger tests spectral-objective accuracy and cost. Small-scale random fields and random large vortices distinguish energy compression from circulation completion. Three-dimensional capacity and error decomposition separate spatial representation from autonomous coefficient dynamics, and assembled operators measure the cost of repeated evolution. Fixed-geometry reuse and held-out geometry reconstruction are evaluated as distinct tasks. Together, these results establish when continuous physical spectra form useful coordinates for reduced fluid computation.

# 2 Method

The construction has two stages (Figure 1). During learning, the differential lifts of Neural Conservation Laws (Richter-Powell et al., 2022) and potential boundary traces restrict the candidates to divergence-free, impermeable velocities. Geometry-local spectral orthogonalization follows Shape Space Spectra (Chang et al., 2025); harmonic circulation fields complete the span as in spectral fluid reduction (Liu et al., 2015). For a selected geometry, initial projection and preassembled Galerkin operators then turn this spatial basis into an autonomous coefficient model. The resulting state can be reconstructed at any requested spatial locations and output times.

## 2.1 The velocity space: positive modes and harmonic circulation

Let $\Omega_{\mathbf{g}} \subset \mathbb{R}^D$ be a connected fluid domain of spatial dimension $D \in \{2, 3\}$, indexed by geometry parameters $\mathbf{g}$, with outward unit normal $\mathbf{n}$. Here $\mathbb{R}$ is the real number space, $\mathbf{x} = (x_1, \ldots, x_D)$ is a spatial point, written $(x, y)$ in 2D or $(x, y, z)$ in 3D, and $\mathbf{u}$ denotes velocity. For scalar or vector fields $a, b$, we use the geometry-local mass inner product

$$\langle a, b\rangle_{\mathbf{g}} = \int_{\Omega_{\mathbf{g}}} a \cdot b \, \mathrm{d}\mathbf{x}, \qquad \|a\|_{\mathbf{g}}^2 = \langle a, a\rangle_{\mathbf{g}}. \tag{1}$$

The dot is the Euclidean inner product (ordinary multiplication for scalars); $\mathrm{d}\mathbf{x}$ is volume measure. For a fixed domain we write $\Omega = \Omega_{\mathbf{g}}$ and suppress the geometry subscript on the inner product and norm. The operators div and curl denote spatial divergence and curl. An admissible velocity satisfies $\operatorname{div}\mathbf{u} = 0$ and $\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{n} = 0$: the wall is impermeable and tangential motion is permitted. We order this space by vorticity energy in 2D and curl energy in 3D, giving the divergence-free absolute Hodge problem (Arnold et al., 2006). Its

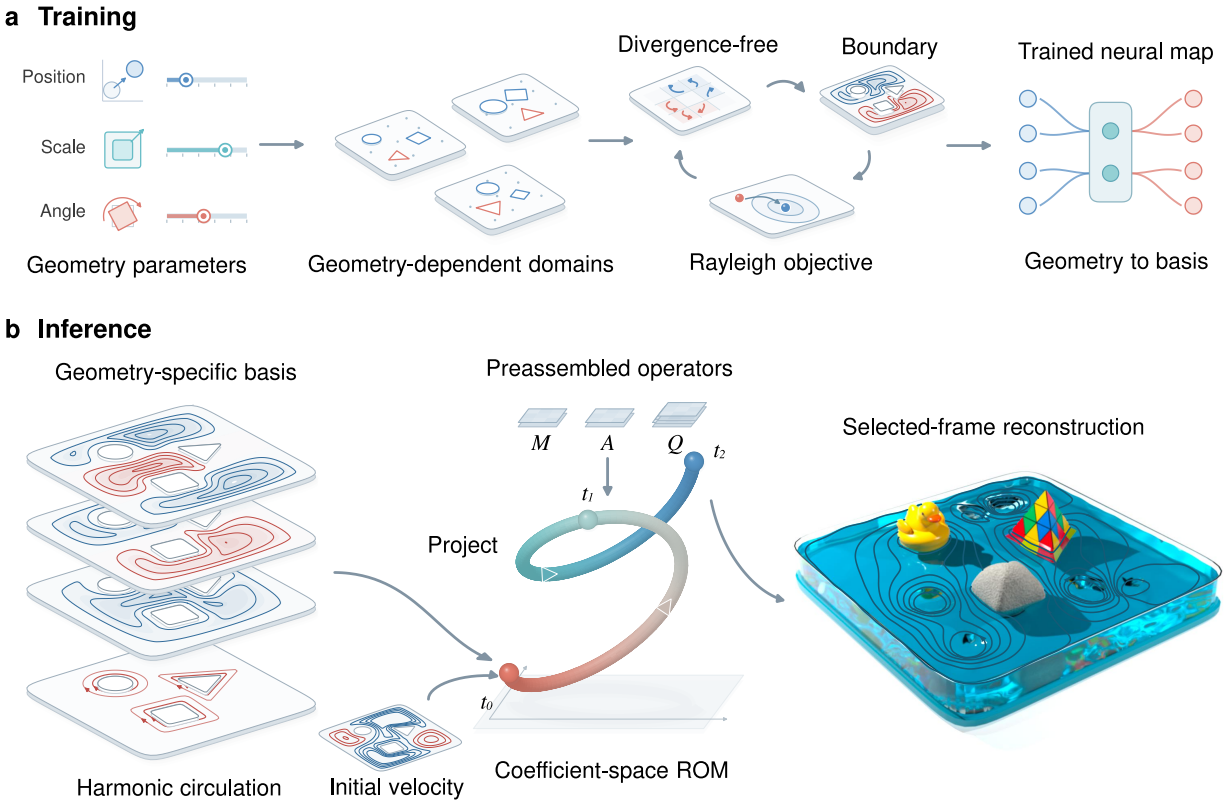


**Figure 1. Shape-dependent training and coefficient-only inference.** (a) Geometry parameters vary obstacle position, scale and orientation within a fixed rounded-square outer boundary. A hard boundary envelope acts on geometry-conditioned potentials. Paired, oppositely oriented red and blue marks depict the antisymmetric tensor in the Neural Conservation Laws (NCL) construction (Richter-Powell et al., 2022); its row-wise divergence generates divergence-free velocities. Gauge fixing and geometry-local causal orthogonalization produce normalized candidates within the divergence-free, impermeable trial space; the Rayleigh contours depict their energy minimization. Training yields the parameter-to-basis neural map. (b) For a selected geometry, the map supplies positive modes, completed by harmonic circulation fields. Initial projection and geometry-specific preassembled mass, linear and quadratic operators support coefficient-only ROM stepping; spatial fields are reconstructed at selected times. The schematic uses $M$ for the velocity mass matrix, $A$ for the reduced linear operator, $Q$ for the quadratic advection tensor, and $t_0, t_1, t_2$ for selected output times.

zero-energy fields form the harmonic sector; its positive-energy eigenfields form the positive sector. To express both dimensions together, write $\alpha = \mathbf{u}^\flat$ for the velocity one-form, with $\flat$ the metric dual, $d$ for exterior differentiation, $\delta$ for its Hilbert adjoint, and $\star$ for the Hodge star. The contraction $\iota_{\mathbf{n}}$ extracts the normal trace. The subscript $A$ denotes absolute boundary conditions; the space $\mathcal{H}^1_A$ of harmonic velocity one-forms is

$$\mathcal{H}^1_A = \{\alpha : d\alpha = 0,\ \delta\alpha = 0,\ \iota_{\mathbf{n}}\alpha = 0\}. \tag{2}$$

These fields have zero Hodge energy but can carry circulation. For positive mode index $i$, let $\Phi_i$ be a normalized velocity eigenfield and $\lambda_i$ its eigenvalue. On admissible velocities orthogonal to the harmonic sector, they satisfy the weak eigenproblem for every admissible test field $v$:

$$\langle d\Phi_i^\flat, dv^\flat\rangle = \lambda_i \langle \Phi_i, v\rangle, \qquad \lambda_i > 0, \tag{3}$$

The absolute Hodge realization has $\Phi_i \cdot \mathbf{n} = 0$ and $\iota_{\mathbf{n}} d\Phi_i^\flat = 0$; the latter is zero boundary vorticity in 2D and $\mathbf{n} \times \operatorname{curl} \Phi_i = 0$ in 3D. These are the natural Hodge slip conditions of the spectral problem. The envelope imposes impermeability directly; the energy determines the natural eigenfield condition.

## 2.2 Admissible neural potentials and the differential lift

Geometry determines the domain, quadrature and boundary envelope. Following the geometry-conditioned spectral representation of Chang et al. (2025), the network $f_\theta(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{g})$ has trainable parameters $\theta$ and outputs $K$ potential candidates $f_{\theta,i}$, indexed by $i = 1, \dots, K$, one per mode. The symbol $\widetilde{\mu}_i$ denotes the enveloped candidate before gauge selection and normalization: a scalar streamfunction in 2D and a vector potential in 3D. Geometry-family training samples $\mathbf{g}$ during optimization; fixed-domain training specializes this map to one geometry.

On a bounded domain we multiply each candidate by a differentiable geometry envelope $e_\mathbf{g}$ that vanishes on the domain boundary $\partial\Omega_\mathbf{g}$,

$$\widetilde{\mu}_i(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{g}) = e_\mathbf{g}(\mathbf{x}) f_{\theta,i}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{g}), \qquad e_\mathbf{g}|_{\partial\Omega_\mathbf{g}} = 0. \tag{4}$$

The zero envelope enforces a sufficient relative potential trace: zero streamfunction trace in 2D and zero tangential vector-potential trace in 3D. The periodic benchmark uses a periodic encoding and identity envelope. For a potential $\mu$, write $\psi$ for its scalar streamfunction in 2D and $\mathbf{A} = (A_1, A_2, A_3)$ for its vector potential in 3D. With $\nabla$ the spatial gradient, $\partial_x, \partial_y$ coordinate derivatives, and $\nabla^\perp$ the rotated gradient, the potential-to-velocity map $C = \star d$ specializes to

$$\mathbf{u} = C\mu = \begin{cases} \nabla^\perp\psi = (\partial_y\psi, -\partial_x\psi), & D = 2, \\ \operatorname{curl}\mathbf{A}, & D = 3. \end{cases} \tag{5}$$

Equivalently, the Neural Conservation Laws (NCL) construction represents velocity as the row-wise divergence of an antisymmetric matrix field (Richter-Powell et al., 2022): $u_i = \sum_j \partial_j \mathsf{S}_{ij}$ with $\mathsf{S} = -\mathsf{S}^\top$. Here $u_i$ is velocity component $i$, $\partial_j$ differentiates coordinate $j$, the component indices run from 1 to $D$, and $\top$ denotes transpose. For smooth fields, antisymmetry and commutation of mixed derivatives give

$$\operatorname{div}\mathbf{u} = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{i,j} \partial_i\partial_j\left(\mathsf{S}_{ij} + \mathsf{S}_{ji}\right) = 0. \tag{6}$$

In 3D the equivalent antisymmetric potential is the $3 \times 3$ tensor $\mathsf{S}$. With $\epsilon_{ijk}$ the Levi–Civita symbol, normalized by $\epsilon_{123} = 1$, its entries are $\mathsf{S}_{ij} = \sum_k \epsilon_{ijk} A_k$. In 2D, $\mathsf{S}_{12} = \psi$ and $\mathsf{S}_{21} = -\psi$.

These yield the rotated gradient and curl in Eq. (5), respectively. This cancellation is the coordinate form of $d^2 = 0$. In 2D a constant streamfunction trace has zero tangential derivative and hence zero normal velocity. In 3D the relative trace $\mathbf{n} \times \mathbf{A} = 0$ gives a curl with zero normal component. Linear combinations preserve these identities, so the parameterization builds the kinematic constraints into the spectral trial space.

Several potentials generate the same velocity. Gauge fixing chooses one representative so that its mass norm, orthogonalization and Rayleigh objective measure the flow-producing coordinates consistently.

## 2.3 Gauge representatives and the potential metric

**Scalar constants in 2D.** Periodic streamfunctions admit the constant freedom $\nabla^\perp(\psi + c) = \nabla^\perp\psi$. Here $c$ is an arbitrary scalar constant. We select the centered representative $\psi^\circ$ by subtracting the area-weighted mean $\langle\psi\rangle_\Omega$. Its quadrature approximation uses the node–weight set $Q = \{(\mathbf{x}_q, w_q)\}_q$, with node index $q$ and positive weights $w_q$:

$$\psi^\circ = \psi - \langle\psi\rangle_\Omega, \qquad \langle\psi\rangle_{\Omega,Q} = \frac{\sum_q w_q \psi(\mathbf{x}_q)}{\sum_q w_q}. \tag{7}$$

This centering removes the constant null coordinate before normalization, ordering, and Gram–Schmidt, and is differentiated during training. It makes the potential norm measure the spatially varying field: an unconstrained constant could otherwise lower the Rayleigh ratio arbitrarily without changing velocity.

For the bounded scalar Dirichlet problem, $\psi = 0$ on the boundary selects the representative. The multi-hole experiment uses this boundary-pinned mass norm. Scalar-field displays subtract one global spatial mean, preserving derivatives and circulation while giving the plots a common gauge. Appendix A.1 details the distinction between the boundary-pinned training metric and the centered display convention.

**Curl-free directions in 3D.** The vector-potential gauge kernel contains admissible gradients and may also contain relative harmonic fields. We first remove the gradients with a Coulomb projection, as also used in vector-potential fluid editing (Chen and Kanai, 2026). Let $\widetilde{\mathbf{A}}$ be the raw potential, $\phi$ its scalar gauge correction, $\Delta = \nabla \cdot \nabla$ the Laplacian, and $\mathbf{A}'$ the gradient-corrected field:

$$\Delta\phi = \operatorname{div} \widetilde{\mathbf{A}}, \qquad \phi|_{\partial\Omega} = 0, \qquad \mathbf{A}' = \widetilde{\mathbf{A}} - \nabla\phi, \tag{8}$$

We then obtain the canonical potential $\mathbf{A}^\circ$ using the identity operator $I$ and the mass-orthogonal projector $P_{\mathcal{H}^1_R}$ onto the relative harmonic potential space $\mathcal{H}^1_R$ (the subscript $R$ denotes relative boundary conditions):

$$\mathbf{A}^\circ = (I - P_{\mathcal{H}^1_R})\mathbf{A}'. \tag{9}$$

The exact representative is orthogonal to the kernel of $C$, has zero divergence, and preserves curl and the relative boundary trace. A geometry-dependent solve handles all mode right-hand sides together. For the Metaball Potential objective (the canonical curl quotient), the full relative compatible curl complex selects the mass-orthogonal canonical representative, with physical solve actions in FP64. The Potential-AL and Potential-FG controls use augmented-Lagrangian constraints and finite scalar/harmonic projection, respectively, as detailed in Appendix E.5. The removed relative harmonic *potential* fields $\mathcal{H}^1_R$ belong to the gauge kernel. The absolute harmonic *velocity* fields $\mathcal{H}^1_A$ carry physical circulation and enter the completed velocity basis.

## 2.4 Rayleigh learning and the effect of objective choice

Denote the selected potential representative by $\mu^\dagger$: canonical for the periodic/vector quotient and boundary-pinned for the scalar Dirichlet experiment. Following variational neural eigenfunction learning (E and Yu, 2018; Pfau et al., 2019; Rowan et al., 2025), the potential Rayleigh ratio $R_p$ and its Hodge velocity counterpart $R_v$ are

$$R_p(\mu^\dagger) = \frac{\|C\mu^\dagger\|^2}{\|\mu^\dagger\|^2}, \qquad R_v(\mu^\dagger) = \frac{\|d(C\mu^\dagger)\|^2}{\|C\mu^\dagger\|^2}. \tag{10}$$

For a streamfunction these are $\|\nabla\psi^\dagger\|^2/\|\psi^\dagger\|^2$ and $\|\Delta\psi\|^2/\|\nabla\psi\|^2$. For a canonical vector potential they are $\|\operatorname{curl}\mathbf{A}^\circ\|^2/\|\mathbf{A}^\circ\|^2$ and $\|\operatorname{curl}\operatorname{curl}\mathbf{A}^\circ\|^2/\|\operatorname{curl}\mathbf{A}^\circ\|^2$. We use **Potential** for potential-space Rayleigh training and **Velocity** for velocity-space Rayleigh training. Potential uses a scalar streamfunction in 2D and the mass-orthogonal canonical vector potential in 3D. Velocity optimizes the energy and mass of the lifted velocity; its network can still parameterize a potential before the differential lift. **Laplacian** denotes the numerically solved spectral basis, and **NKB** denotes the direct-velocity Neural Kinematic Basis. The potential controls are named **Potential-FG** for finite scalar/harmonic gauge projection and **Potential-AL** for augmented-Lagrangian constraints. The potential form therefore uses one fewer spatial derivative. Both variational energies learn the operator-defined coordinates directly from geometry and spatial derivatives.

The lower-order objective is linked to the velocity spectrum by the differential lift. Write $C^*$ for the mass-inner-product adjoint of $C$, and $\mu_i$ for a normalized potential eigenmode. If $C^*C\mu_i = \lambda_i\mu_i$ with $\lambda_i > 0$ and $\|\mu\|_i = 1$, then

$$\Phi_i = \frac{C\mu_i}{\sqrt{\lambda_i}}, \qquad CC^*\Phi_i = \lambda_i\Phi_i, \qquad \|\Phi_i\| = 1. \tag{11}$$

Under compatible relative/absolute domains, $CC^*$ is the positive Hodge velocity operator. The classical Hodge pairing gives the same exact nonzero spectrum, including multiplicities (Arnold et al., 2006). This includes mean-zero periodic fields and decaying free-space fields when integration by parts has no boundary contribution. The equivalence concerns eigenvalues and their lifted eigenspaces; for arbitrary approximate candidates the objectives obey Eq. (13). Appendix B gives the operator proof and its free-space specialization.

The objectives still differ away from an exact eigenspace. For a potential expansion $\mu = \sum_j a_j \mu_j$, with spectral coefficients $a_j$ and mode index $j$ in an orthonormal potential eigenbasis,

$$R_p = \frac{\sum_j \lambda_j |a_j|^2}{\sum_j |a_j|^2}, \qquad R_v = \frac{\sum_j \lambda_j^2 |a_j|^2}{\sum_j \lambda_j |a_j|^2} \geq R_p. \tag{12}$$

Writing $p_j = |a_j|^2 / \sum_\ell |a_\ell|^2$ defines probability weights on the eigenvalues. With $\mathbb{E}_p$ and $\mathrm{Var}_p$ denoting their weighted mean and variance, the difference is

$$R_v - R_p = \frac{\mathrm{Var}_p(\lambda)}{\mathbb{E}_p[\lambda]}. \tag{13}$$

Velocity learning places extra weight on high-frequency content in an approximate mode. This changes the optimization of a finite neural representation even though the exact spectra agree. The periodic experiment measures the resulting cost–accuracy tradeoff. Appendix B derives the correspondence and the boundary term relating componentwise gradient energy to curl energy in 3D.

## 2.5 Geometry-local ordering and causal orthogonalization

Multiple independent outputs must span distinct low-frequency directions. For quadrature points $(\mathbf{x}_q, w_q)$ with $w_q > 0$, define

$$\langle a, b \rangle_Q = \sum_q w_q a(\mathbf{x}_q) \cdot b(\mathbf{x}_q). \tag{14}$$

At each sampled geometry we select representatives, normalize them in the chosen metric, and sort detached preliminary Rayleigh values. The geometry-local permutation $\pi$ adapts the ordering to that domain. Let $\bar{\mu}_i$ be preliminary normalized representatives, $\nu_i$ their orthogonalization residuals, and $\widehat{\mu}_i$ the resulting unit-norm candidates, where $\|a\|_Q^2 = \langle a, a \rangle_Q$. The operator sg stops differentiation through its argument. The training loss $\mathcal{L}(\theta)$ averages the quadrature Rayleigh ratio $R_{p,Q}$ over the sampled geometry distribution, denoted by $\mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{g}}$. For the potential objective, causal orthogonalization follows Shape Space Spectra (Chang et al., 2025) and treats lower-ranked modes as fixed when learning the next mode:

$$\nu_i = \bar{\mu}_{\pi(i)} - \sum_{j<i} \langle \bar{\mu}_{\pi(i)}, \mathrm{sg}(\widehat{\mu}_j) \rangle_Q \, \mathrm{sg}(\widehat{\mu}_j), \tag{15}$$

$$\widehat{\mu}_i = \nu_i / \|\nu_i\|_Q, \qquad \mathcal{L}(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{g}} \sum_{i=1}^{K} R_{p,Q}(\widehat{\mu}_i). \tag{16}$$

A second orthogonalization pass reduces accumulated projection error. The causal gradient prevents a higher mode from changing a lower mode merely to simplify its own residual. Because gauge selection and the boundary constraints define linear spaces, the subsequent linear combinations preserve them.

The velocity objective uses the velocity inner product and corresponding energy, applying the same coefficient transform to every derivative channel. Spatial derivatives and parameter adjoints use an analytic CuPy implementation. At repeated eigenvalues, the identifiable object is the eigenspace; the mode atlas is interpreted up to signs and orthogonal rotations within that space.

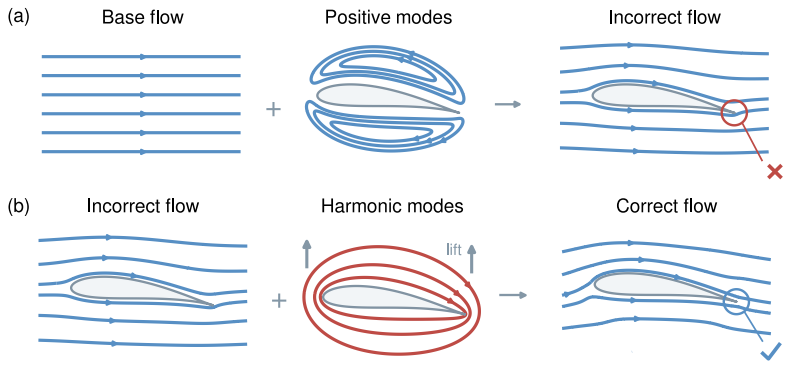


**Figure 2. Harmonic circulation completes the flow representation.** (a) A base flow combined with positive modes gives an incomplete, zero-circulation description of a lifting airfoil, with an incorrect sharp-trailing-edge flow. (b) Adding harmonic circulation permits smooth outflow satisfying the Kutta condition and generates lift in the presence of the base flow. Streamlines schematically illustrate the decomposition in Eq. (19).

## 2.6 Harmonic completion at fixed capacity

Harmonic zero-frequency fields complete the spectral ROM basis in Liu et al. (2015). We construct their neural counterparts with a dedicated boundary-value objective. Zero-trace positive streamfunctions describe the vortical sector; independent curl-free circulation is supplied by differences between boundary constants. Let $h$ be the number of holes, $\Gamma_0$ the outer boundary, and $\Gamma_m$ the boundary of obstacle $m = 1, \ldots, h$. For obstacle $\ell$, its harmonic measure $\chi_\ell$ solves the following problem, where $\delta_{\ell m}$ is the Kronecker delta:

$$\Delta\chi_\ell = 0, \qquad \chi_\ell|_{\Gamma_m} = \delta_{\ell m}, \qquad \chi_\ell|_{\Gamma_0} = 0, \tag{17}$$

The velocities $h_\ell = \nabla^\perp \chi_\ell$ are divergence-free, curl-free, and tangent to every boundary. Their span has one independent coordinate per hole. Cardinal boundary values are convenient coordinates; a further invertible circulation matrix can convert them into unit-period coordinates.

Let $L_\ell$ be a fixed lift of the cardinal boundary traces and $n_{\theta,\ell}$ a neural correction. The parameterization $\chi_\ell = L_\ell + e_{\mathbf{g}} n_{\theta,\ell}$ gives the correction zero trace. The harmonic training loss $\mathcal{L}_H$ therefore minimizes Dirichlet energy within this prescribed boundary-value space:

$$\mathcal{L}_H(\theta; \mathbf{g}) = \sum_{\ell=1}^{h} \int_{\Omega_{\mathbf{g}}} |\nabla \chi_\ell|^2 \, \mathrm{d}\mathbf{x}, \tag{18}$$

Fixed traces determine the scale of a harmonic measure, so this numerator-only objective directly realizes the Dirichlet principle through neural energy minimization (E and Yu, 2018). Appendix C.2 gives the variational derivation. Raw and scaled lifts parameterize the same boundary-value problem and correction space with different optimization coordinates. Holding the positive checkpoint fixed while changing the lift isolates this conditioning effect.

With $h$ holes and total dimension $K$, the completed representation contains $K - h$ positive modes and $h$ harmonic modes. Let $\mathbf{u}_{\text{base}}$ supply any prescribed base flow, and $a_i, b_\ell$ be the positive and harmonic coefficients:

$$\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{u}_{\text{base}} + \sum_{i=1}^{K-h} a_i \Phi_i + \sum_{\ell=1}^{h} b_\ell h_\ell. \tag{19}$$

The prescribed base flow carries nonhomogeneous data when present. Writing $P_K = \mathrm{span}\{\Phi_1, \ldots, \Phi_K\}$ and $H_h = \mathrm{span}\{h_1, \ldots, h_h\}$, the comparison $P_K$ versus $P_{K-h} + H_h$ changes the allocation of coordinates

while keeping their total number fixed. We abbreviate these allocations as P and P+H (or PH). They test topological completeness at the same capacity. Appendix C illustrates this distinction on an annulus and gives the circulation normalization.

Circulation is particularly important in lifting-airfoil flow. In the ideal slip-flow illustration of Figure 2, the Kutta condition selects a circulation $\Gamma$ and the classical Kutta–Joukowski lift per unit span has magnitude $\rho U_\infty |\Gamma|$, where $\rho$ is fluid density and $U_\infty$ the freestream speed (Batchelor, 2000). The harmonic coordinate permits that circulation to be represented alongside the base flow and positive modes. This motivates including the sector whenever the target physics requires it; the multi-hole experiments quantify its allocation at a fixed coordinate budget.

## 2.7 From the learned span to autonomous dynamics

Write the reduced velocity as $u = u_{\text{base}} + Uc$, where column $U_i$ is basis field $i$ and $c = (c_1, \dots, c_K)^\top$ is the coefficient state. Following spectral fluid Galerkin reduction (De Witt et al., 2012; Liu et al., 2015), let $t$ denote simulation time and $\dot{c} = \mathrm{d}c/\mathrm{d}t$. The full velocity mass matrix $M$ defines the coefficient metric, the vorticity/curl stiffness matrix $S$ supplies viscous dissipation, $\nu$ is kinematic viscosity, and $Q(c, c)$ is the quadratic advective load. Projection of the homogeneous unforced Hodge model gives

$$M\dot{c} = Q(c, c) - \nu S c, \qquad M_{ij} = \langle U_i, U_j \rangle, \quad S_{ij} = \langle dU_i^\flat, dU_j^\flat \rangle, \tag{20}$$

For indices $i, j, k = 1, \dots, K$, advection gives the quadratic load $[Q(c, c)]_i = \sum_{j,k} Q_{ijk} c_j c_k$, with $Q_{ijk} = -\langle U_i, (U_j \cdot \nabla) U_k \rangle$.

A base flow or force contributes the corresponding constant and linear terms. Exact orthonormal eigenfields make $M$ the identity and $S$ diagonal. For the learned span, retaining the full operators incorporates its measured metric and energy couplings into the dynamics.

For initial velocity $u_0$, the initial coefficients solve $Mc(0) = \langle U, u_0 - u_{\text{base}}(0) \rangle$, where the vector inner product has entry $\langle U_i, u_0 - u_{\text{base}}(0) \rangle$. This initializes an autonomous coefficient trajectory. Numerical reference states enter the subsequent error measurement. Learned and numerical bases use the same stated discrete generator within each matched comparison, including the normal-penalty grid generator in 3D.

**Offline assembly and coefficient-only integration.** For a fixed span and a quadratic discrete fluid generator, preassembled reduced operators (Treuille et al., 2006; De Witt et al., 2012; Liu et al., 2015) move full-field evaluation offline. Here $\mathcal{L}$ denotes the specified linear fluid generator (viscosity and any linear penalty or base-flow terms), while $\mathcal{N}$ denotes its bilinear advective part. Writing the generator as $\mathcal{L}u + \mathcal{N}(u, u)$ gives the reduced linear matrix $A$ and quadratic tensor $\mathcal{Q}$ below. The subscript $h$ denotes the discrete spatial quadrature:

$$M\dot{c} = Ac + \mathcal{Q}(c, c), \qquad A_{ij} = \langle U_i, \mathcal{L}U_j \rangle_h, \quad \mathcal{Q}_{ijk} = \langle U_i, \mathcal{N}(U_j, U_k) \rangle_h. \tag{21}$$

The same quadrature defines $M$ and the two assembled operators. During inference, each time-integration stage contracts these fixed operators with the current coefficient vector and solves the full mass system using its cached Cholesky factor. The recurrent state is therefore the reduced vector $c(t)$ throughout the trajectory. Spatial reconstruction $u(t) = u_{\text{base}}(t) + Uc(t)$ is performed only at requested output times, as illustrated in Figure 1. This is an algebraic reorganization of the chosen Galerkin system. Appendix E.2 measures operator equivalence, integration time, offline cost, and flow error separately.

# 3 Experiments

**Method names.** Potential and Velocity denote potential-space and velocity-space spectral training, respectively. Both generate velocity by differentiating neural potentials; NKB predicts velocity directly. Laplacian is the numerical spectral baseline. Potential-FG and Potential-AL denote the finite-gauge and augmented-Lagrangian potential controls. The same names label all figures and tables.

We evaluate how spectral objectives, harmonic completion, and reduced dynamics shape a learned flow basis. A periodic vortex merger measures learned-basis autonomous accuracy and viscous decay. One-, two-, and three-hole domains test the circulation sector and the conditioning of its neural coordinates. A three-dimensional Metaball domain then connects spatial capacity to autonomous accuracy and coefficient-space cost (Table 1).

**Table 1.** Validation goals and controlled comparisons.

| Case | Comparison | Validation |
|---|---|---|
| Periodic | Learned spectral and kinematic bases; same-capacity Laplacian | Neural eigenfluid and potential-space feasibility; autonomous accuracy and decay. |
| Multi-hole | Random small-scale fields and large-scale vortices; fixed-budget allocation and lift conditioning | Topology-aware circulation completion, energy capture and harmonic conditioning. |
| Metaball | Velocity-basis capacity; full-grid and assembled coefficient operators | 3D feasibility, capacity-dependent representation and coefficient-space acceleration. |

The field comparisons show the numerical ground-truth flow reference (Numerical GT), a same-capacity Laplacian basis, a potential-trained basis, and a velocity-trained basis. Let $u(t)$ be a reduced velocity and $u_{\mathrm{GT}}(t)$ the numerical reference at time $t$. Annotations give relative velocity error $e_u(t) = \|u(t) - u_{\mathrm{GT}}(t)\|_{L^2}/\|u_{\mathrm{GT}}(t)\|_{L^2}$, where $L^2$ is the spatial mass norm over the full assessment domain and plotted percentages are $100e_u$; we also write $e(t) = e_u(t)$. A subscript GT denotes a reference quantity; shared color scales preserve amplitude differences. Appendix D gives discretizations and convergence checks. Figure 7 compares the multiply connected modes, complemented by the periodic and three-dimensional atlases in Appendix G.

A fixed-case adaptation of Neural Kinematic Bases (Liu et al., 2025) provides an additional direct-velocity comparison under the stated training budget and common Galerkin evolution (Appendix H). Experiments are conducted on a workstation with an Intel Core i9-14900K CPU and an NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4080 SUPER GPU.

## 3.1 Case 1: Periodic vortex merger

The periodic domain admits an analytic Fourier basis and a mean-zero scalar gauge, providing a controlled setting for autonomous flow with learned spatial coordinates. The vortex pair has separation $d = 1.35$, with $K = 1024$ modes and a final simulation time $T = 18\pi$. All methods project the same initial velocity with the full mass matrix and retain every basis coordinate during evolution. The Laplacian (Fourier) basis supplies the same-capacity numerical control, following Laplacian Eigenfluids (De Witt et al., 2012).

**Autonomous evolution.** Figure 3 shows the potential-trained seed-0 trajectory through $t = 0, 9\pi, 18\pi$. Figure 4 measures velocity and vorticity errors, kinetic-energy decay, and enstrophy decay on the same case. The spatial basis is reused throughout the trajectory. Both learned spectral objectives sustain sub-percent

velocity error. Velocity learning gives the higher accuracy, while potential learning reduces training cost, matching the cost–accuracy tradeoff predicted by the objective analysis (Figure 4; Table 25). The potential and NKB trajectories have nearly identical synchronized integration times, yet the spectral span gives substantially smaller flow error (Table 30). Spectral organization therefore improves autonomous accuracy at comparable recurrent cost under this matched protocol. The absolute mean squared velocity error is reported in Table 2.

**Table 2.** Periodic vortex merger, $d = 1.35$, $T = 18\pi$, $K = 1024$. Velocity mean squared error (MSE) averages squared velocity-component errors over all 241 saved $128^2$ observation-grid states. Learned entries then average three seeds. Relative errors are visualized in Figure 4; training costs appear in Table 25. NKB uses the 2000-update adaptation in Appendix H.

| Basis | Velocity MSE |
|---|---|
| Laplacian | $9.737 \times 10^{-10}$ |
| Velocity | $8.882 \times 10^{-9}$ |
| Potential | $1.619 \times 10^{-7}$ |
| NKB | $2.823 \times 10^{-3}$ |

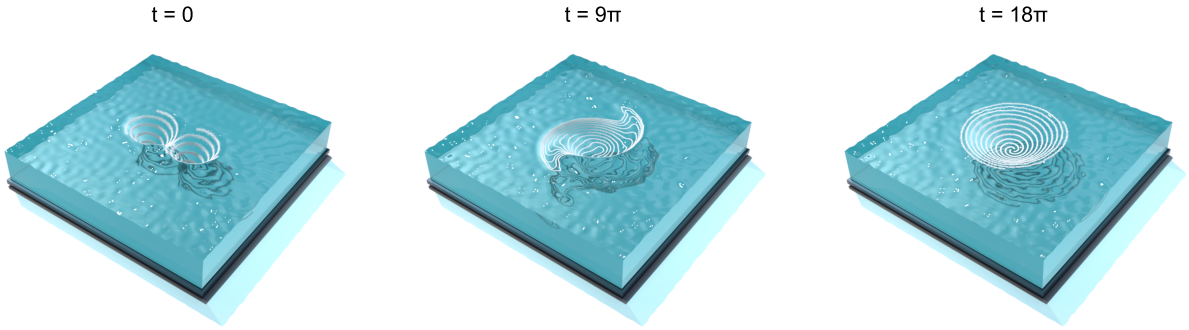


**Figure 3. Potential: periodic vortex merger.** Panels show the $K = 1024$, seed-0 Potential trajectory with vortex separation $d = 1.35$, from left to right at $t = 0, 9\pi, 18\pi$. Surface relief encodes smoothed vorticity magnitude on a common scale; white accents trace vortex structure. Height is a display coordinate for the two-dimensional flow.

## 3.2 Case 2: Multiply connected flow—energy compression and circulation

Each obstacle introduces an independent circulation coordinate. We consider two random flow ensembles: streamfunctions with many small-scale vortical structures, and combinations of a few smooth, large-scale vortices. Together they test energy compression, harmonic completion, and lift conditioning. The small-scale random-field comparison uses total $K = 1024$ throughout: $P_K$ and $P_{K-h} + H_h$ exchange positive and harmonic coordinates within the same state budget.

**Energy captured per reduced coordinate.** We sample streamfunctions in physical space from Gaussian lattice values and a quintic spline, then condition each draw to impermeability and zero boundary vorticity before analytic differentiation. Boundary constants are derived from the same draw, so its vortical and circulation content arise together. Frozen seeds [20260928, topology index, field index] define 20 reproducible fields per topology; indices 0 and 1 supply the six-field all-method dynamic comparison. Appendix D.4 specifies the generator, conditioning, and reference construction.

Let $W$ be the positive assessment quadrature matrix, with $\|v\|_W^2 = v^\top W v$ for sampled velocity $v$, and let $u_K = Uc_0$ be the full-mass projection of $u_0$, with initial coefficient vector $c_0 = c(0)$. The captured

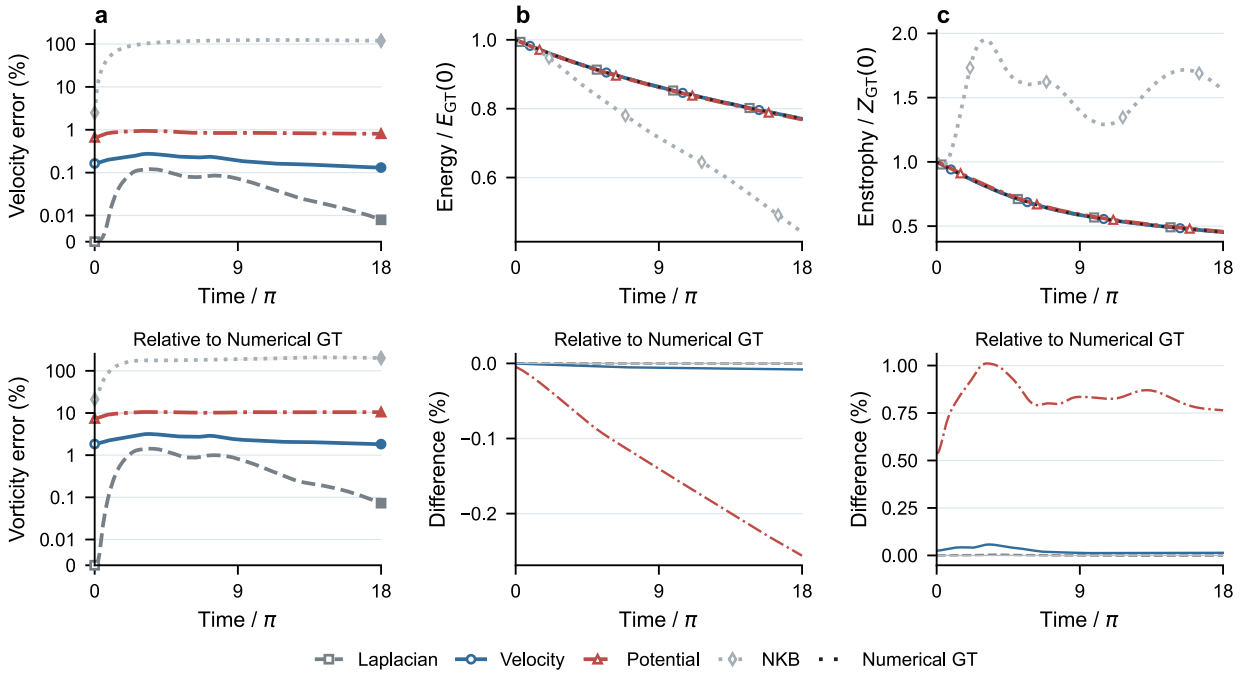


**Figure 4. Autonomous accuracy and decay in vortex merger.** All panels use $K = 1024$, $d = 1.35$, $T = 18\pi$. (a) Relative velocity (top) and vorticity (bottom) errors against Numerical GT, normalized by the corresponding time-dependent observation-grid $L^2$ norm. Learned curves show three-seed means with one sample standard deviation (SD), on a symmetric-log scale with a linear interval below 0.01%. Open and filled markers indicate initial and final states. (b) Kinetic energy, $E = \frac{1}{2}\langle|u|^2\rangle$. (c) Enstrophy, $Z = \frac{1}{2}\langle\omega^2\rangle$, where $\omega = \partial_x u_y - \partial_y u_x$ is scalar vorticity, $u_x, u_y$ are velocity components, and $\langle\cdot\rangle$ denotes the spatial mean. All five methods appear in the upper decay panels, using seed-0 learned trajectories and common initial GT normalization. Distinct line styles and sampled markers distinguish nearly overlapping curves. The lower panels of (b,c) show $100(E - E_{GT})/E_{GT}$ and $100(Z - Z_{GT})/Z_{GT}$ for Laplacian, velocity and potential bases. Curves use all 241 saved $128^2$ states from $256^2$ operator quadrature and maximum step 0.005.

kinetic-energy fraction is $\eta = \|u_K\|_W^2/\|u_0\|_W^2$. Potential bases capture more initial kinetic energy than equal-capacity Laplacian controls across all three topologies, with the largest gains in the two- and three-hole domains, while compressing the reference state by roughly three orders of magnitude (Figure 5). Most energy in these small-scale random fields lies in the vortical sector, represented by the spectrally ordered $P$ modes. Harmonic coordinates lift independent obstacle-boundary constants into circulation-carrying velocities (Arnold et al., 2006; Liu et al., 2015). At fixed $K$, their added harmonic energy competes with the energy of the $h$ displaced positive modes. This energy allocation favors positive coordinates for the small-scale ensemble, while harmonic coordinates provide its independent circulation sector (Appendix D.4).

**Autonomous dynamics at the same capacity.** Each representation evolves from its analytic-field projection using the full Galerkin operators, $\nu = 1/750$, and $T = 1$. The Potential P span combines higher initial energy capture with lower final trajectory error than the same-capacity Laplacian P control in every topology. Table 3 quantifies the paired effects of coordinate allocation on energy capture and trajectory accuracy. The nonlinear evolution couples these coordinates within the retained span. With $e_P, e_{PH}$ and $\eta_P, \eta_{PH}$ denoting the errors and energy fractions under the two allocations, its gains are $\Delta e = e_P - e_{PH}$ and $\Delta\eta = \eta_{PH} - \eta_P$, with positive values denoting improvement. Appendix D.4.5 gives the full method–field curves, reference checks, energy histories, and circulation diagnostics; Appendix D.4 provides the broader numerical capacity and low-dimensional allocation studies.

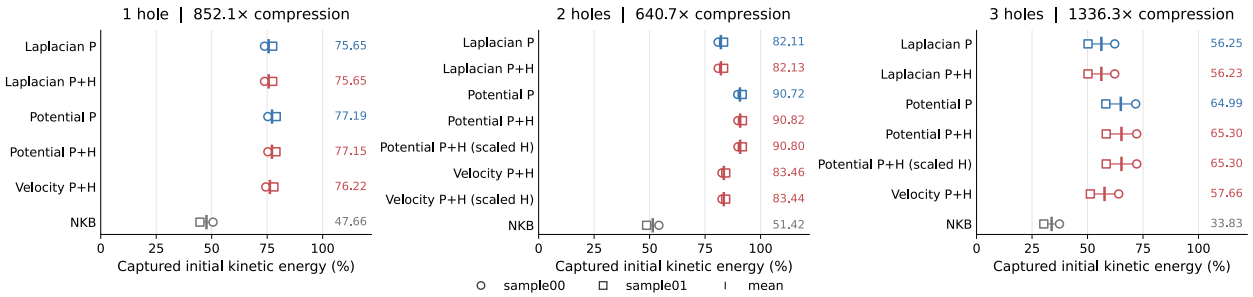


**Figure 5.** Initial energy captured by the original $K = 1024$ representations. Circles and squares denote the two predetermined physical fields in each topology; vertical ticks denote their mean. The annotations give mean captured-energy percentages and state-coordinate compression $N_{\text{ref}}/K$, where $N_{\text{ref}}$ is the number of independent coordinates of the reference state. The complete set of learned branches, raw/scaled harmonic coordinates, numerical controls, and NKBs use the same analytic initial fields.

**Table 3.** Paired changes under harmonic allocation on the six qualified random fields at total $K = 1024$. Each entry averages the two fixed fields in its topology. Initial capture $\eta$ uses the analytic-target full-mass projection; final velocity error uses the qualified numerical trajectory. Gains are $\Delta\eta = \eta_{PH} - \eta_P$ and $\Delta e(1) = e_P(1) - e_{PH}(1)$ in percentage points, so positive values favor completion. Absolute capture and trajectories are shown in Figures 5 and 11.

| Holes | Basis | $\Delta\eta$ | $\Delta e(1)$ |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Laplacian | +0.004 | +0.020 |
| 1 | Potential | -0.045 | +0.092 |
| 2 | Laplacian | +0.018 | +0.087 |
| 2 | Potential | +0.102 | -0.243 |
| 3 | Laplacian | -0.014 | +0.021 |
| 3 | Potential | +0.305 | +0.942 |

**Completion and conditioning in random large-vortex flows.** We randomly construct flows from a few smooth, large-scale vortices, with random locations, signs, and strengths. These flows combine local vorticity with motion around the obstacles. At $K = 32$, harmonic completion consistently lowers final error across all three obstacle configurations and brings the learned completed bases close to the numerical completed controls (Table 6). The boundary lifts make the independent circulation component accessible within a fixed-size reduced state. The two ensembles thus expose complementary demands on the basis: small-scale random fields emphasize vortical energy capture, while random large-vortex flows make topological completion and lift conditioning visible.

At $K = 1024$, raw/scaled pairs share the positive checkpoint, boundary traces, Dirichlet objective, initialization, and training budget. Scaling substantially lowers the multi-hole trajectory errors (Figure 18), whereas changing the spectral objective in the raw two-hole control has little effect. The paired comparison identifies harmonic-lift conditioning as the main source of this improvement. Table 4 gives the corresponding positive-only controls.

Once the harmonic fields are consistently conditioned, potential and velocity learning produce similar trajectory errors. Figure 6 shows the resulting flow, and Appendix F gives the matched-objective and conditioning comparisons.

**Topology-dependent spectral modes.** Figure 7 compares the first eight positive modes of the Laplacian and both learned constructions across three obstacle configurations. The aligned panels show each basis's spatial structure and ordering; independent harmonic coordinates complete the span.

**Table 4.** Positive-only controls for the random large-vortex ensemble: final relative velocity error (%), total $K = 1024$, $T = 1$, averaged over 20 initial states. Learned positive modes use potential training, seed 1. Completed bases and raw/scaled lift comparisons are visualized in Figure 18.

| Holes | Numerical $P$ | Learned $P$ |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | 32.542 | 32.124 |
| 2 | 34.197 | 33.963 |
| 3 | 36.685 | 36.707 |

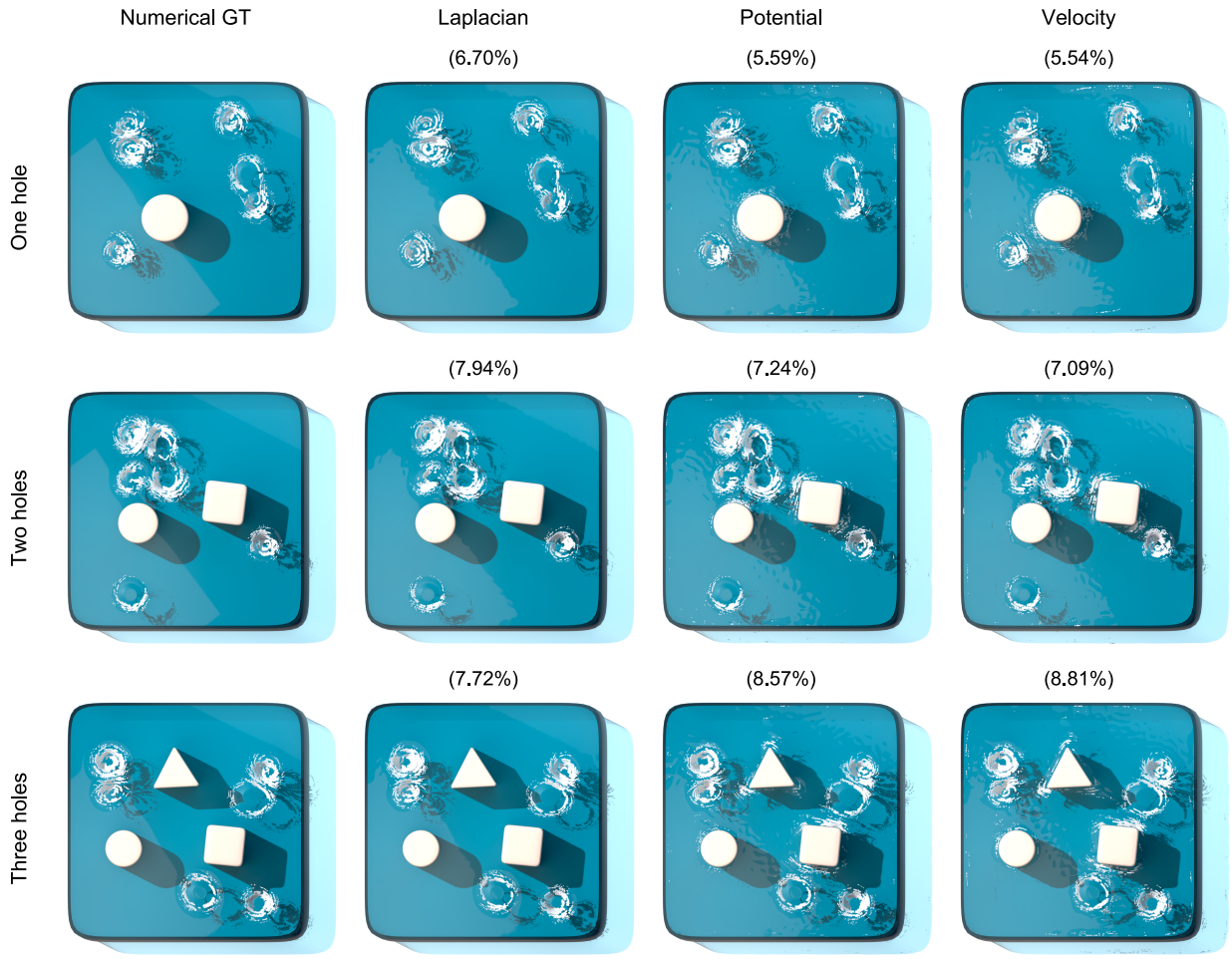


**Figure 6. Random large-vortex flow at $K = 1024$.** Rows: one-, two-, and three-hole domains. Columns: numerical reference, Laplacian, potential- and velocity-trained bases at $t = 1$, seed 1, state 00. Reduced bases have $1024 - h$ positive and $h$ harmonic coordinates; the learned objectives share raw $H_1$ and scaled $H_2, H_3$. Errors use the common level-2 reference. Overhead views share height and foam mappings within each geometry (Appendix F).

## 3.3 Case 3: 3D Metaball—representation and autonomous evolution

The three-dimensional domain tests how a learned span supports autonomous dynamics. We separate the error due to spatial representation from the error in coefficient evolution, then measure the cost of evaluating the same reduced generator entirely in coefficient space.

**Figure 7. Positive spectral modes across obstacle topologies.** Panels (a–c) show one-, two-, and three-hole domains. Within each panel, rows compare Laplacian, potential-trained, and velocity-trained fields; columns show modes 1–8. Learned fields follow the positive-mode selection order in the total-32 continuous piecewise-linear finite-element (P1) basis, whose $h$ harmonic coordinates are separate. The shared color scale shows area-centered streamfunction divided by its per-mode maximum magnitude. Signs and rotations within repeated eigenspaces preserve the span.

**Autonomous flow at 1024 modes.** Figure 8 compares a velocity-trained $K = 1024$ basis with same-capacity Laplacian and NKB bases against the common independent $128^3$ normal-penalty Navier–Stokes (NS) reference. All three evolve autonomously from full-mass projections of the same initial field. Eigenfluid and Laplacian begin with comparable reconstruction quality and develop similar relative errors during autonomous evolution. The vector-error panels in Figure 8 also highlight similar regions of elevated error. Their agreement in error magnitude and spatial structure identifies the shared role of truncated Galerkin dynamics. Both methods compress the flow into the same number of coordinates, with nonlinear interactions resolved within that

span. This correspondence connects the learned continuous basis to the established spectral ROM behavior at the same compression level. Figure 10 examines the joint contributions of spatial capacity and coefficient dynamics.

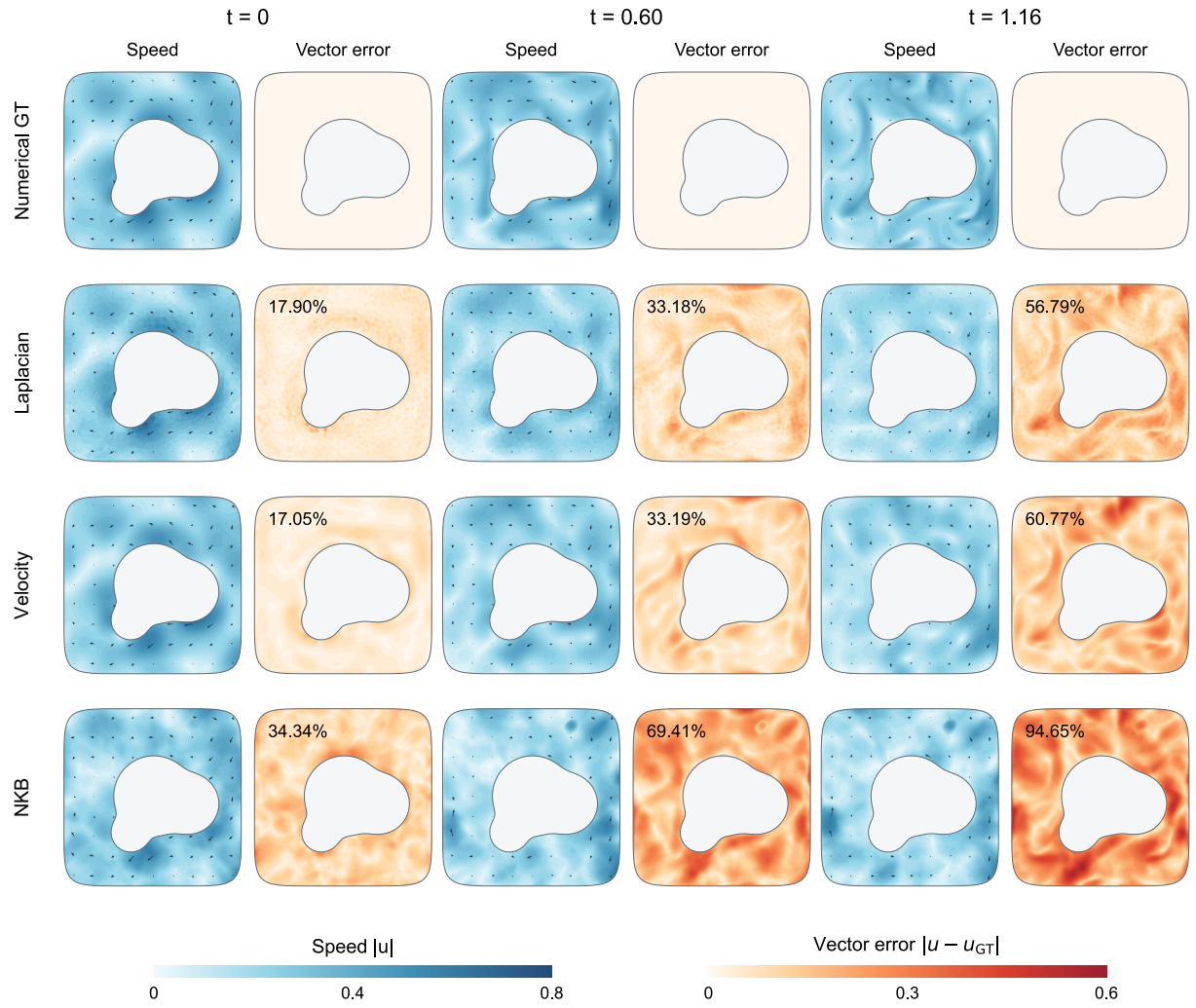


**Figure 8. Three-dimensional autonomous flow at $K = 1024$.** Rows show Numerical GT, Laplacian, Velocity, and NKB; columns show $t = 0, 0.60, 1.16$. Each time pairs speed $|u|$ (blue) with pointwise vector error $|u - u_{\mathrm{GT}}|$ (orange–red) on the offset $z = 0.31640625$ slice, which exposes the fused Metaball silhouette. Filled contours interpolate the saved nodal values and are clipped to the original geometry's smooth boundary. Speed, error, and in-plane arrow lengths use separate fixed scales across all methods and times. Percentages in the upper-left corner of the vector-error panels denote full-volume relative velocity error, evaluated on all 1,599,754 fluid nodes. Here $\Delta t$ is the integration time step; ROM trajectories use $\Delta t = 0.000625$ and the common NS reference uses $\Delta t = 0.0025$.

**Spatial capacity.** Increasing capacity improves both initial reconstruction and autonomous accuracy under the same training budget, full-volume reference, and assessment times (Figure 10). At the largest capacity of the autonomous study, the learned span has lower initial projection error than the Laplacian control. The matched $K = 2048$ projection extends this trend (Table 12): the learned basis captures more initial kinetic energy at both high capacities. Appendix E.1 gives the detailed projection and training-cost comparison.

**Representation of randomized 3D large-eddy fields.** Figure 9 compares the frozen Metaball spans on 20 independently randomized large-eddy initial states. A case-local Philox stream draws 96 independent standard-Gaussian sine and cosine coefficients for a three-component vector potential over 16 representatives of the integer wavevector pairs $\pm\boldsymbol{k}$ with $1 \le \|\boldsymbol{k}\| \le 2$. Coefficients are scaled by $1/\|\boldsymbol{k}\|$; the raw potential wavelengths range from 0.5 to 1 unit-domain length. The analytic curl follows the common $128^3$ Metaball incompressibility projection and boundary conditioning, RMS normalization to 0.32, and four warm-up substeps. Each frozen basis projects the same states using the full physical mass matrix, all 1,599,754 fluid nodes, and all $K$ retained coordinates. Errors decrease with capacity; at $K = 256$, mean relative velocity errors are Laplacian $26.51102 \pm 3.94584\%$, Velocity $31.26405 \pm 5.95889\%$, Potential $26.10521 \pm 3.97608\%$, and NKB $56.03645 \pm 2.70518\%$ (mean $\pm$ sample standard deviation). At $K = 512$, Potential gives $23.73323 \pm 3.99279\%$, compared with Laplacian $23.90729 \pm 4.04593\%$, with lower Potential error in 15 of the same 20 states. This paired assessment measures representation of independently sampled large eddies with each training checkpoint held fixed; the autonomous-flow study evaluates evolution on its trajectory initial condition. Assessment states are separate from basis training and selection, and NKB uses geometry alone. Appendix E.5 documents the Potential-FG and Potential-AL configurations; Appendix E.7 reports preparation costs.

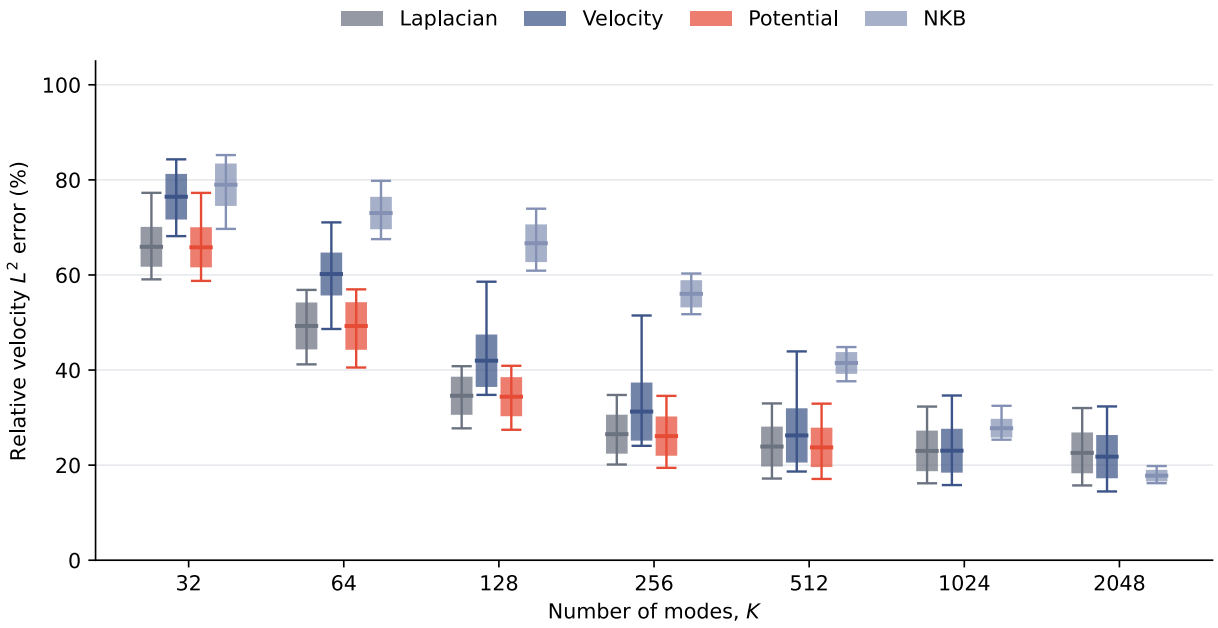


**Figure 9. Representation of independently randomized large-eddy fields.** Relative velocity $L^2$ errors on the same 20 paired initial states generated by independent Gaussian vector-potential Fourier coefficients and common Metaball physical conditioning. The 26 method–capacity groups contain 520 model–field measurements. Solid rectangles span mean $\pm$ sample standard deviation ($n = 20$, ddof $= 1$); whisker caps show the observed minimum and maximum. Each frozen basis uses all $K$ retained modes and all 1,599,754 fluid nodes in the full-mass representation comparison. Potential extends through $K = 512$; Laplacian, Velocity, and NKB extend through $K = 2048$. Horizontal offsets separate the methods at each capacity.

**Separating the two error sources.** Projection onto each frozen span separates autonomous error into orthogonal representation and in-span coefficient terms (Eq. (43)). The extended decomposition shows the

same pattern through 1024 modes: a richer span lowers the best-projection error, while the coefficient term remains nearly unchanged at the upper capacities (Table 11). Spatial refinement and coefficient evolution thus control complementary parts of the reduced model. The decomposition makes the representation gain explicit and connects the common evolution pattern to the retained-coordinate dynamics.

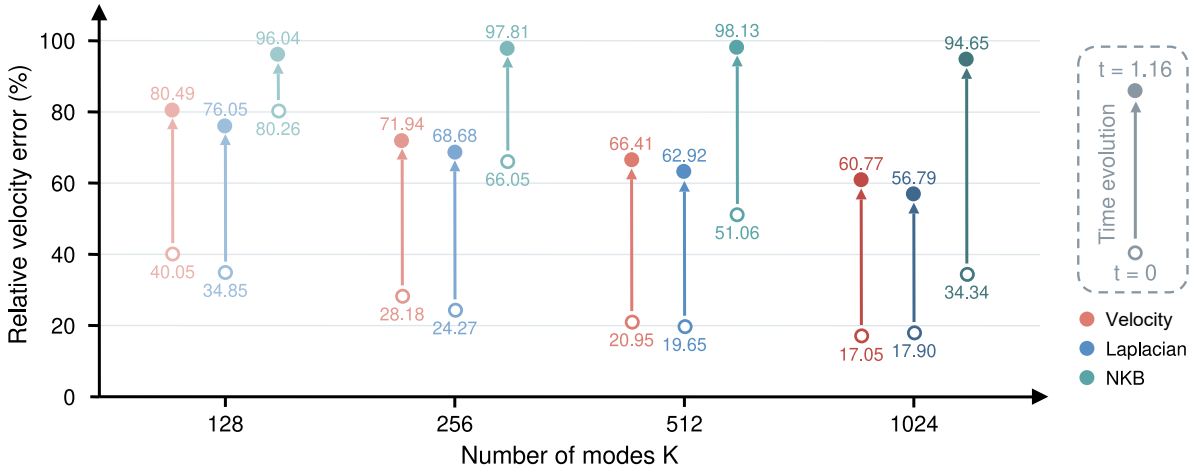


**Figure 10. Spatial capacity and autonomous accuracy through 1024 modes.** Initial full-mass projection error (open circles, $t = 0$) and final autonomous error (filled circles, $T = 1.16$) for $K = 128, 256, 512, 1024$. Within each capacity, Velocity, Laplacian, and NKB bases are offset from left to right for readability; color identifies the basis and darkens with increasing capacity. Arrows connect the two assessment times. All errors are percentages, evaluated against the same full-volume reference using all trained coordinates. Each trajectory has 30 stored states through $T = 1.16$, with ROM step $\Delta t = 0.000625$ and common NS reference step $\Delta t = 0.0025$. Training costs are listed in Table 25. The error decomposition is specified in Appendix D.5.

**Exact coefficient-space execution.** Preassembling the full quadratic Galerkin operator moves spatial evaluation out of recurrent time stepping. The resulting integration is faster than the matched-step NS control at both tested capacities, with assembled and direct reduced right-hand sides agreeing to numerical precision. This acceleration comes from executing the same reduced generator in coefficient space. Table 13 reports timings and one-time assembly costs; Figure 14 shows the associated flow errors. Repeated initial-condition queries reuse that assembly, motivating the amortization analysis below.

**Continuous reconstruction across query domains.** The same frozen neural map can be evaluated at held-out points and on three unseen domains. Appendix E.9 reports these reconstruction measurements together with target-specific numerical controls. This assessment complements the capacity study by examining how the continuous coordinates respond to changes in query location and geometry.

## 3.4 Continuous basis queries and amortized inference

The learned object is the map $(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{g}) \mapsto U_\theta(\mathbf{x}; \mathbf{g})$ from spatial coordinates and geometry parameters to a vector-valued basis. Once trained, this map supplies basis values and analytic spatial derivatives at newly requested locations without repeating variational optimization or solving a new eigenproblem. It supports arbitrarily dense spatial resampling: there is no fixed output lattice or discrete set of admissible query points. For a geometry-conditioned model, geometry parameters can likewise be queried continuously within its

learned family. The three-dimensional capacity experiment uses a fixed-domain checkpoint; the continuous geometry-family construction is exercised in the planar cases.

**Online latency and numerical comparison.** The map supplies spatial fields once a geometry is selected; operator assembly then prepares their recurrent coefficient dynamics. Synchronized measurements give mean RK4 update times of 3.79 ms at $K = 512$ and 26.18 ms at $K = 1024$, with field reconstruction charged at requested outputs. Table 13 reports NS integration speedups, alongside the flow errors in Figure 14. This cost separation makes reuse explicit: trajectories on one geometry share the basis and assembled operators, while initial projection and selected field outputs belong to each query.

**When repeated inference recovers training cost.** For $n$ trajectories on one geometry, let $T_{\text{train}}$ denote training, $T_{\text{off}}$ the reusable preparation cost, and $T_{\text{ROM}}, T_{\text{NS}}$ the per-trajectory integration costs. The smallest integration-only break-even count $n_\star$ is given below, with $\lceil\cdot\rceil$ denoting rounding up to an integer:

$$n_\star = \left\lceil \frac{T_{\text{train}} + T_{\text{off}}}{T_{\text{NS}} - T_{\text{ROM}}} \right\rceil, \qquad T_{\text{NS}} > T_{\text{ROM}}. \tag{22}$$

Repeated initial-condition queries amortize both training and reusable operator preparation. Table 33 gives the counts and exact timer boundaries. Projection and requested field output enter the per-query cost when included in the workload. For a parameterized family, training is shared across geometry queries, while each geometry's basis generation and operator preparation are charged to that query (Appendix I.5).

# 4 Conclusion

Neural eigenfluids express a physically structured fluid spectrum through a continuous spatial basis. Differential lifts and potential traces define admissible velocities; geometry-local orthogonalization and Rayleigh minimization organize their positive modes. Canonical gauge selection gives potential-space learning a lower-derivative formulation, with the spectral-variance relation explaining its weighting of approximate modes. A neural Dirichlet construction supplies the independent harmonic circulation coordinates.

The experiments connect this structure to representation and dynamics. Learned spectral spans sustain accurate periodic vortex merger and improve energy capture and autonomous accuracy over equal-capacity Laplacian controls on directly sampled random fields. Completed bases express obstacle-scale circulation, and matched conditioning tests identify how harmonic coordinates affect evolution. In three dimensions, increasing capacity reduces spatial representation error while exposing the contribution of coefficient dynamics to total flow error. Full quadratic assembly moves the same reduced generator into coefficient space, allowing repeated initial states to share their spatial basis and operators. Continuous evaluation, physical spectral organization, and reusable autonomous computation are thus realized within one reduced representation.

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# A Gauge representatives and their physical meaning

This appendix develops the gauge projection, spectral correspondence, and harmonic completion used in the construction. Experimental protocols, three-dimensional comparisons, flow visualizations, and mode atlases follow the mathematical details.

## A.1 Scalar constants and boundary-pinned representatives

For a connected domain, $\nabla^\perp(\psi + c) = \nabla^\perp\psi$. The mean-zero projection $P_0\psi = \psi - \langle\psi\rangle_\Omega$ is invariant to a constant shift, preserves all spatial derivatives, and selects a unique representative. Let $w$ be the column vector of positive quadrature weights, $\mathbf{1}$ the all-ones vector, and $\psi_q = \psi(\mathbf{x}_q)$. The discrete projector is $P_0 = I - \mathbf{1}w^\top/(\mathbf{1}^\top w)$; backpropagation uses its transpose in Euclidean coordinates. In particular,

$$\sum_q w_q (P_0\psi)_q = 0, \qquad \|P_0\psi\|_Q^2 = \|\psi\|_Q^2 - \frac{(\sum_q w_q\psi_q)^2}{\sum_q w_q}.$$

For a periodic scalar potential, this removes the constant kernel before the spectral mass is formed. Without removal, $\|\nabla(\psi + c)\|^2/\|\psi + c\|^2 \to 0$ as $|c| \to \infty$, although the physical velocity is unchanged.

For a homogeneous Dirichlet scalar eigenproblem, $\psi = 0$ on the boundary excludes nonzero constant shifts from the admissible space and fixes the representative used in its mass form. Centering this function changes the mass form and is therefore used here for display only: it changes the common boundary value to $-\langle\psi\rangle_\Omega$ while preserving velocity. Finite-element scalar displays use area-weighted means, and periodic displays use uniform-grid means.

On a multiply connected domain, independent boundary constants encode physical harmonic velocities. Subtracting one global constant preserves their differences. It therefore fixes scalar gauge without deleting

circulation degrees of freedom. Each connected component requires its own additive convention if the fluid domain itself is disconnected.

### A.2 Vector gauge as a quotient-space projection

Let $d_R^k$ denote exterior differentiation of degree-$k$ forms with relative boundary trace; its adjoint is $\delta_R^{k+1}$. The closed potential-to-velocity operator is $C = \star d_R^{D-2}$. Writing ker for the nullspace and $\perp$ for mass-orthogonal complement, the canonical potential space is $(\ker C)^\perp$. In 3D, exact-gradient removal is the orthogonal projection defined using scalar test functions $\eta \in H_0^1(\Omega)$, where $H_0^1$ is the Sobolev space of functions with square-integrable first derivatives and zero boundary trace:

$$\langle \nabla\phi, \nabla\eta \rangle = \langle \widetilde{\mathbf{A}}, \nabla\eta \rangle, \qquad \eta \in H_0^1(\Omega).$$

Integration by parts gives Eq. (8). Removing the remaining relative harmonic kernel completes the projection. Both corrections have zero curl, and a Dirichlet scalar has no tangential derivative on the boundary, so curl and the relative tangential trace are preserved.

To see why this operation belongs before the loss, choose a nonzero $\kappa \in \ker C$. The family $\mu_\alpha = \mu + \alpha\kappa$ represents exactly the same velocity for every real scalar $\alpha$, yet

$$\frac{\|C\mu_\alpha\|^2}{\|\mu_\alpha\|^2} = \frac{\|C\mu\|^2}{\|\mu + \alpha\kappa\|^2} \longrightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } |\alpha| \longrightarrow \infty. \tag{23}$$

The unprojected quotient can therefore decrease without improving a physical mode. On the canonical space this ambiguity disappears. Write $L^2\Lambda^k$ for square-integrable degree-$k$ forms, Ran for operator range, an overline for closure, and $\oplus$ for orthogonal direct sum. The relative harmonic space $\mathcal{H}_R^k$ contains the closed, coclosed forms with relative boundary trace. With the orthogonal Hodge decomposition (Arnold et al., 2006)

$$L^2\Lambda^{D-2} = \overline{\operatorname{Ran} d_R^{D-3}} \oplus \mathcal{H}_R^{D-2} \oplus \overline{\operatorname{Ran} \delta_R^{D-1}}, \tag{24}$$

the last summand is $(\ker C)^\perp$. Let $\Delta_H = d\delta + \delta d$ be the positive Hodge Laplacian and $G_R$ its relative-boundary Green pseudoinverse. The exact projector is $P_{\mathrm{gf}} = \delta_R d_R G_R$, and it satisfies

$$P_{\mathrm{gf}}(\mu + \kappa) = P_{\mathrm{gf}}\mu, \quad CP_{\mathrm{gf}}\mu = C\mu, \quad \delta_R P_{\mathrm{gf}}\mu = 0. \tag{25}$$

Normalization and Gram–Schmidt consequently act on physical equivalence classes. In a finite auxiliary space, the invariance identity applies to the resolved kernel directions; Appendix E quantifies the residual for the three-dimensional implementation.

## B Spectral correspondence, objective weighting, and boundaries

### B.1 Pairing the nonzero spectrum

Take $C$ to be a densely defined closed operator between the potential and velocity Hilbert spaces, with Hilbert adjoint $C^*$. The classical spectral relationship follows from the paired normal operators of the differential complex (Arnold et al., 2006), with the differential-complex domains determining which physical boundary problem they realize.

**Proposition 1** (Positive-spectrum correspondence)**.** *If $C^*C\mu = \lambda\mu$ with $\lambda > 0$ and $\|\mu\| = 1$, then $u = C\mu/\sqrt{\lambda}$ has unit norm and satisfies $CC^*u = \lambda u$. Conversely, $\mu = C^*u/\sqrt{\lambda}$ maps a positive eigenfield back to the canonical potential space.*

*Proof.* The norm identity is $\|C\mu\|^2 = \langle \mu, C^*C\mu \rangle = \lambda$. Applying $C$ to the potential eigenproblem gives the velocity equation. Applying $C^*$ gives the converse. Positive eigenvectors are orthogonal to the corresponding kernels. With the relative/absolute Hodge domains, the range of the lift is the coexact absolute velocity sector; physical harmonic velocities form its orthogonal complement. □

For the absolute Hodge domain, smooth velocities obey $\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{n} = 0$ and $\mathbf{n} \times \operatorname{curl} \mathbf{u} = 0$ in 3D (zero boundary vorticity in 2D). These boundary conditions, together with the differential energy, identify the physical realization of the paired normal operators.

### B.2 Periodic and decaying free-space specialization

For periodic potentials with zero mean, $C = \nabla^\perp$ in 2D and $C = \operatorname{curl}$ on divergence-free canonical vector potentials in 3D commute with $-\Delta$. Thus $-\Delta\mu = \lambda\mu$ implies $-\Delta(C\mu) = \lambda C\mu$. Normalization gives the correspondence $u = C\mu/\sqrt{\lambda}$ from the proposition above. Conversely, $\mu = C^*u/\sqrt{\lambda}$ maps a positive velocity eigenfield back to the canonical potential eigenspace. The maps are inverse on each positive eigenspace and preserve its multiplicity.

On $\mathbb{R}^D$, smooth fields with sufficient decay give the same identities without a wall boundary contribution. In Fourier coordinates, let $\xi$ be spatial frequency, $i$ the imaginary unit, a hat the Fourier transform, and $\xi^\perp = (\xi_y, -\xi_x)$ in 2D. The positive symbol is $|\xi|^2$; $\widehat{u} = i\xi^\perp\widehat{\psi}$ in 2D and $\widehat{u} = i\xi \times \widehat{A}$ with $\xi \cdot \widehat{A} = 0$ in 3D. For $\xi \neq 0$, these maps pair the potential and divergence-free velocity spectral sectors. Free space generally has continuous spectrum, so this statement is a spectral correspondence rather than a discrete list of square-integrable eigenmodes. For either periodic cancellation or decay at infinity, integration by parts also gives $\|\nabla u\|^2 = \|\operatorname{curl} u\|^2$ for divergence-free velocity. A bounded curved-wall problem requires its specified boundary domain. Even when the positive spectra agree, $R_p$ and $R_v$ coincide on exact eigenspaces and differ on mixtures according to Eq. (13).

### B.3 Weak formulation and its 2D specialization

For scalar Dirichlet trial functions $\psi, \eta \in H_0^1(\Omega)$,

$$\langle C\psi, C\eta \rangle = \int_\Omega \nabla\psi \cdot \nabla\eta \, \mathrm{d}\mathbf{x}. \tag{26}$$

Stationarity of $\frac{1}{2}\|\nabla\psi\|^2 - \frac{\lambda}{2}(\|\psi\|^2 - 1)$ therefore yields

$$\int_\Omega \nabla\psi \cdot \nabla\eta \, \mathrm{d}\mathbf{x} = \lambda \int_\Omega \psi\eta \, \mathrm{d}\mathbf{x}, \qquad \eta \in H_0^1(\Omega). \tag{27}$$

The first-derivative form realizes $C^*C = -\Delta_D$, where $-\Delta_D$ is the positive Dirichlet Laplacian. If $-\Delta\psi = \lambda\psi$ and $u = \nabla^\perp\psi$, then

$$\operatorname{div} u = 0, \quad u \cdot \mathbf{n} = 0, \quad -\Delta u = \lambda u, \qquad \omega = \partial_x u_y - \partial_y u_x = \lambda\psi. \tag{28}$$

The boundary vorticity vanishes because the streamfunction trace does. This explicitly identifies the compatible 2D Hodge problem. On the periodic domain, the same calculation uses mean-zero periodic functions in place of Dirichlet trial functions.

For compatible form domains, the general calculation is the commutation identity $\Delta_H d = d\Delta_H$, which follows from $d^2 = 0$, together with $\Delta_H \star = \star\Delta_H$. It yields $\Delta_H \star d\mu = \lambda \star d\mu$ for a potential eigenform. The absolute harmonic velocities remain outside the positive lifted sector and must be supplied independently.

### B.4 Spectral moments and the choice of velocity energy

For nonnegative integer $r$, define the spectral moment $m_r = \sum_j \lambda_j^r |a_j|^2$ in an orthonormal canonical eigenbasis. Potential and velocity Rayleigh ratios are $m_1/m_0$ and $m_2/m_1$. In 2D, a direct-vorticity objective gives $m_3/m_2$. Cauchy–Schwarz gives $m_r^2 \le m_{r-1} m_{r+1}$, hence

$$\frac{m_1}{m_0} \le \frac{m_2}{m_1} \le \frac{m_3}{m_2}.$$

Equality holds when the nonzero coefficients occupy one eigenvalue eigenspace. At repeated eigenvalues the eigenspace, rather than the phase or orientation of individual modes, is identifiable.

The Hodge velocity form is $\|\operatorname{curl} \mathbf{u}\|^2 + \|\operatorname{div} \mathbf{u}\|^2$, reducing to curl energy on divergence-free fields. The componentwise Dirichlet form $\|\nabla \mathbf{u}\|^2$ coincides with it on a periodic domain and differs by boundary terms on a general bounded domain. The 3D velocity experiments use the componentwise Dirichlet quotient during training and the common discrete NS generator during evolution. Their boundary-energy relation is given below.

### B.5 The boundary term in gradient and curl energy

For a smooth vector field on a Euclidean domain, with $\mathrm{d}S$ denoting boundary surface measure, integration by parts gives

$$\|\operatorname{curl} u\|^2 + \|\operatorname{div} u\|^2 - \|\nabla u\|^2 = \int_{\partial\Omega} \left[(u \cdot n) \operatorname{div} u - n \cdot ((u \cdot \nabla)u)\right] \, \mathrm{d}S. \tag{29}$$

Periodic faces cancel, and a strong componentwise-zero trace also eliminates the right-hand side. For a tangent field on a curved wall, the remaining term depends on the wall geometry. Thus a bounded-domain spectral problem is specified jointly by its energy and boundary domain.

## C Topology completion and reduced evolution

### C.1 One scalar gauge constant versus physical boundary differences

Let $r$ be radial distance, $r_{\text{in}}, r_{\text{out}}$ the inner and outer radii, and $e_\theta$ the azimuthal unit vector. The annulus $r_{\text{in}} < r < r_{\text{out}}$ provides a concrete example; $\gamma$ is a counterclockwise loop around its hole and $\mathrm{d}l$ its oriented line element. The streamfunction $\psi = \log r$ has

$$u = \nabla^\perp \psi = -\frac{1}{r} e_\theta, \qquad \operatorname{div} u = 0, \quad \operatorname{curl} u = 0, \quad \oint_\gamma u \cdot \, \mathrm{d}l = -2\pi \tag{30}$$

for a counterclockwise loop around the hole. Subtracting the spatial mean of $\psi$ leaves this circulation unchanged. Setting both boundary values to the same constant would instead remove this harmonic component. The former changes only the representative; the latter changes the physical field.

For $h$ holes, the harmonic measures of Eq. (17) form convenient independent coordinates. Let $H_\ell = \nabla^\perp \chi_\ell$ and let $\gamma_m$ encircle hole $m$ counterclockwise. Define the period matrix $P_{m\ell} = \oint_{\gamma_m} H_\ell \cdot \, \mathrm{d}l$. If unit-circulation coordinates are desired, set $\widetilde{H}_\ell = \sum_j H_j (P^{-1})_{j\ell}$. Then $\oint_{\gamma_m} \widetilde{H}_\ell \cdot \, \mathrm{d}l = \delta_{m\ell}$. This invertible change of coordinates preserves the span. The reduced mass matrix accounts for the actual harmonic basis used in computation.

## C.2 Harmonic training with a numerator-only Rayleigh energy

The harmonic sector already appears in the spectral ROM of Liu et al. (2015), whose Section 3.1 includes the zero-frequency vector fields and whose Appendix A discusses both kernel eigenvectors and sparse harmonic solves. Our construction learns this sector through geometry-conditioned potentials. Each harmonic measure is learned in the affine admissible space $\mathcal{A}_\ell$ below, where $\chi$ is a trial scalar field and $H^1(\Omega)$ is the Sobolev space without a zero-trace restriction:

$$\mathcal{A}_\ell = \{\chi \in H^1(\Omega) : \chi|_{\Gamma_0} = 0,\ \chi|_{\Gamma_m} = \delta_{\ell m}\} = L_\ell + H_0^1(\Omega). \tag{31}$$

The prescribed boundary differences fix the amplitude and circulation coordinate. The Dirichlet principle therefore supplies the unnormalized potential Rayleigh numerator in Eq. (18), rather than a spectral quotient (E and Yu, 2018). For Dirichlet energy $E(\chi) = \int_\Omega |\nabla\chi|^2$ and any admissible variation $v \in H_0^1(\Omega)$ with real variation parameter $\varepsilon$,

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}\varepsilon} E(\chi + \varepsilon v)\bigg|_{\varepsilon=0} = 2\int_\Omega \nabla\chi \cdot \nabla v = -2\int_\Omega (\Delta\chi) v = 0. \tag{32}$$

Thus the minimizer solves $\Delta\chi = 0$ with the cardinal traces, giving a curl-free velocity $u_H = \nabla^\perp\chi$. The traces exclude the trivial zero field, and the energy is strictly convex in the zero-trace correction. If $\chi^*$ is the harmonic extension, then

$$E(\chi^* + v) = E(\chi^*) + \|\nabla v\|^2, \qquad v \in H_0^1(\Omega), \tag{33}$$

which identifies the unique energy minimizer.

A potential-mass denominator would change this boundary-value problem. Setting $M(\chi) = \int_\Omega \chi^2$ and $R(\chi) = E(\chi)/M(\chi)$ yields the stationarity condition

$$\int_\Omega \nabla\chi \cdot \nabla v = R(\chi)\int_\Omega \chi v, \qquad v \in H_0^1(\Omega), \tag{34}$$

or $-\Delta\chi = R(\chi)\chi$, instead of the required harmonic equation. The positive-mode quotient determines an eigenvalue with free amplitude; the harmonic loss determines the minimum-energy extension of fixed, nonhomogeneous traces. Zero Hodge energy of the resulting velocity refers to its curl, while the training energy $E(\chi) = \|u_H\|^2$ is nonzero for a nontrivial circulation coordinate. The implementation averages $|\nabla\chi_\ell|^2$ over uniformly sampled interior points for each output and differentiates these per-output energies; on a fixed geometry their sum differs from Eq. (18) by the constant factor $1/|\Omega|$, where $|\Omega|$ is the domain volume. Validation additionally averages over the $h$ outputs. Subsequent mass or circulation normalization is a change of basis after learning and leaves the harmonic span unchanged.

## C.3 Conditioning the harmonic coordinates

The Dirichlet principle characterizes $\chi_\ell$ as the minimum of $\frac{1}{2}\int_\Omega |\nabla\chi|^2$ among functions with the prescribed cardinal boundary values. In the neural parameterization $L_\ell + e_{\mathbf{g}} n_{\theta,\ell}$, the lift fixes those traces before training. Rescaling its interior construction changes the optimization gradients while preserving the variational boundary-value problem. The raw/scaled comparison holds the positive modes, cardinal traces, correction envelope, initialization protocol, and epoch budget fixed, isolating the effect of harmonic coordinates at finite optimization accuracy.

### C.4 Full reduced operators and physical initialization

Following the spectral Galerkin fluid operators of De Witt et al. (2012); Liu et al. (2015), for a static geometry and basis $U$ define

$$Q_{ijk} = -\langle U_i, (U_j \cdot \nabla)U_k \rangle, \qquad M_{ij} = \langle U_i, U_j \rangle, \qquad S_{ij} = \langle dU_i^\flat, dU_j^\flat \rangle. \tag{35}$$

Equation (20) is the homogeneous unforced form. Substituting $u = u_{\text{base}} + Uc$ adds constant and linear terms, the base-flow time derivative, and projected external forcing. A full-mass initial projection minimizes $\|u_{\text{base}} + Uc - u_0\|$ using the assembled physical velocity metric.

For exact normalized positive Hodge eigenfields, $S$ is diagonal with entries $\lambda_i$, so viscosity alone gives $a_i(t) = e^{-\nu\lambda_i t} a_i(0)$. Ideal harmonic modes occupy the zero Hodge sector. The actual experiments retain assembled operators; in 3D they project the stated grid generator, including its normal penalty. The exact-mode identity gives the spectral interpretation of viscous decay; the assembled operators realize the measured dynamics.

### C.5 Invariant subspaces and the mode atlas

An eigenvalue multiplicity identifies an eigenspace whose basis can rotate. For mass-orthonormal subspace matrices $V$ and $W$, the singular values of $V^\top MW$ are cosines of their principal angles, providing a basis-independent comparison. The atlases retain each method's ordering and display normalization. Across topologies, the harmonic dimension changes with the first Betti number; this changes the physical space itself.

## D Experimental protocols and measurements

### D.1 Shared initialization, error, and timing definitions

Each autonomous trajectory begins with a full-mass projection of the prescribed initial velocity and evolves all basis coordinates. Writing $u_{\text{ref}} = u_{\text{GT}}$, reference states supply subsequent error measurements, $\|u - u_{\text{ref}}\|/\|u_{\text{ref}}\|$, on a common assessment domain. Numerical controls use the same mode count wherever reported. Training uses analytic derivatives and native CuPy; operator contraction and reduced evolution use 64-bit floating-point arithmetic (FP64) where specified; FP32 denotes 32-bit floating-point arithmetic. Timings are measured wall times with training, assembly, integration, and output reported as separate stages.

**Table 5.** Primary comparison protocols. DNS denotes direct numerical simulation. The multi-hole P1 and analytic high-capacity stages are separate discretizations.

| Case | Capacity | Reference / assessment | Autonomous horizon |
|---|---|---|---|
| Periodic | 1024 | $256^2$ DNS / $128^2$ observations | 241 frames, $T = 18\pi$ |
| Multi-hole P1 | 32 | Common circulation-aware P1 mesh | 51 frames, $T = 1$ |
| Multi-hole analytic | 1024 | Finest level-2 reference, common points | 51 frames, $T = 1$ |
| Metaball | 128–1024 | $128^3$, 1,599,754 fluid nodes | 30 frames, $T = 1.16$ |

### D.2 Periodic flow protocol

The periodic domain is $[0, 2\pi)^2$. The vortex separation is $d = 1.35$, core size $\sigma = \pi/10$, circulation $\pi/5$ per vortex, and viscosity $\nu = 0.0010742914$. The numerical reference, same-capacity Laplacian control, and

learned trajectories share 241 observation times through $T = 18\pi$. Full mass and curl-stiffness matrices and matrix-free rotational loads use $256^2$ quadrature points; errors are measured on the same uniform $128^2$ observation grid. With $k = (k_x, k_y)$ the integer Fourier wavevector, Fourier uses 512 conjugate wave pairs ordered by $(|k|^2, k_x, k_y)$, with complete sine/cosine pairs and zero constant-velocity coefficients. The learned spectral models retain frozen epoch-2000 checkpoints and analytic spatial derivatives. Initial projection uses the physical velocity alone; subsequent reference states do not enter the evolution. Figure 3 shows saved states 1, 121, and 241. Energy and enstrophy use the same initial reference normalization for all methods. All nine learned full-mass matrices have rank 1024 without ridge or mode deletion. Each frozen span is advanced at maximum steps 0.005 and 0.0025; the largest relative mass-norm trajectory difference is $4.412 \times 10^{-12}$. An independent implementation check against the inherited exponential time-differencing fourth-order Runge–Kutta (ETDRK4) equations (Cox and Matthews, 2002; Kassam and Trefethen, 2005) precedes each trajectory.

### D.3 Topology allocation and harmonic conditioning

The random large-vortex ensemble combines three to seven smooth Wendland $C^4$ vortices, where $C^k$ denotes fields with continuous derivatives through order $k$. Centers, signs, and amplitudes are random; support radii lie in $[0.65, 0.95]$. Random obstacle-boundary streamfunction constants complete each initial field. Their direction is sampled from a normalized Gaussian vector, and the energy of its harmonic lift relative to the zero-trace vortical component is drawn uniformly from $[0, 0.30]$. A common rescaling sets peak speed to 0.5. All bases project the same resulting velocity field. The low-capacity comparison uses three training seeds, 20 such initial states per geometry, and the same circulation-aware P1 NS reference for every basis. Each total-32 completed basis contains $32 - h$ positive fields and $h$ harmonic fields. The displayed fields use seed 1, state 00. The high-capacity analytic comparison retains 1024 coordinates, the same 20 states, and both time steps 0.002 and 0.001; the finest common assessment contains approximately 4.19 million points per domain.

**Table 6.** Harmonic completion for random large-vortex flows at total $K = 32$. Final relative velocity error (%) over the same 20 initial states per geometry; learned entries average three training seeds. Completed bases replace $h$ positive modes with $h$ harmonic modes. These are the low-capacity results summarized in Section 3.2.

| Holes | Potential $P$ | Potential $PH$ | Numerical $PH$ |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 53.23 | 40.04 | 39.76 |
| 2 | 52.99 | 40.49 | 40.13 |
| 3 | 54.59 | 40.49 | 39.72 |

The high-capacity raw/scaled harmonic pairs fix the positive checkpoint, seed, optimizer initialization, trace, correction envelope, Dirichlet objective, and 2000-epoch budget. For two holes, initial/final errors change from 12.709%/28.486% to 6.591%/6.692%; for three holes, from 16.069%/25.831% to 8.503%/9.066%. The single-hole raw completed basis gives 5.739% final error. Maximum final time-step differences are $7.00 \times 10^{-7}$ for single-hole raw, $3.68 \times 10^{-7}$ for two-hole scaled, and $3.40 \times 10^{-7}$ for three-hole scaled. The common level-2 reference fixes the spatial assessment for these temporal comparisons.

For basis streamfunctions $\psi_i$ with vorticities $\omega_i = -\Delta\psi_i$, velocity-basis integration uses the FP64 weak tensor $Q_{ijk} = \sum_q w_q[(\partial_x\psi_i)(\partial_y\psi_j) - (\partial_y\psi_i)(\partial_x\psi_j)]\omega_k$, assembled from all 1,048,576 quadrature points. Its $1024^3$ entries occupy 8 GiB on the RTX 4080 SUPER, alongside the coefficient states and linear operators. For the one-hole case, assembly takes 57.9 minutes including checkpoint I/O. Subsequent steps average 0.393 seconds, compared with 153.8 seconds for streamed full-field contraction of the same Galerkin operator: approximately 391× faster stepping, with assembly accounted for separately. Assembled and factored nonlinear contractions agree to $3.37 \times 10^{-14}$ relative error over the 60 initial coefficient columns.

## D.4 Direct random-streamfunction ensemble

The ensemble contains 20 fixed fields per topology, indexed 0–19. The numerical capacity study and learned/numerical $K = 32$ allocation ablation use this ensemble. The all-method $K = 1024$ dynamic comparison uses fields 0 and 1 in each topology, with six independently qualified references. Each reported comparison uses identical physical target fields across methods and completion arms.

### D.4.1 Sampling and boundary conditioning

We draw independent standard-normal scalar values on a $25 \times 25$ lattice spanning $[-1, 11] \times [-6, 6]$, with spacing 0.5, and interpolate them with an exact tensor-product quintic B-spline (de Boor, 1978). The seed hierarchy is $[20260928, \text{topology index}, \text{field index}]$, with topology indices 0, 1, and 2. The spline is $C^4$ before boundary conditioning, and the final streamfunction is at least $C^2$.

Let $s$ be the raw spline and $q_j$ a smooth nonnegative defining function for boundary component $j$. The boundary indices $i, j, k$ run from 0 to $h$. The outer component has $q_0 = 1 - ((x-5)/4)^{12} - (y/4)^{12}$; the obstacles use the original circle, rounded-square, and smoothed-triangle defining functions. For each component, $c_j$ is the arc-length-weighted mean of $s$ over 1536 boundary points. We construct bounded defining functions $\sigma_j$, partition weights $w_j$, logarithmic functions $\ell_j$, squared distance estimates $d_j^2$, and localized blending functions $b_j$. These give the boundary-adjusted field $p$, vorticity-correction weight $a$, and final streamfunction $\psi$:

$$\sigma_j = q_j / \sqrt{1 + q_j^2}, \qquad w_j = \frac{\prod_{i \neq j} \sigma_i}{\sum_k \prod_{i \neq k} \sigma_i}, \tag{36}$$

$$\ell_j = \log(1 + q_j), \qquad d_j^2 = \frac{\ell_j^2}{|\nabla \ell_j|^2 + (\ell_j/4)^2 + 10^{-30}}, \tag{37}$$

$$b_j = w_j^3 \exp\left[ - \left( d_j^2 / 0.35^2 \right)^2 \right], \qquad p = s + \sum_j b_j (c_j - s), \tag{38}$$

$$a = \tfrac{1}{2} \sum_j d_j^2 b_j, \qquad \psi = p - a \Delta p. \tag{39}$$

This construction retains a separate constant on each boundary component and enforces the original impermeability and zero-boundary-vorticity conditions. Velocity and vorticity follow from analytic derivatives, $u = (\partial_y \psi, -\partial_x \psi)$ and $\omega = -\Delta \psi$. One global scale sets the maximum sampled speed to 0.5 on the original $321 \times 321$ mask and boundary loops; this scale is fixed under all numerical refinements. The distribution, raw lattice values, boundary constants, and scales define each reproducible draw; harmonic content is measured from the resulting velocity field.

### D.4.2 Captured energy, reference coordinates, and independent samples

Assessment uses arrays of 1,048,576, 4,194,304, and 4,194,304 points. Their common all-method masks contain 1,048,092, 4,192,289, and 4,192,265 points. These are quadrature/assessment locations. The state dimensions below are counted from continuous piecewise-cubic (P3) reference finite-element spaces.

Using the common velocity assessment matrix $W$, let $M = U^\top W U$ be the mass matrix, $b = U^\top W u_0$ the initial load vector, and $n = u_0^\top W u_0$ the squared target norm. The full-mass initial projection gives

$$M c_0 = b, \qquad \eta = \frac{c_0^\top M c_0}{n} = \frac{\frac{1}{2} \|U c_0\|_W^2}{\frac{1}{2} \|u_0\|_W^2}. \tag{40}$$

Here $\eta$ is the fraction of initial kinetic energy represented by the projected field. Projection orthogonality gives $\eta = 1 - e_0^2$ for each field, where $e_0 = \|Uc_0 - u_0\|_W / \|u_0\|_W$. We compute the quadratic energy separately for every field and training seed before averaging. An overbar on scalar statistics denotes the ensemble mean. The mean is therefore $\overline{\eta} = 1 - \overline{e_0^2}$; no transformation of the ensemble-mean error is used. All coordinates are retained without a ridge term. Across the 840 saved $K = 32$ and 120 numerical $K = 1024$ projections, direct quadratic-energy and load-energy ratios agree within $1.3 \times 10^{-13}$.

The one-, two-, and three-hole P3 meshes have 881,793, 669,533, and 1,390,768 scalar nodes. Their boundary nodes number 9,216, 13,458, and 22,428. With constant streamfunction trace on each component and the outer constant fixed, writing $N_{\mathrm{P3}}$ for the scalar node count and $N_\partial$ for the boundary node count, the velocity-state dimension is

$$N_{\mathrm{ref}} = N_{\mathrm{P3}} - N_\partial + h. \tag{41}$$

Equivalently, the reference evolves interior vorticity values and $h$ circulations; streamfunction is reconstructed from that state. This gives $N_{\mathrm{ref}} = 872{,}578$, 656,077, and 1,368,343. The counts in Table 7 define the state-coordinate compression ratio $N_{\mathrm{ref}}/K$, visualized in Figure 5. The same mesh dimensions apply to both reduced capacities in each domain. Initial representation checks cover all 60 P3 fields. The six predetermined fields in Appendix D.4.5 additionally have full-trajectory refinement measurements.

**Table 7.** Initial kinetic-energy capture and reference state dimensions for 20 direct random-streamfunction fields per topology. P3 nodes count the reference mesh; $N_{\mathrm{ref}}$ counts independent interior scalar coordinates plus $h$ circulations after boundary constraints and outer-gauge fixing. $K$ is the reduced state dimension, and $\eta_P, \eta_{PH}$ are mean captured-energy percentages for numerical $P_K$ and $P_{K-h} + H_h$. Energy fractions are evaluated per field before averaging. The common assessment measure, basis discretizations, and initial reference qualification are specified in Appendix D.4.

| Holes | P3 nodes | $N_{\mathrm{ref}}$ | $K$ | $\eta_P$ (%) | $\eta_{PH}$ (%) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 881,793 | 872,578 | 32 | 2.27 | 2.13 |
| 1 | 881,793 | 872,578 | 1024 | 75.32 | 75.34 |
| 2 | 669,533 | 656,077 | 32 | 2.37 | 2.16 |
| 2 | 669,533 | 656,077 | 1024 | 79.66 | 79.73 |
| 3 | 1,390,768 | 1,368,343 | 32 | 1.79 | 1.60 |
| 3 | 1,390,768 | 1,368,343 | 1024 | 54.48 | 54.52 |

### D.4.3 Optional combined energy–compression summary

For a fixed reference discretization, captured energy and compression in Figure 5 define the energy–compression product $Q_B$. Let $E_{\mathrm{projected}}$ and $E_{\mathrm{target}}$ denote initial projected and target kinetic energies; then

$$Q_B = \eta \frac{N_{\mathrm{ref}}}{K} = \frac{E_{\mathrm{projected}}/K}{E_{\mathrm{target}}/N_{\mathrm{ref}}}. \tag{42}$$

For field $i$, $Q_{B,i} = (N_{\mathrm{ref}}/K)\eta_i$, so $\overline{Q}_B = (N_{\mathrm{ref}}/K)\overline{\eta}$. This is a derived summary of energy capture and compression. At fixed $N_{\mathrm{ref}}$ and $K$ it orders methods exactly as $\eta$ does. Its reference normalization changes under mesh refinement. We therefore report the independently interpretable energy fractions and compression ratios in the main text, and retain the combined values here for a common reference convention.

The $K = 32$ bases use their original common P1 embeddings. The numerical $K = 1024$ bases use their original level-2 P1 representations. Both are assessed against the same continuous analytic initial fields on the unchanged common masks. The capacity table compares these existing discretized representations; their basis meshes differ. All 20 fields are retained at each capacity.

**Table 8.** Derived energy–compression products for the numerical representations in Table 7. Energy fractions are evaluated per field before averaging; all 20 draws per topology are retained.

| Holes | $K$ | $\overline{Q}_{B,P}$ | $\overline{Q}_{B,PH}$ |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 32 | 618.62 | 581.29 |
| 1 | 1024 | 641.84 | 641.99 |
| 2 | 32 | 485.62 | 442.04 |
| 2 | 1024 | 510.41 | 510.82 |
| 3 | 32 | 767.13 | 685.73 |
| 3 | 1024 | 728.05 | 728.60 |

The Laplacian basis contributes one numerical realization; potential and velocity training each contribute three existing seeds at $K = 32$. For each learned method, captured-energy fractions are averaged across seeds within a field, then over the 20 independent fields. Table 9 reports mean capture and the paired gain $\Delta\eta = \eta_{PH} - \eta_P$ in percentage points. This equal-total-$K$ comparison exchanges $h$ positive coordinates for $h$ harmonic coordinates.

**Table 9.** Initial kinetic-energy capture at total $K = 32$, in percent. $\Delta\eta$ is the mean captured-energy change in percentage points. Positive values favor completion. Learned energy fractions average three seeds within each of the 20 independent fields; the last column counts fields with higher $PH$ capture.

| Holes | Basis | $\eta_P$ (%) | $\eta_{PH}$ (%) | $\Delta\eta$ | Improved |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Laplacian | 2.269 | 2.132 | -0.137 | 2/20 |
| 1 | Potential | 2.252 | 2.178 | -0.075 | 5/20 |
| 1 | Velocity | 2.269 | 2.145 | -0.124 | 2/20 |
| 2 | Laplacian | 2.369 | 2.156 | -0.213 | 3/20 |
| 2 | Potential | 2.370 | 2.174 | -0.197 | 3/20 |
| 2 | Velocity | 2.345 | 2.216 | -0.129 | 3/20 |
| 3 | Laplacian | 1.794 | 1.604 | -0.190 | 3/20 |
| 3 | Potential | 1.795 | 1.633 | -0.163 | 2/20 |
| 3 | Velocity | 2.009 | 1.814 | -0.195 | 2/20 |

**Harmonic-energy diagnostic.** The 60 directly sampled fields predominantly occupy the vortical sector. Projection onto the numerical harmonic span gives median initial energy fractions of 0.01016%, 0.06411%, and 0.04385% for one, two, and three holes, with maxima of 0.11744%, 0.17651%, and 0.27178%. Level-2/level-3 harmonic refinement changes these fractions by at most 0.00214 percentage points. At fixed $K$, mass-orthogonal sectors trade the harmonic projection energy gained against the energy of the $h$ displaced positive modes. The coordinate allocation is therefore governed by the relative occupation of these two sectors. Positive modes are ordered by spectral Rayleigh values; a field's captured energy depends on its modal coefficients. Appending $H_h$ to unchanged $P_K$ creates a nested span, whose best-projection error is nonincreasing.

### D.4.4 Autonomous trajectories for the first one- and two-hole draws

The $K = 32$ comparison uses the first fixed draw (index 0) in each of the one- and two-hole domains. Each method starts from the analytic-field full-mass projection and evolves autonomously with the reused Galerkin operators, $\nu = 1/750$, $T = 1$, and 51 saved frames. The two step sizes are 0.002 and 0.001. Subsequent reference values enter error assessment, not the coefficient evolution. Table 10 summarizes the fine-step errors.

With $\bar{e} = \int_0^1 e(t)\ \mathrm{d}t$ the time-averaged relative error, we define the improvement $\Delta(t) = e_P(t) - e_{PH}(t)$ and $\bar{\Delta} = \bar{e}_P - \bar{e}_{PH}$; positive values mean lower error after completion.

The numerical reference uses continuous cubic finite elements and the fine time step. Maximum coarse/fine relative velocity differences are $2.53042 \times 10^{-6}$ and $5.03966 \times 10^{-5}$. Full-trajectory quadratic/cubic comparisons give 0.84444% and 0.72543% differences; independent boundary-geometry refinement gives 0.02050% and 0.07681% across all 51 frames on both original masks. These checks retain the same analytic initial field. Direct-field and moment-based error evaluation agree to below $6.10 \times 10^{-16}$; the independent polynomial point-adapter check is below $3.33 \times 10^{-13}$. This table reports the two $K = 32$ dynamic cases; the complete six-field $K = 1024$ assessment is reported next.

**Table 10.** Random-field dynamics for index 0 in each of two domains. $\bar{e} = \int_0^1 e_u(t)\,\mathrm{d}t$ is evaluated by the trapezoidal rule over 51 frames. Errors are percentages and differences are percentage points. Learned entries average the three training seeds of the same physical field.

| Holes | Basis | $\bar{e}_P$ | $\bar{e}_{PH}$ | $\bar{\Delta}$ | $\Delta(T)$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Laplacian | 99.28325 | 99.29712 | -0.01387 | -0.01336 |
| 1 | Potential | 99.26077 | 99.26889 | -0.00812 | -0.00733 |
| 1 | Velocity | 99.27255 | 99.29087 | -0.01832 | -0.01817 |
| 2 | Laplacian | 98.75970 | 98.79192 | -0.03221 | -0.02997 |
| 2 | Potential | 98.79390 | 98.84504 | -0.05114 | -0.05093 |
| 2 | Velocity | 98.81309 | 98.91302 | -0.09993 | -0.10682 |

#### D.4.5 Six-field $K = 1024$ comparison

All methods use the fixed indices 0 and 1, full-rank mass projection of the analytic initial field, and all 1024 coordinates. Existing learned checkpoints, numerical operators, and NKB models are reused. Reduced trajectories were advanced as 20-field batches; this assessment selects the two predetermined fields without changing their coefficients. Coarse/fine steps are $0.002/0.001$ with 51 saved frames on $[0, 1]$ and $\nu = 1/750$. No later reference state enters autonomous integration. Initial-energy fractions use the assessment mass, which is distinct from the operator quadrature mass.

Reference refinement tests compare the same physical fields under time-step, polynomial-space, and boundary-geometry changes on both original masks. For the three-hole fields, the largest time-step differences are 0.02414% and 0.03835%; polynomial-space differences are 0.49879% and 0.92725%; geometry differences are 0.10612% and 0.17219%. The initial physical fields and evaluation masks remain fixed under all refinements. The reported relative velocity errors use the original common all-method masks; analytic-only supplementary points are reported separately where the representation is defined.

Figure 5 gives initial capture and compression, and Figure 11 shows all autonomous error curves. The paired allocation gains are reported in Table 3.

For a saved coefficient vector, let $M_{\text{assessment}} = U^\top W U$ denote the full mass matrix on assessment nodes. Its quadratic energy is $c^\top M_{\text{assessment}} c$ (twice the kinetic energy). Explicit harmonic components are reported both through their own coefficients and as the mass-orthogonal projection of the full velocity onto each method's harmonic span. Let $H$ index the harmonic coordinates, $M_{HH}$ be their mass block, and $\ell_H$ the harmonic entries of the full velocity load. The latter quadratic energy is $\ell_H^\top M_{HH}^{-1} \ell_H$, with $\ell_H = (M_{\text{assessment}} c)_H$, retaining P/H cross terms. Learned harmonic fields use their original learned representation throughout.

Supplementary boundary diagnostics use exact edge integration of the original P1 polygon velocities for numerical bases, and nested 1024/2048-point analytic-boundary evaluations for neural bases. They

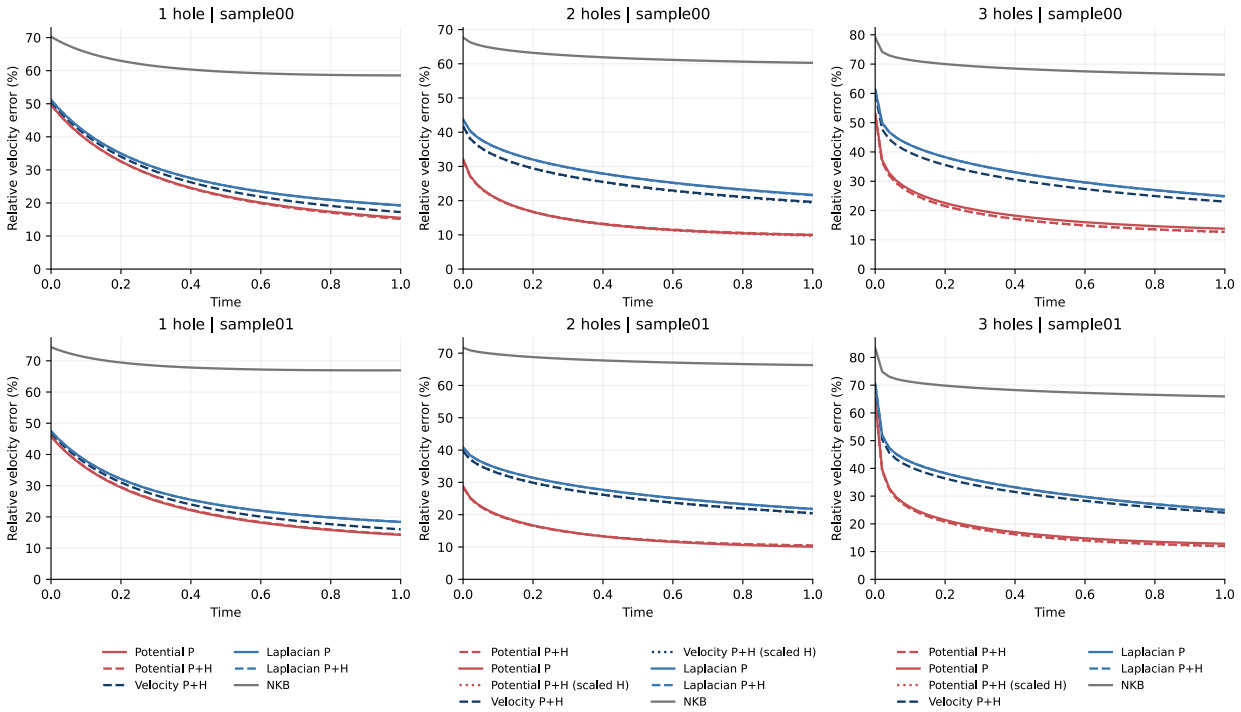


**Figure 11.** All six autonomous random-field comparisons at $K = 1024$ against qualified references. Each panel is one predetermined physical field, and every curve uses all 51 saved times and the original common mask. The numerical control has the same total coordinate count and the corresponding P or P+H allocation.

report normal speed and counterclockwise circulation around each enclosed component over all 51 frames. Curl-form neural velocities have cancelling analytic mixed derivatives; NKB divergence is evaluated from its analytic direct-velocity Jacobian at 1024 deterministic original common-mask points. These component diagnostics complement the full-domain error measurements. The released results include all per-component circulation curves, quadrature-refinement differences, and energy histories.

The timing ledger separates reference generation and qualification, cache/operator recovery, projection, batched evolution, and error assessment. Existing 20-field batch costs remain associated with those batches. Stage and process timers retain their respective workload boundaries. Supplementary boundary diagnostics required 390.59 seconds across their measured stages, independently of reference generation and final full-domain error assessment.

## D.5 Three-dimensional dynamics and error attribution

The $128^3$ reference uses rotational NS with viscosity 0.00025 and normal penalization. The reference solver uses classical RK4 advection (Butcher, 2008) with split viscosity and normal-penalty updates at step 0.0025. Reduced trial fields are zero-extended in the solid and integrated with the projected, unsplit grid generator at 0.00125 and 0.000625. Numerical fields use the mapped fitted Nédélec basis (Nédélec, 1980); learned velocities use analytic curls. All fluid nodes enter the mass matrix, projections, and error measurements. The coefficient timing study below additionally evaluates the NS reference at the matched step 0.000625.

The velocity capacity study retains 6144 training points per epoch, eight validation geometries with 4096 points each every 25 epochs, and all 2000 epochs. Training takes 5361.59 and 8622.13 seconds at $K = 128, 256$. The learned final/initial energy ratios are $0.496797, 0.505110$; numerical ratios are $0.410710, 0.396369$. Maximum relative mass-norm time-step differences are below $5.3 \times 10^{-13}$.

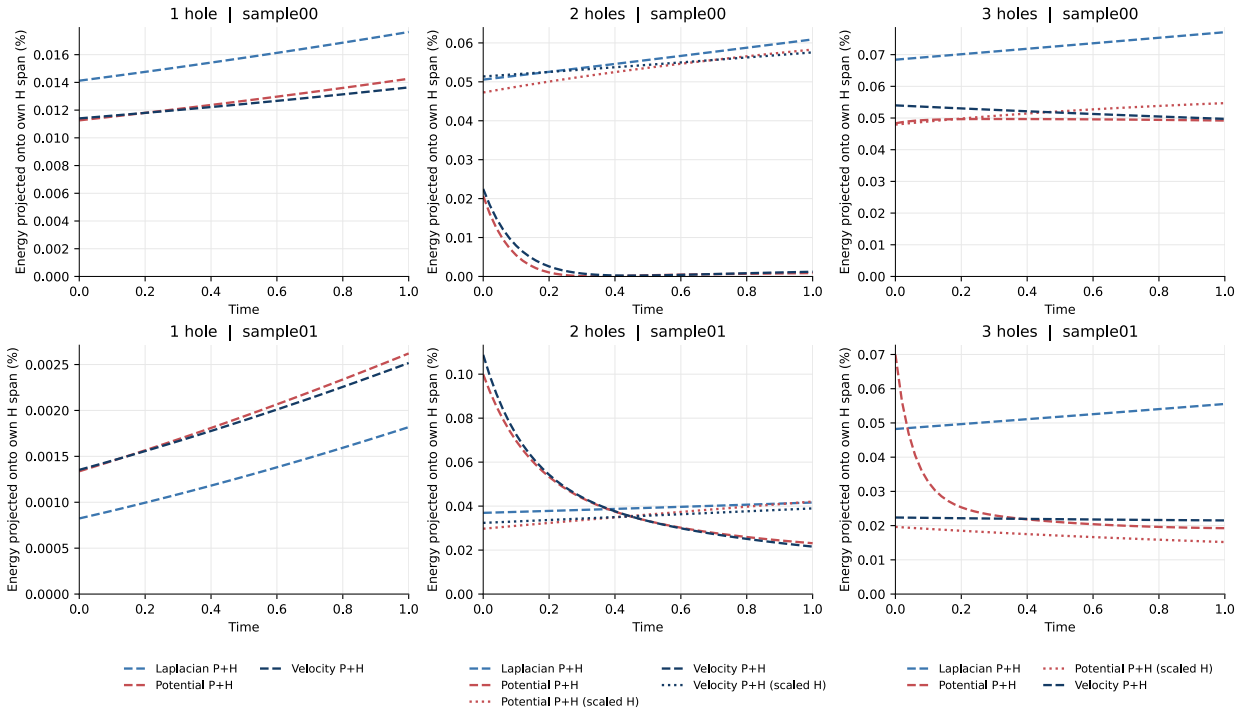


**Figure 12.** Energy projected onto each representation's explicit harmonic span as a fraction of its instantaneous total energy. The projection measures occupation of each representation's explicit circulation coordinates.

For frozen $U$, let $c_\star(t)$ minimize $\|Uc - u_{\mathrm{ref}}(t)\|$. Projection orthogonality gives

$$\frac{\|Uc(t) - u_{\mathrm{ref}}\|^2}{\|u_{\mathrm{ref}}\|^2} = \frac{\|Uc_\star - u_{\mathrm{ref}}\|^2}{\|u_{\mathrm{ref}}\|^2} + \frac{\|U(c(t) - c_\star)\|^2}{\|u_{\mathrm{ref}}\|^2}. \tag{43}$$

The representation term decreases with capacity, whereas the in-span term stays close to one half of the reference norm at $K = 512, 1024$. Its share of the total squared error consequently increases. The decomposition is evaluated after autonomous integration using the saved trajectories and common reference loads. At $K = 128, 256$, the numerical best-projection errors are $0.659617, 0.547576$ and in-span errors are $0.378547, 0.414556$, respectively. These controls show the same separation between improving the spatial span and changing its autonomous evolution.

**Table 11.** Final orthogonal error decomposition for the velocity-trained Eigenfluid spans, $T = 1.16$. Entries are relative velocity errors (%), normalized by the common full-fluid NS state. Representation and in-span terms add in square, as in Eq. (43). The $K = 512, 1024$ entries extend the decomposition using saved full-mass matrices, all 30 reference loads, and autonomous coefficients; their final total errors also agree with direct saved-field differences.

| $K$ | Best representation | In-span evolution |
|---|---|---|
| 128 | 67.0459 | 44.5447 |
| 256 | 55.5999 | 45.6442 |
| 512 | 43.9777 | 49.7599 |
| 1024 | 35.0357 | 49.6553 |

# E Three-dimensional capacity, computation, and transfer

## E.1 High-capacity initial representation and training cost

The fixed-domain velocity models at $K = 512, 1024, 2048$ each receive 2000 training epochs. Full-mass projection of the common initial numerical velocity on all 1,599,754 fluid nodes gives relative errors of 20.95%, 17.05%, 15.62%, compared with 19.65%, 17.90%, 17.27% for the same-capacity Laplacian bases. Doubling learned capacity from 1024 to 2048 reduces initial error by a further 1.43 percentage points and yields an error 1.65 points below the matched numerical control (Table 12). Figure 13 relates these representation measurements to the training cost.

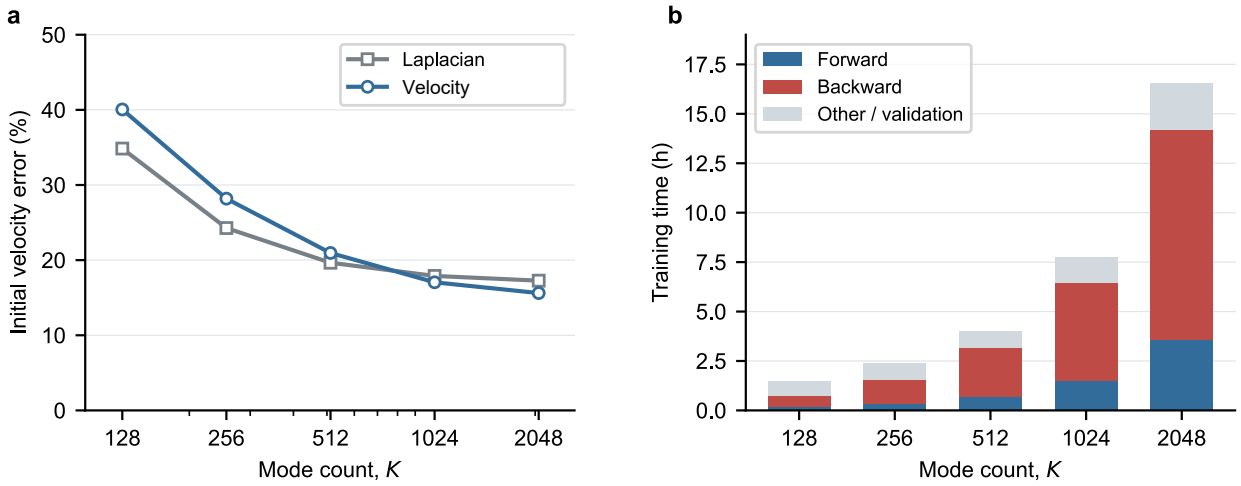


**Figure 13. Initial representation and training cost in three dimensions.** (a) Full-mass initial projection error on all fluid nodes, using every mode. Numerical Laplacian and learned velocity results both extend through $K = 2048$ and measure initial representation. (b) Wall time for 2000 epochs: forward and backward computation plus other training costs, including validation and checkpoint I/O. Total times at $K = 512, 1024, 2048$ are 3.99, 7.77, and 16.55 hours.

**Matched $K = 2048$ initial representation.** At 2048 coordinates, the learned velocity basis captures 97.561% of the initial kinetic energy, compared with 97.018% for the same-mesh Laplacian basis (Table 12). Full-mass projections of the common NS initial field retain every mode and all 1,599,754 fluid nodes. The Laplacian modes solve the consistent-mass eigenproblem with relative residuals below $10^{-6}$; the mapped mass agrees with its 1024-mode prefix to $10^{-10}$. Independent direct-field errors and quadratic projection energies agree with $\eta = 1 - e_0^2$ to $10^{-10}$.

**Table 12.** Initial velocity representation at $K = 2048$. Learned and Laplacian bases project the same NS initial field with the full mass matrix on all fluid nodes. The table gives captured energy; Figure 13 plots the corresponding initial velocity errors, and Figure 10 gives autonomous errors through $K = 1024$.

| Basis | Captured kinetic energy (%) |
|---|---|
| Laplacian | 97.018 |
| Velocity | 97.561 |
| NKB | 95.314 |

## E.2 Coefficient-only acceleration of the 3D Galerkin system

For the original $128^3$ normal-penalty generator, let $B_i$ denote a sampled learned velocity field, extended by zero outside the fluid nodes, and let $P_h$ be the original self-adjoint Leray, dealiasing, and zero-mean projector. Here $\Omega_h$ is the set of fluid grid nodes, $h = 1/128$ the Cartesian grid spacing, and $\nabla_h, \Delta_h$ the grid spectral gradient and Laplacian. The spatial weight $\chi$ and positive penalty timescale $\eta$ specify the original normal penalty along wall normal $n$. The operators in Eq. (21) are

$$M_{ij} = h^3 \sum_{x \in \Omega_h} B_i(x) \cdot B_j(x), \tag{44}$$

$$A_{ij} = \left\langle B_i, P_h \left[ \nu \Delta_h B_j - \frac{\chi}{\eta} (B_j \cdot n) n \right] \right\rangle_h, \tag{45}$$

$$Q_{ijk} = h^3 \sum_{x \in \Omega_h} (P_h B_i)(x) \cdot \left[ B_j(x) \times (\nabla_h \times B_k)(x) \right]. \tag{46}$$

The full-grid projector and derivatives act before restriction to the fluid nodes. The adjoint projector in the last line moves the output projection onto the test field, permitting blocked matrix products without changing the nonlinear operator. Input pairs are stored as $j \le k$, summing $Q_{ijk} + Q_{ikj}$ for $j < k$. This stores $K^2(K+1)/2$ FP64 entries. All 1,599,754 fluid nodes and all modes are retained; the sampled basis cache remains at its original FP32 precision, with operator construction and coefficient arithmetic in FP64.

At $K = 512$, the packed tensor occupies 0.501 GiB and remains on the GPU. Native CuPy evaluation of two production right-hand sides agrees with full-grid projection to $1.17 \times 10^{-14}$ relative error; one RK4 step differs by $4.53 \times 10^{-17}$ in relative mass norm. The complete coarse-step trajectory agrees with the full-grid Galerkin trajectory to $1.25 \times 10^{-14}$. These comparisons verify that tensor assembly preserves the selected reduced dynamics.

On an NVIDIA RTX 4080 SUPER, the 1856 RK4 steps with $\Delta t = 0.000625$ to $T = 1.16$ take 7.03 seconds. The original numerical NS solver takes 124.75 seconds for the same step size, physical interval, and initial physical field. It retains its split viscosity and normal-penalty integrator; the ROM integrates the projected unsplit generator using RK4. The measured 17.74× ratio compares online integration, including GPU synchronization. Quadratic assembly takes 3645.51 seconds offline; reconstructing and diagnosing three selected frames takes a further 20.41 seconds. Training, derived-field preparation, reference projection, and output are accounted for separately from online integration.

Halving the ROM time step changes the trajectory by at most $2.67 \times 10^{-12}$ in relative mass norm, confirming temporal convergence of the assembled dynamics. Refining the NS reference from 0.0025 to 0.000625 changes its final velocity by 2.12%. Figure 14 presents the flow error and kinetic energy alongside the measured online and preparation costs, characterizing the accuracy–cost tradeoff of coefficient-space execution.

**Capacity scaling of the assembled ROM.** Increasing velocity-basis capacity improves autonomous accuracy while increasing online integration cost (Table 13). Figure 14 shows the corresponding full-fluid error and energy trajectories. All trained coordinates are retained. Packed FP64 tensors occupy 0.501 and 4.004 GiB and remain on the GPU throughout integration. The $K = 2048$ measurement in Figure 13 evaluates initial representation.

**Operator agreement and stage costs.** At $K = 1024$, assembled and direct full-grid right-hand sides agree to $3.81 \times 10^{-14}$ relative error; the one-step RK4 discrepancy is $6.48 \times 10^{-17}$ in relative mass norm. Halving the ROM step changes the trajectory by at most $1.49 \times 10^{-11}$. Appendix I collects field preparation,

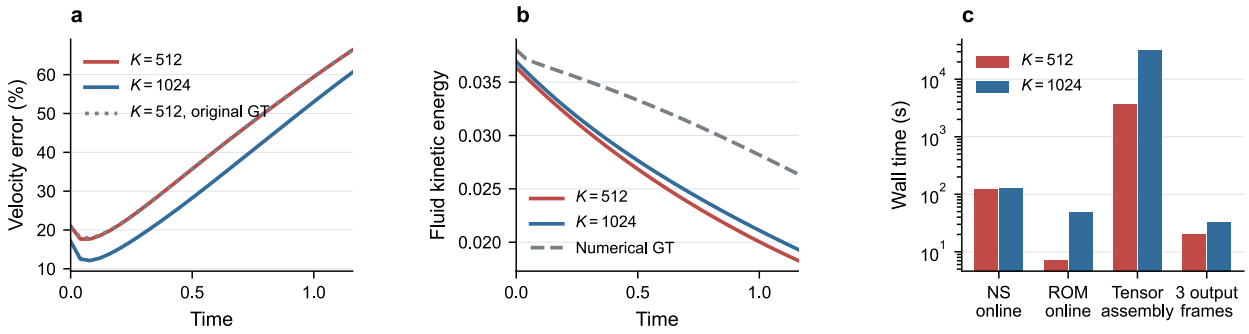


**Figure 14. Accuracy, energy, and cost of coefficient-space dynamics.** Red and blue denote $K = 512$ and 1024. (a) Autonomous velocity errors against the shared refined NS reference on all 1,599,754 fluid nodes; the dotted gray curve assesses $K = 512$ against the original reference. (b) Fluid kinetic energy. (c) Synchronized NS/ROM online integration, offline tensor assembly, and three-frame output times. Both 2000-epoch models use full-mass initial projection, all retained coordinates, and $\Delta t = 0.000625$. Time-step checks are given in the adjacent text; Table 13 reports cost ratios.

**Table 13.** Coefficient-ROM capacity scaling at $\Delta t = 0.000625$, $T = 1.16$. Figure 14 shows accuracy against the matched-step NS reference. Assembly measures the offline tensor construction, excluding training and field preparation. Synchronized online NS/ROM wall times define the speed ratio.

| $K$ | Assembly (h) | ROM (s) | NS (s) | Speedup |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 512 | 1.01 | 7.03 | 124.75 | 17.74× |
| 1024 | 9.01 | 48.59 | 126.68 | 2.61× |

tensor assembly, loading, full-grid checks, projection, and output costs alongside the NKB and Laplacian comparisons. The agreement measurements show that assembly preserves the reduced generator, connecting the online cost directly to the learned span and projected dynamics assessed above.

## E.3 Randomized-field representation across capacities

**Table 14.** Relative velocity $L^2$ reconstruction errors (%) on the same 20 independent random large-eddy fields. Entries are mean ± sample standard deviation, using all 1,599,754 fluid points and all retained modes. These are the numerical values for Figure 9. A dash denotes an unavailable measurement.

| $K$ | Potential | Velocity | Laplacian | NKB |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 32 | 65.82 ± 4.06 | 76.46 ± 4.65 | 65.92 ± 4.04 | 78.98 ± 4.30 |
| 64 | 49.27 ± 4.85 | 60.20 ± 4.36 | 49.28 ± 4.78 | 73.03 ± 3.26 |
| 128 | 34.39 ± 3.95 | 41.96 ± 5.36 | 34.59 ± 3.85 | 66.67 ± 3.81 |
| 256 | 26.11 ± 3.98 | 31.26 ± 5.96 | 26.51 ± 3.95 | 56.04 ± 2.71 |
| 512 | 23.73 ± 3.99 | 26.25 ± 5.56 | 23.91 ± 4.05 | 41.49 ± 2.13 |
| 1024 | — | 23.03 ± 4.46 | 23.00 ± 4.11 | 27.77 ± 1.82 |
| 2048 | — | 21.78 ± 4.40 | 22.58 ± 4.14 | 17.79 ± 1.07 |

## E.4 Differentiable auxiliary gauge projection

The Potential-FG configuration uses 441 effective scalar gauge directions for differentiable representative selection. A pure-gauge injection diagnostic quantifies the resolved gradient content, with 43.80% amplitude retained after projection. Scalar corrections preserve the analytic curl exactly. The solver comparison below

separately examines refinement, harmonic orthogonality, and derivative consistency using a frozen 32-network auxiliary-solver checkpoint after five updates; it is not the full-training Potential or Potential-FG capacity checkpoint.

### E.5 Potential-AL and Potential-FG controls and capacity

Potential-AL and Potential-FG are the noncanonical 3D potential controls. The Potential-AL models at $K = 32, 64, 128$ use divergence and wall constraints with an augmented-Lagrangian objective. The seed-0 $K = 256$ Potential-FG model uses finite scalar/harmonic gauge projection. Their original-field reconstruction results appear in Table 16. A separately trained, matched Potential-FG family spans $K = 32, 64, 128, 256$, with the results below.

The matched finite-gauge family completes 2000 training epochs and 80 scheduled validations at each of $K = 32, 64, 128, 256$. Every model reconstructs the same 20 independent random vortical fields with all retained modes and all 1,599,754 fluid points. At $K = 256$, the mean relative $L^2$ errors are 0.910006 for Potential-FG and 0.265110 for the same-capacity Laplacian eigenbasis. The corresponding raw-boundary-to-all-basis times are 291.39, 346.78, 451.21, and 665.15 seconds across the four capacities. These measurements include geometry preparation and streamed basis-output I/O.

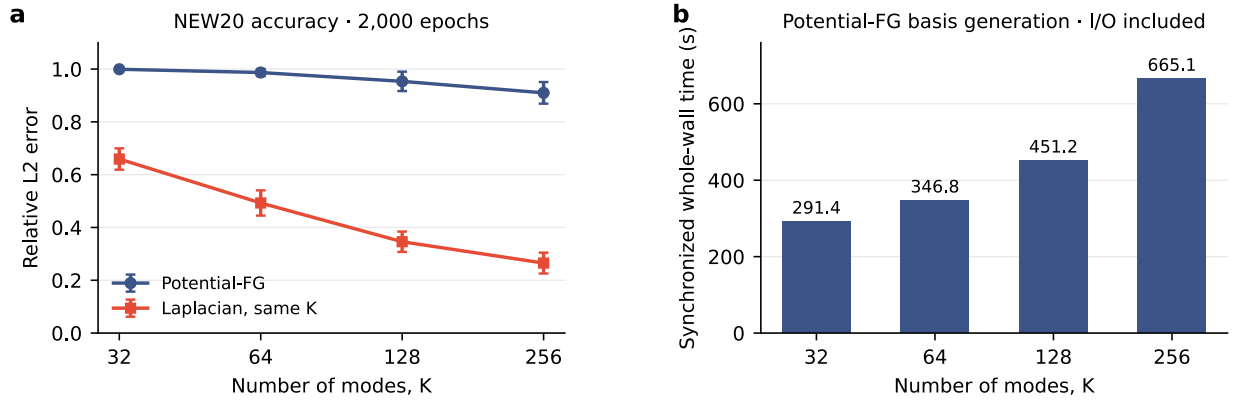


**Figure 15. Matched finite-gauge reconstruction and basis generation.** (a) Relative velocity $L^2$ reconstruction error on 20 independent random vortical fields, using Potential-FG models trained for 2000 epochs and 80 scheduled validations and the same-capacity Laplacian eigenbasis. Error bars show sample standard deviation across the 20 fields. (b) Potential-FG synchronized wall time from raw-boundary JSON parsing and FP64 geometry upload to all 1,599,754 points and all $K$ raw analytic FP64 basis values, including streamed output I/O.

**Table 15.** Matched Potential-FG reconstruction on the same 20 independent random large-eddy fields, after 2000 epochs and 80 scheduled validations. Relative velocity $L^2$ errors are reported as mean ± sample standard deviation (%); all 1,599,754 points and all $K$ modes are retained. The Laplacian entries use the same fields and capacity.

| $K$ | Matched Potential-FG | Laplacian |
|---|---|---|
| 32 | 99.928 ± 0.045 | 65.924 ± 4.039 |
| 64 | 98.690 ± 1.315 | 49.278 ± 4.782 |
| 128 | 95.348 ± 3.671 | 34.595 ± 3.852 |
| 256 | 91.001 ± 4.096 | 26.511 ± 3.946 |

**Table 16.** Initial relative velocity $L^2$ errors on the original common initial field ($n = 1$ per method and capacity), using all retained modes and all 1,599,754 fluid nodes. Potential completes 2000 epochs and 80 scheduled validations through $K = 512$. The controls use Potential-AL at $K = 32, 64, 128$ and Potential-FG at $K = 256$. The $K = 1024$ and 2048 Potential training runs complete 25 optimizer updates and one update, respectively; their completed update counts are reported separately from the full-training representation results.

| $K$ | Potential | Velocity | Laplacian | Potential-AL/FG |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 32 | 0.843112 | 0.839273 | 0.845281 | 0.917776 (AL) |
| 64 | 0.515772 | 0.622647 | 0.521114 | 0.878704 (AL) |
| 128 | 0.343194 | 0.400527 | 0.348509 | 0.869497 (AL) |
| 256 | 0.235699 | 0.281845 | 0.242727 | 0.994937 (FG) |
| 512 | 0.201610 | 0.209542 | 0.196530 | — |
| 1024 | — | 0.170499 | 0.178991 | — |
| 2048 | — | 0.156175 | 0.172679 | — |

The finite projection leaves gradient directions in the curl kernel. For the admissible analytic potential $A = \nabla[e(x)^2 \sin(2\pi f(x_1 + 2x_2 + 3x_3))]$, where $e$ is the boundary envelope, curl vanishes and $A$ is zero on the boundary. At $f = 4$, the scalar and harmonic correction leaves 99.86% of its source-point mass, despite a scalar-system residual below $5 \times 10^{-15}$. Residual gradient content can enlarge the potential quotient's denominator without adding velocity energy. On the frozen 256-mode model, replacing 441 scalar directions with a nonnested 1392-direction space changes retained potential mass by 44.91% and the mean orthogonalized quotient by a factor of 4.62, while preserving each raw curl. This measures representative sensitivity rather than auxiliary-space convergence. The measured FP32/FP64 analytic-curl discrepancy is 0.0111%. For the Potential-FG seed-0 control, these probes connect finite-gauge sensitivity to its velocity representation; they are not diagnostics of the distinct Potential-AL loss. Full-mass best projection is invariant to nonzero column scaling, so reduced curl amplitude alone does not explain the reconstruction error. Resolving gradient content is the necessary qualification for this 3D potential objective.

## E.6 Accuracy and cost of the auxiliary gauge solve

The auxiliary solve selects the potential representative entering the Rayleigh quotient. Its accuracy depends on the space used to represent the Poisson correction as well as on the precision of the linear algebra. We compare these effects on a fixed 32-network checkpoint obtained after five updates with Fourier projection and a method-of-fundamental-solutions (MFS) boundary correction. All methods use the same smooth Metaball geometry, neural parameters, analytic derivatives, and relative harmonic field, isolating representative selection from learning.

**Common assessment.** Let $A_\theta$ denote the neural vector potential, with raw column $A_j$. Its scalar divergence forcing is $f_j = \operatorname{div} A_j$, and $\phi_j$ denotes its numerical scalar correction. We define $\epsilon_P$ as the maximum relative Poisson residual over columns $j = 1, \ldots, 32$; the sums below use unit weights on independent points $x_q$. On 8192 identical independent fluid points, we report

$$\epsilon_P = \max_{j \le 32} \frac{\left(\sum_q |f_j(x_q) - \Delta\phi_j(x_q)|^2\right)^{1/2}}{\left(\sum_q |f_j(x_q)|^2\right)^{1/2}}. \tag{47}$$

The residual measures the fraction of divergence forcing left after the scalar correction, since $\operatorname{div}(A_j - \nabla\phi_j) = f_j - \Delta\phi_j$. Relative harmonic overlap is measured on a disjoint 110592-node volume rule after the column

transform, and tangential trace on 8192 independent points per wall. Columnwise diagnostics characterize gradient correction, harmonic orthogonality, and boundary trace across all 32 modes. Setup, forward, reverse, and assessment times are measured separately on an RTX 4080 SUPER using native CuPy. Forward/reverse measurements use a 4 GiB allocation pool; the R-marked synchronized setup and assessment measurements use a 12 GiB pool with the same complete workload.

**Fourier particular solution and boundary correction.** On an auxiliary box of side $L = 1.12$, an exterior continuation agrees with the original neural potential throughout the fluid. Its divergence is sampled on $193^3$ nodes. Let $k \in \mathbb{Z}^3$ be an integer wavevector ($\mathbb{Z}$ denotes integers), $\kappa_k = 2\pi k/L$ its physical frequency, $x_0$ the box origin, and $\widehat{f_k}$ the Fourier coefficients of the sampled forcing. The scalar particular solution $\phi_p$ is

$$\phi_p(x) = -\sum_{k\neq 0} \frac{\widehat{f_k}}{|\kappa_k|^2} e^{\mathrm{i}\kappa_k\cdot(x-x_0)} + \widehat{f_0}\frac{|x-(0.5,0.5,0.5)|^2}{6}. \tag{48}$$

The mean term preserves nonzero-mean forcing. The represented Laplacian is the Fourier interpolant $f_N$ with $N = 193$ nodes per axis. The independent residual $f_j - f_N$ measures the source representation at this resolution. A Laplace method-of-fundamental-solutions (MFS) correction with 6144 exterior sources and 18432 boundary collocation nodes enforces the zero Dirichlet trace in least squares (Fairweather and Karageorghis, 1998). This harmonic boundary correction complements the volume particular solution. We separately test the training arithmetic, FP64 fast Fourier transforms (FFTs) on the same FP32 samples, and an FP64 source/FFT path. A reuse control combines repeated source FFTs and accumulates spectral cotangents before the source-grid inverse FFT, keeping the represented operator unchanged.

**Smooth weak projection.** For a scalar test function $v \in H^1_0(\Omega)$, integration by parts gives the same continuous Dirichlet problem in the form

$$\int_\Omega \nabla v\cdot\nabla\phi \,\mathrm{d}x = \int_\Omega \nabla v\cdot A_\theta \,\mathrm{d}x, \qquad v\in H^1_0(\Omega). \tag{49}$$

We use $C^2$ tensor cubic B-splines (de Boor, 1978) multiplied by the original analytic zero-trace envelope. Let $b_i$ be the enveloped spline basis functions, $\zeta_i$ their coefficients in $\phi_h = \sum_i \zeta_i b_i$, $\zeta = (\zeta_i)$ their coefficient vector, $\mathsf{K}$ the gradient stiffness matrix, and $r = (r_i)$ the load vector. The discretization is

$$\mathsf{K}_{ij} = \sum_q w_q \nabla b_i(x_q)\cdot\nabla b_j(x_q), \quad r_i = \sum_q w_q \nabla b_i(x_q)\cdot A_\theta(x_q), \quad \mathsf{K}\zeta = r. \tag{50}$$

The neural right-hand side and its parameter reverse require potential values rather than divergence derivatives. Basis gradients and Laplacians are analytic, including across spline knots. Resolution-12, -20, and -24 spaces use 32768, 110592, and 262144 fitting quadrature points. Matrix-free conjugate gradients (Hestenes and Stiefel, 1952) apply the weighted gradient Gram operator; a standard two-level construction (Briggs et al., 2000) uses cubic refinement prolongation, symmetric smoothing, and a factored coarse solve. Severely cut supports are removed when their quadrature gradient-energy diagonal is at most $10^{-5}$ of the maximum. The selection and quadrature remain fixed during differentiation. The algebraic solve residual measures convergence within this space, while Eq. (47) measures the resolved neural forcing.

**Volume potential with multipole acceleration.** The alternative particular solution follows volume-potential methods (Malhotra and Biros, 2016) and uses the Newton potential of the piecewise-constant source density $f_h$ over the auxiliary box $B$, with $y$ the integration point:

$$\phi_p(x) = -\frac{1}{4\pi}\int_B \frac{f_h(y)}{|x-y|}\,\mathrm{d}y. \tag{51}$$

The volume representation uses constant cuboid densities in $B = [-0.02, 1.02]^3$, with the same interior forcing and exterior continuation. Near cuboids, including self interactions, are integrated analytically. Degree-six Cartesian multipole-to-multipole, multipole-to-local, and local-to-local translations follow the fast multipole method (FMM) (Greengard and Rokhlin, 1987) to evaluate the far field, whose local Taylor polynomials are harmonic. The same MFS correction enforces the boundary trace. A source-adaptation variant refines coarse cells when a neighboring density difference, normalized by the per-column coarse-source root mean square (RMS) and maximized over the 32 columns, exceeds 0.5. The sampling map is fixed for the adjoint, and evaluation uses a uniform tree. The fixed sampling map permits consistent differentiation through the adaptive piecewise-constant representation, following the volume-potential construction (Malhotra and Biros, 2016).

**Table 17.** Gauge-solver accuracy and cost at the fixed checkpoint. Figure 16 plots the Poisson residual $\epsilon_P$. Harmonic overlap and tangential trace are percentages; all four timing columns are seconds. Size denotes grid size or retained spline degrees of freedom. Setup and assessment are excluded from forward/reverse. Superscript R denotes a synchronized measurement of the complete workload; forward/reverse columns exclude setup and assessment.

| Method | Size | Harm. | Wall tan. | Forward | Reverse | Setup | Assess. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Fourier–MFS | $193^3$ | 0.0177 | 0.6904 | 49.07 | 138.60 | $54.57^{\mathrm{R}}$ | $23.82^{\mathrm{R}}$ |
| Fourier–MFS, reuse | $193^3$ | 0.0177 | 0.6904 | 48.28 | 136.12 | $62.86^{\mathrm{R}}$ | $23.32^{\mathrm{R}}$ |
| Spline 12 | 3,106 | 0.0181 | 0.0012 | 6.63 | 6.98 | 1.98 | 5.90 |
| Spline 20 | 10,648 | 0.0015 | 0.0012 | 15.40 | 16.60 | 4.75 | 5.91 |
| Spline 24 + two-level | 17,086 | 0.0036 | 0.0012 | 71.00 | 78.96 | 11.69 | 5.84 |
| Volume FMM 32 | $32^3$ | 0.0242 | 4.8727 | 12.15 | 13.43 | 22.99 | 61.76 |
| Volume FMM 64 | $64^3$ | 0.0261 | 3.6399 | 14.23 | 17.66 | 22.82 | 60.63 |
| Volume FMM 64 adaptive | $64^3$ | 0.0261 | 3.6399 | 14.53 | 17.96 | 23.71 | 60.51 |

Forward and reverse totals include synchronized component measurements; one-time setup and independent assessment are separate columns. Setup combines spline space/quadrature and optional multigrid construction, or the FMM and fixed harmonic moments; assessment combines independent residual, harmonic, and wall checks. Spline forward timing includes query-point construction. The Fourier and Fourier-reuse measurements share identical neural passes and include source-array export, while spline and volume methods use in-memory sources. Both particular-solution families reuse the geometry-dependent MFS factors.

**Table 18.** Floating-point precision on the same $193^3$ grid. The first two rows use identical source samples. Source time measures one all-32 forward pass, including export.

| Arithmetic | $\epsilon_P$ (%) | Source forward (s) |
|---|---|---|
| Training arithmetic | 7.989593 | 37.24 |
| FP32 source, FP64 FFT | 7.989595 | 37.24 |
| FP64 source and FFT | 7.989582 | 266.41 |

**Representation and arithmetic.** The precision controls yield nearly identical forcing residuals (Table 18). With identical source samples, changing FFT precision produces a relative Laplacian difference of $4.20 \times 10^{-7}$. Source-space resolution therefore provides the effective control over representative selection at this checkpoint.

Transform reuse preserves forward outputs to the reported precision and changes the source cotangent by a relative $2.50 \times 10^{-12}$. It reduces the three-evaluation Fourier stage from 9.91 to 8.99 seconds and the source-grid transpose from 12.96 to 10.48 seconds. Total component time decreases from 187.67 to 184.40 seconds (1.74%); neural source evaluation and parameter differentiation account for 85.5% of the original total.

**Auxiliary-space resolution.** Refinement systematically improves the spline and volume corrections (Figure 16), while the harmonic projection maintains small overlap across the solver family (Table 17). These complementary diagnostics identify two controls for representative selection: the approximation space resolves gradient content, and the mass projection selects harmonic coordinates. Source adaptation refines 31,432 of 32,768 coarse cells (95.9%), with 284,224 source evaluations including the coarse pass, compared with 262,144 for the uniform rule. This distribution favors uniform refinement for the present forcing.

**Operator consistency.** FMM evaluation and transpose consistency are tested using $16^3$ cuboids, 48 query points, and two random right-hand sides. The analytic cuboid kernel agrees with nonsingular Gauss integration to relative $7.30 \times 10^{-11}$. Against direct cuboid integration, increasing the far expansion degree from four to six reduces relative gradient error from $1.38 \times 10^{-3}$ to $1.90 \times 10^{-4}$; the degree-six transpose discrepancy is $2.73 \times 10^{-16}$. These comparisons isolate evaluation of the chosen density from density approximation. For the manufactured scalar $e(x)[1 + 0.2\sin(2\pi x_1) + 0.1x_2x_3]$, the refined spline method gives relative gradient and Poisson errors of $2.85 \times 10^{-4}$ and $8.82 \times 10^{-4}$, with linear residual $4.95 \times 10^{-9}$. Together with Figure 16 and Table 17, these checks connect accurate operator evaluation to systematic control through auxiliary-space refinement.

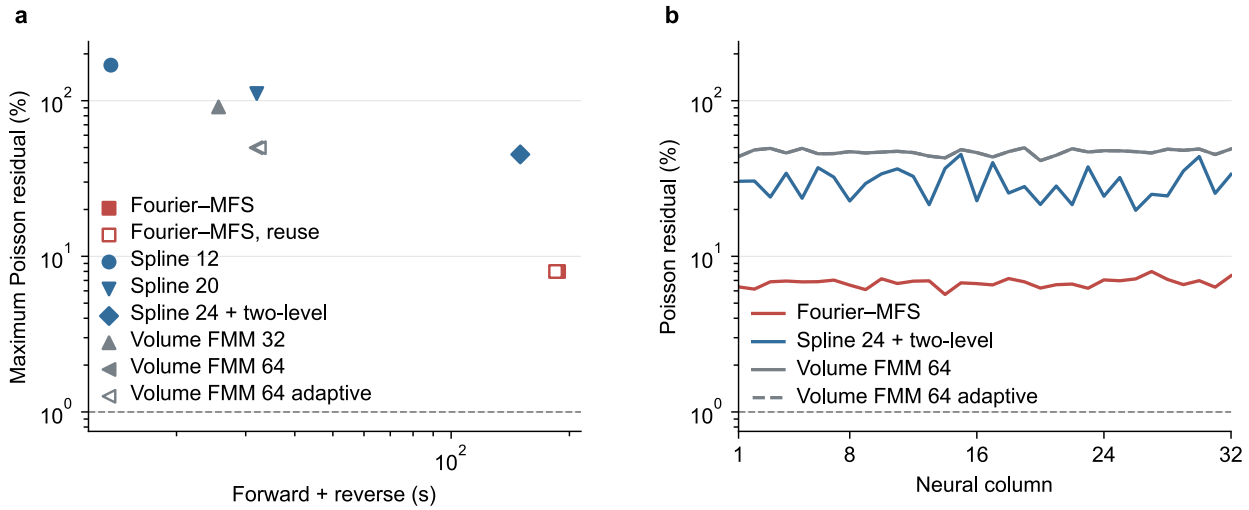


**Figure 16. Gauge-solver accuracy and cost.** Left: all-32 forward-plus-reverse time versus independent Poisson residual. Right: per-column residuals for Fourier–MFS and the finest tested spline and volume spaces. All methods evaluate the same fixed neural checkpoint.

**Connection to the velocity span.** At a fixed network, each scalar correction has zero curl, so all solvers retain the same 32-dimensional analytic velocity span. The solver comparison therefore measures representative selection for the potential objective; changes to the learned velocity span arise through subsequent optimization.

## E.7 Training and boundary-to-basis costs

Initial-field evaluation is separate from training and basis generation: Potential takes 655.76 seconds at $K = 256$ and 1182.42 seconds at $K = 512$. At $K = 512$, the saved-basis assessment of 20 independent random fields takes 123.32 seconds. High-capacity Potential training completes 25 updates at $K = 1024$ and one update at $K = 2048$, with zero scheduled validations, the original 2000-epoch learning-rate horizon, and full model/Adam endpoint checkpoints.

**Table 19.** Three-dimensional training and basis-generation costs in seconds. Normal training includes the scheduled validation and checkpoint I/O of each run; state recovery is separate. The reported full training runs complete 2000 epochs. Basis generation measures one synchronized interval from the original parameterized boundary to all 1,599,754 points and all $K$ basis fields, including required streamed-output I/O. The Laplacian interval also includes interstage waits, setup, paging, and background load. Runtime/model loading, coefficient synthesis, projection, and diagnostics have separate boundaries. A dash denotes an unavailable measurement under the stated run and timing boundary; Laplacian has no training or recovery stage. Completed short high-capacity Potential runs are reported in Table 20. † denotes an inclusive training-time counter. Matched Potential-FG rows complete 2000 epochs and 80 validations; their reconstruction and basis-generation results also appear in Figure 15.

| $K$ | Method | Normal training | State recovery | Boundary to all basis |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 32 | Laplacian | — | — | 3467.56 |
| 32 | Velocity | 3042.38 | 0.00 | 267.91 |
| 32 | Potential | 8170.08 | 200.31 | 255.50 |
| 32 | Potential-AL | 6316.24 | 0.00 | 259.52 |
| 32 | Potential-FG (matched) | 7332.09 | 0.00 | 291.39 |
| 64 | Laplacian | — | — | 2545.51 |
| 64 | Velocity | 3930.13 | — | 307.32 |
| 64 | Potential | 14404.07 | 0.00 | 269.28 |
| 64 | Potential-AL | 10513.53 | — | 273.65 |
| 64 | Potential-FG (matched) | 11924.79 | 0.00 | 346.78 |
| 128 | Laplacian | — | — | 3576.89 |
| 128 | Velocity | 5361.59 | — | 295.34 |
| 128 | Potential | 26569.77 | 0.00 | 281.03 |
| 128 | Potential-AL | 18887.93 | 4036.51 | 281.98 |
| 128 | Potential-FG (matched) | 20862.81 | 0.00 | 451.21 |
| 256 | Laplacian | — | — | 5548.86 |
| 256 | Velocity | 8622.13 | — | 310.61 |
| 256 | Potential | 59879.95 | 717.31 | 291.56 |
| 256 | Potential-FG (seed 0) | 23238.19† | — | 469.61 |
| 256 | Potential-FG (matched) | 39108.35 | 0.00 | 665.15 |
| 512 | Laplacian | — | — | 9246.67 |
| 512 | Velocity | 14366.09 | — | 488.29 |
| 512 | Potential | 504713.77 | 106.03 | 348.12 |
| 512 | Potential-AL/FG | — | — | — |
| 1024 | Laplacian | — | — | 22049.01 |
| 1024 | Velocity | 27976.58 | — | 747.68 |
| 1024 | Potential | — | — | — |
| 1024 | Potential-AL/FG | — | — | — |
| 2048 | Laplacian | — | — | 40075.66 |
| 2048 | Velocity | 59575.55 | — | 1379.85 |
| 2048 | Potential | — | — | — |
| 2048 | Potential-AL/FG | — | — | — |

At $K = 1024$, Laplacian construction from raw geometry (marching-cubes resolution 80, mesh size 0.025) through the full spectrum and coefficient archive takes 18769.83 seconds. The sampled-basis stage takes 477.10 seconds and writes all $1{,}599{,}754 \times 3 \times 1024$ FP64 values (39,315,554,304 payload bytes). The raw-geometry-to-output interval is 22049.01 seconds, including interstage waits, setup, paging, I/O, and background load. CPU construction uses one BLAS thread, a 7 GiB resident limit, and an 8 GiB resident-peak guard; GPU basis output reuses the completed analytic geometry prefix.

At $K = 2048$, CPU coefficient construction takes 37927.17 seconds. The uninterrupted solve uses one BLAS thread and a 32 GiB peak-memory budget; the reported interval retains the time under its initial 7 GiB resident limit.

## E.8 Training geometry and frequency

The full 2000-epoch Potential and three-dimensional velocity runs use the original sampling and optimization computations: 6144 query points and eight 4096-point validation geometries every 25 epochs (80 scheduled

**Table 20.** High-capacity Potential training runtime with update budgets of 25 at $K = 1024$ and one at $K = 2048$. Elapsed time covers the first native training-worker start through atomic publication of the full model and Adam state, including repairs, recovery, waits, failed attempts and output I/O. Both runs use zero scheduled validations and a learning-rate schedule defined over 2000 epochs.

| $K$ | Completed optimizer updates | Elapsed runtime (s) |
|---|---|---|
| 1024 | 25 | 13267.46 |
| 2048 | 1 | 69257.03 |

validations). The high-capacity Potential training runs at $K = 1024, 2048$ retain the original sampling and learning-rate horizon and complete 25 optimizer updates and one update, respectively, with zero scheduled validations. Potential retains the established canonical objective and two-pass causal Gram–Schmidt; its canonical physical actions use FP64, while ANN parameters and analytic derivatives use FP32. The three-dimensional velocity capacity family uses a fixed training domain, first-layer frequency 40, and cosine learning-rate endpoints scaled by 0.1 relative to the original velocity configuration. Its reported checkpoints complete 2000 epochs with the original sampling and scheduled validation. The Potential-AL models at $K = 32, 64, 128$ use seed 20260823, frequencies 40/36, and cosine learning-rate endpoints $2.8 \times 10^{-5}$ and $10^{-7}$. The Potential-FG $K = 256$ model instead uses seed 0, frequencies 160/36, and endpoints $2.8 \times 10^{-4}$ and $10^{-6}$; it is not a matched cross-method control. Geometry-conditioned evaluation on other domains is reported separately below.

## E.9 Capacity and unseen-geometry reconstruction

**Table 21.** Held-out velocity reconstruction on disjoint 16,384-point assessment sets. Fixed-domain learned checkpoints complete 2000 epochs. Numerical bases use the same capacity, fit and assessment point sets, and target fields. Geometries 2 and 3 use radial Piola transport; geometry 4 uses a globally qualified quadratic approximation of its original smooth boundary and consistent physical finite-element matrices.

| $K$ | Geometry | Learned | Numerical |
|---|---|---|---|
| 128 | Training geometry, independent points | .398468 | .346917 |
| 256 | Training geometry, independent points | .281388 | .241861 |
| 256 | Unseen geometry 2 | .751690 | .222570 |
| 256 | Unseen geometry 3 | .744673 | .254720 |
| 256 | Unseen geometry 4 | .770144 | .230048 |

The geometry-2 numerical basis uses a fitted mesh with 80,890 vertices and 354,108 tetrahedra, the relative-potential finite-element method (FEM) with consistent mass, and radial Piola transport onto the smooth target domain. Geometry 3 uses the same construction on its own fitted mesh. Each reconstruction uses all 256 positive modes and the identical 16,384 fit points, disjoint assessment points, and target velocities. Solution and reconstruction take 687.17 and 1061.51 seconds for geometries 2 and 3, after mesh and point-map preparation. Geometry 4 retains all 320,815 tetrahedra and uses a quadratic physical Nédélec chart: positive cell determinants, the entire 95,296-face boundary homotopy, and the boundary degree qualify its global map. This chart approximates the original smooth geometry. Its consistent stiffness/mass eigensolve obtains 264 Ritz vectors with maximum relative residual $5.04 \times 10^{-11}$; the reconstruction retains 256 positive modes. Assembly, solve, and evaluation total 1054.85 seconds. The disjoint error is .230048, while the fit-point error is .227943. All three learned transfer measurements use the unchanged frozen checkpoint.

# F Additional paired flow visualizations

## F.1 Random large-vortex ablations and matched flow views

These figures report the random large-vortex ensemble used for the $K = 1024$ lift-conditioning comparisons in Section 3.2. The direct random-streamfunction ensemble is reported separately in Appendix D.4.

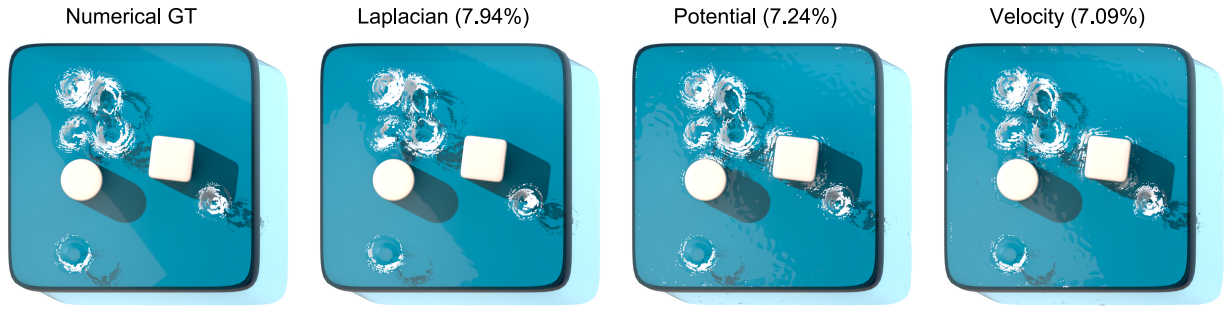


**Figure 17. Random large-vortex flow around two holes with a shared harmonic lift.** Numerical reference, Laplacian, potential-trained, and velocity-trained trajectories at $K = 1024$, $t = 1$, seed 1, state 00. Both learned bases use scaled $H_2$. Shared height and contour mappings preserve amplitude differences; annotations give full-domain velocity error.

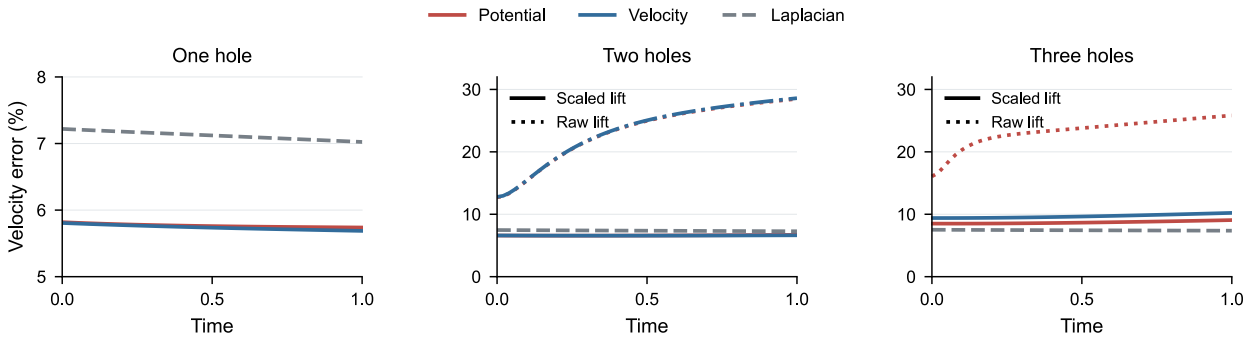


**Figure 18. Harmonic completion, lift conditioning, and objective choice.** One-, two-, and three-hole trajectories use total-1024 bases and average the same 20 random large-vortex states. Red/blue denote potential/velocity learning, dashed gray numerical completion, dotted red raw lifts, and dash-dot blue the raw-$H_2$ velocity control. Matched learned bases share raw $H_1$, scaled $H_2$, and scaled $H_3$. Curve endpoints give the final-error comparison; positive-basis training costs appear in Table 25.

## F.2 Periodic matched-basis comparison

**Periodic vortex-merger relief.** Figure 3 uses saved potential-trained $K = 1024$, seed-0 states at $t = 0, 9\pi, 18\pi$ from the $d = 1.35$ trajectory. On the periodic $384^2$ display grid, $S$ smooths $|\omega|$ with Gaussian standard deviation 4.5 pixels; all three times use the fixed original scale $q = 0.7395528286634208$ and the common display height $h = 0.20 - 1.40[\mathrm{clip}(S|\omega|/q, 0, 1)]^{0.70}$. Here $\mathrm{clip}(v, a, b)$ clamps $v$ to $[a, b]$. One subdivision smooths the display mesh. At the middle time, white foam follows 12 signed-smoothed vorticity contour levels, normalized by the same fixed $q$, from 0.065 to 0.69; this exposes the elongated S-shaped merger filaments and pointed outer lobes. At the initial and final times, continuous spiral material accents are anchored to measured vortex cores and cover both deep and shallow relief. These material cues emphasize vortex structure on the data-derived height surface. The oblique camera, lighting, transparent water material, and white ground are shared. Saved velocity, vorticity, and ROM coefficients are unchanged.

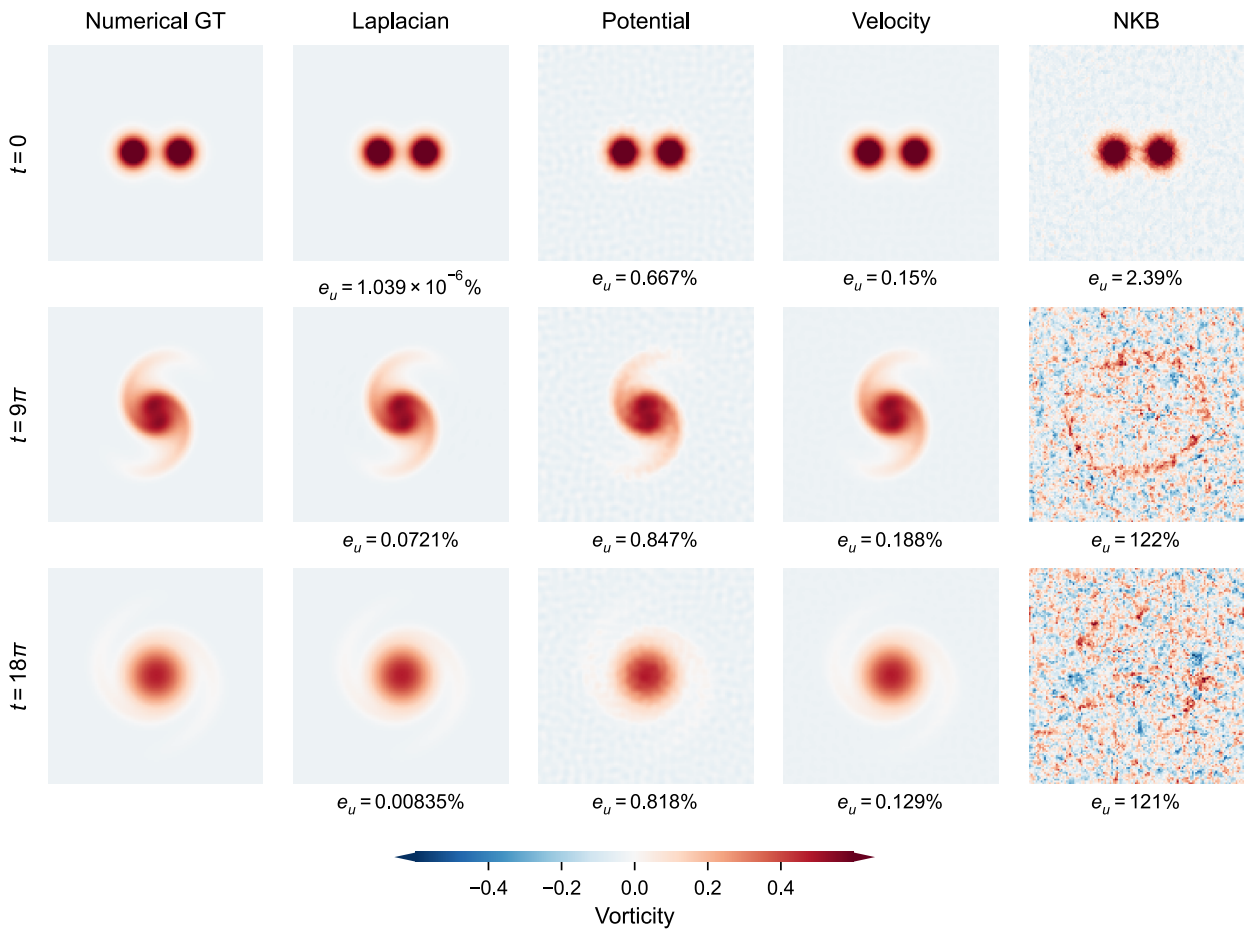


**Figure 19. Vortex merger at $K = 1024$.** Columns compare Numerical GT, Laplacian, potential-trained, velocity-trained, and NKB bases; rows show $t = 0, 9\pi, 18\pi$. Learned fields use seed 0 and maximum step 0.005. Signed vorticity uses the common GT 99.5th-percentile scale; colorbar extensions indicate saturation. Annotations report velocity error over the full $128^2$ observation grid. All methods use the same $d = 1.35$ initial velocity and evolve autonomously.

## F.3 Three-dimensional flow comparison

Figure 20 compares instantaneous velocity streamtubes for the numerical reference, Laplacian basis, and velocity-trained Eigenfluid basis. Shared camera, seeding, material, and speed mapping expose the three-dimensional flow structure behind the common-slice comparison in Figure 8.

## F.4 Three-hole $K = 1024$ time sequence

Figure 21 follows the refined reference and all three completed bases through three saved times. One display mapping across methods and times preserves temporal changes in the surface relief.

**Water-surface display mapping.** The $K = 1024$ renderings in Figures 6, 17, and 21 embed the saved two-dimensional fields in a height surface. Analytic derivatives of the learned fields are evaluated from the original checkpoints and contracted with the saved coefficients. The refined GT vorticity is recovered from its stored streamfunction using the original interior finite-element mass–stiffness relation. On a $481 \times 481$ display grid, let $S$ be a masked Gaussian smoother with standard deviation 8 pixels. Let $Q_p[f]$ be the pooled

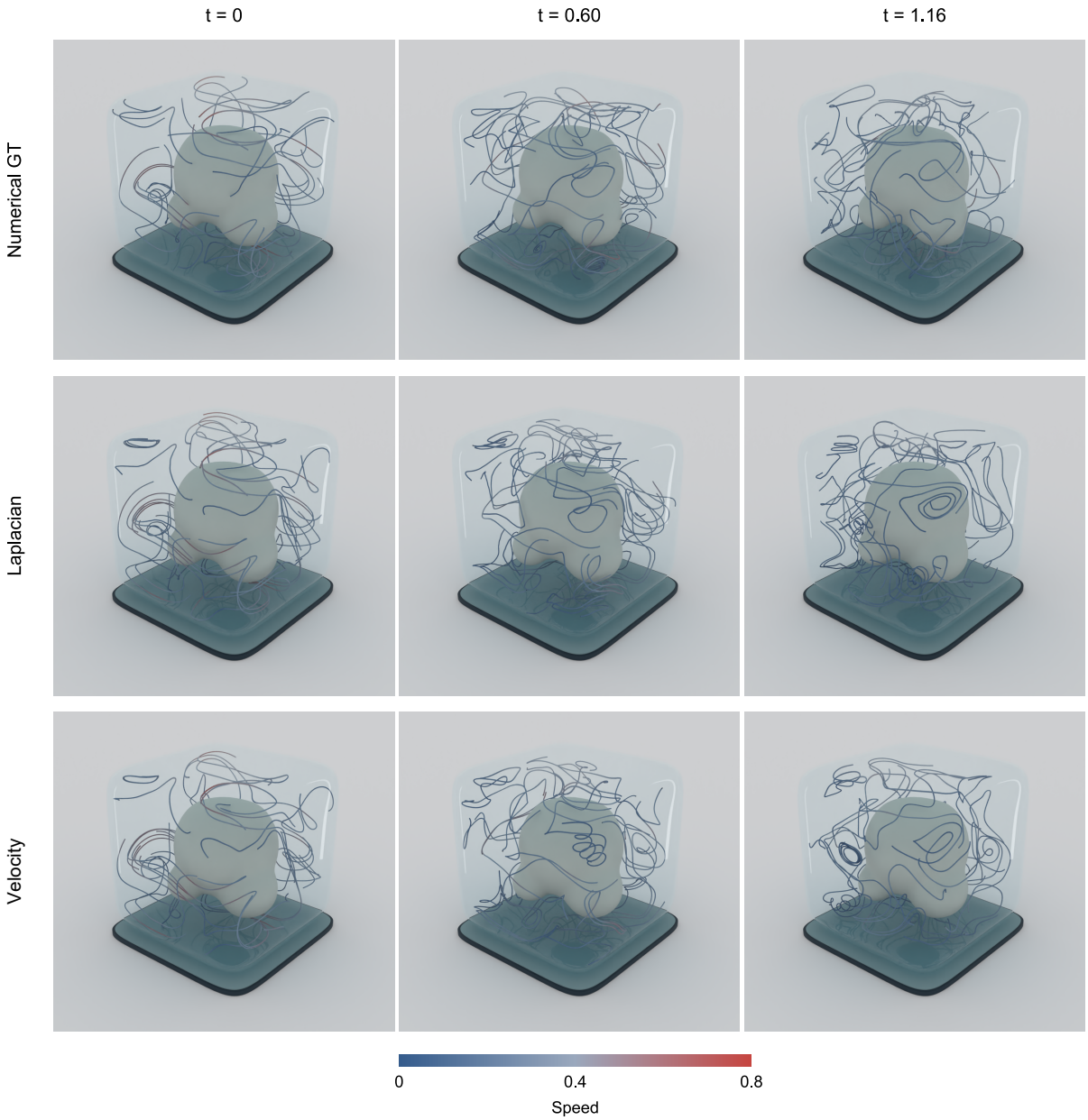


**Figure 20. Three-dimensional flow structure.** Numerical GT, Laplacian, and velocity-trained Eigenfluid $K = 1024$ streamtubes at $t = 0, 0.60, 1.16$, colored by speed. The transparent shell follows the rounded domain boundary. Camera, seeding, material, and the $[0, 0.8]$ speed range are shared. Centerline smoothing is a display operation.

empirical quantile of field $f$ at probability $p$, $q$ a combined vorticity–speed display signal, and $z_{\text{disp}}$ the display height. Define

$$q = 0.8\,\frac{|S(\omega)|}{Q_{0.90}[|S(\omega)|]} + 0.2\,\frac{S(\|u\|^2)}{Q_{0.90}[S(\|u\|^2)]},$$
$$z_{\text{disp}} = 0.30 - 0.75\ \text{clip}\left(\frac{q - Q_{0.02}[q]}{Q_{0.98}[q] - Q_{0.02}[q]}, 0, 1\right).$$

Quantiles pool all four methods and all three times within each geometry; the main views and time sequence reuse that common mapping. Filtering signed vorticity before taking its magnitude emphasizes coherent

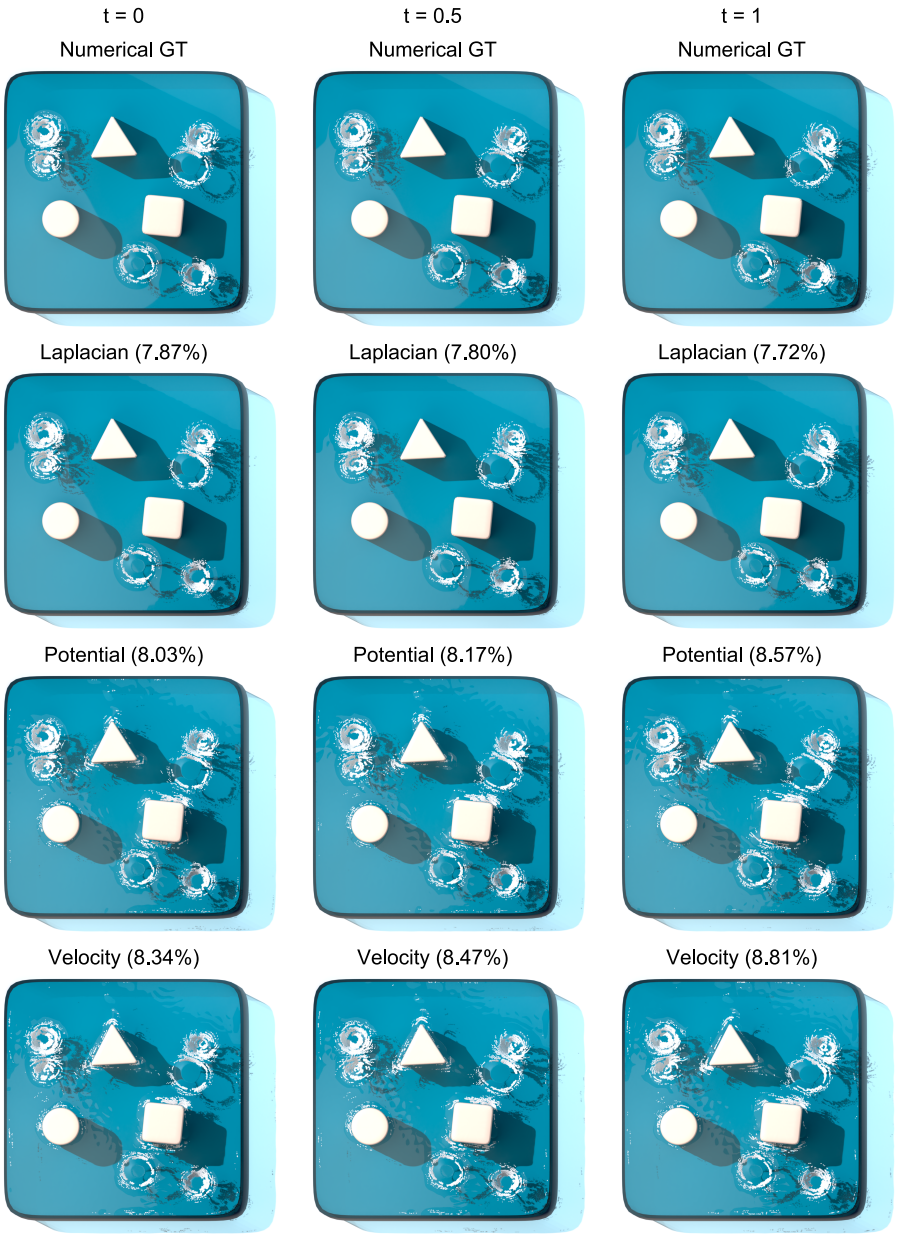


**Figure 21. Three-hole evolution at $K = 1024$.** Rows compare Numerical GT, Laplacian, potential-trained, and velocity-trained bases; columns show $t = 0, 0.5, 1$, seed 1, state 00. Each basis contains 1021 positive and three harmonic coordinates; the learned bases share scaled $H_3$. All panels share the height mapping, contour levels, camera, and material. Annotations give full-domain velocity error against the level-2 reference.

large-scale structure. The speed term also reveals curl-free harmonic circulation. Height is a display coordinate; the saved physical fields and ROM coordinates remain unchanged. White foam follows shared streamfunction contour levels after subtracting each field's nodal mean on the reference mesh; this contour convention differs from the area-weighted centering of the planar scalar plots. The obstacle footprints come from the stored reference-level-2 mesh. Camera and water material are fixed within each plate. Figures 6, 17, and 21 use matched orthographic overhead views with a white ground and one subdivision of the display surface. Its foam particles follow the saved contours, with density weighted by $|S\omega|$; within each geometry, all four methods use the same absolute density thresholds taken from the potential-trained $t = 1$ field (58th

and 95th percentiles), particle-size rule, and random seeds. Foam provides a common material cue for the displayed flow structure.

### F.5 Planar $K = 1024$ four-way comparisons

The $K = 1024$ field plates compare Laplacian, potential-trained, and velocity-trained trajectories against the same numerical reference. The two learned objectives share their harmonic fields within each geometry. Figures 18 and 27 compare final velocity errors averaged over 20 initial states; the plates show state 00 at three times and annotate its individual errors. Learned vorticity uses analytic derivatives, and numerical vorticity uses the interior finite-element mass–stiffness relation. The signed planar fields are displayed without smoothing.

**Training cost.** Table 25 compares the completed positive-basis training costs alongside NKB. Appendix I separates shared harmonic scope, offline preparation, process-stage receipts, and synchronized online timings.

## G First eight modes: a basis atlas

The periodic and three-dimensional atlases complement the multiply connected comparison in Figure 7. Rows identify the construction and columns show its first eight displayed modes, with ordering and representation specified in each caption. Signs and orthogonal rotations within repeated eigenspaces preserve the represented span. Mean-zero scalar displays and per-mode amplitude normalization expose spatial structure while leaving the ROM coordinates unchanged.

## H Neural kinematic basis comparison

We compare the learned spectral spans with a direct-velocity neural kinematic basis (NKB), following the camera-ready formulation of Liu et al. (2025). Each NKB model is trained independently at the reported capacity on the original case geometry. Its initial coefficients are obtained from the same physical initial velocity through a full-mass least-squares projection. The trajectory comparisons evolve all coordinates autonomously; subsequent reference snapshots are used only for assessment. The $K = 2048$ 3D measurement assesses initial spatial representation separately.

**Architecture and optimization.** Our native-CuPy reimplementation uses seven hidden layers of width 256 with LeakyReLU slope 0.01, followed by an exponential linear unit (ELU) velocity output; LeakyReLU is the leaky rectified linear unit. It optimizes the six NKB penalties with weights 0.01, 5, 100, 30, 100, and 100 for spatial variation, divergence, orthogonality, boundary alignment, mean length, and small length, respectively. The target mean basis length is 0.37, and the small-length threshold is 0.05. We realize the orthogonality penalty as the mean squared off-diagonal entry of the global velocity Gram matrix, a nonnegative implementation of the paper's printed signed sum. Spatial Jacobians and their parameter adjoints are evaluated analytically. The periodic model uses sine/cosine coordinates; bounded domains retain their original implicit surfaces and use a soft boundary band of width 0.05 times the domain side length. Direct velocity outputs use the stated soft kinematic penalties; Eigenfluid uses differential lifts, spectral objectives, and explicit harmonic coordinates.

Each model receives 2000 Adam updates (Kingma and Ba, 2015), using 4096 points per update in 2D and 6144 in 3D. The learning rate is $5 \times 10^{-4}\, 0.96^{10(s-1)/2000}$ at update $s$, mapping the original ten-epoch

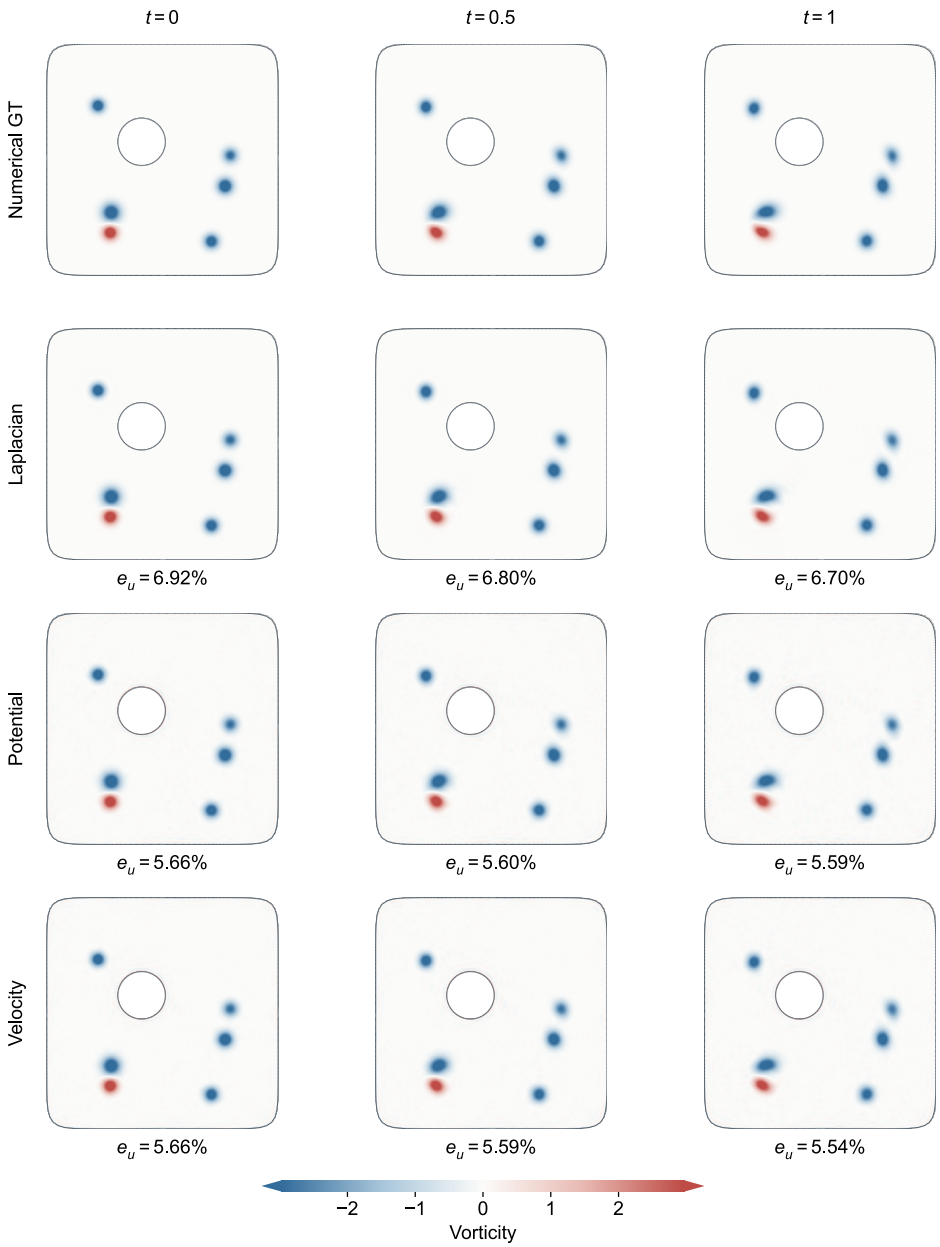


**Figure 22. 1-hole planar evolution at $K = 1024$.** Rows compare Numerical GT, Laplacian, potential-trained, and velocity-trained bases; columns show $t = 0, 0.5, 1$. Unsmoothed signed vorticity shares a symmetric scale, with colorbar extensions indicating saturation. Annotations give full-domain velocity error for seed 1, state 00 against the common level-2 reference.

decay over this fixed-case budget. Validation uses 4096 points every 25 updates, including the eight original validation geometries in 3D. The common 2000-update protocol compares fixed-case spatial bases, with autonomous assessment at the trajectory capacities. The original NKB geometry-collection experiment uses one million updates; here its shared network architecture and penalties are trained independently for each reported case.

**Common evolution and assessment.** We use the full velocity mass and all output modes, without mode truncation or ridge regularization. The 3D comparison projects the unchanged $128^3$ NS generator, including

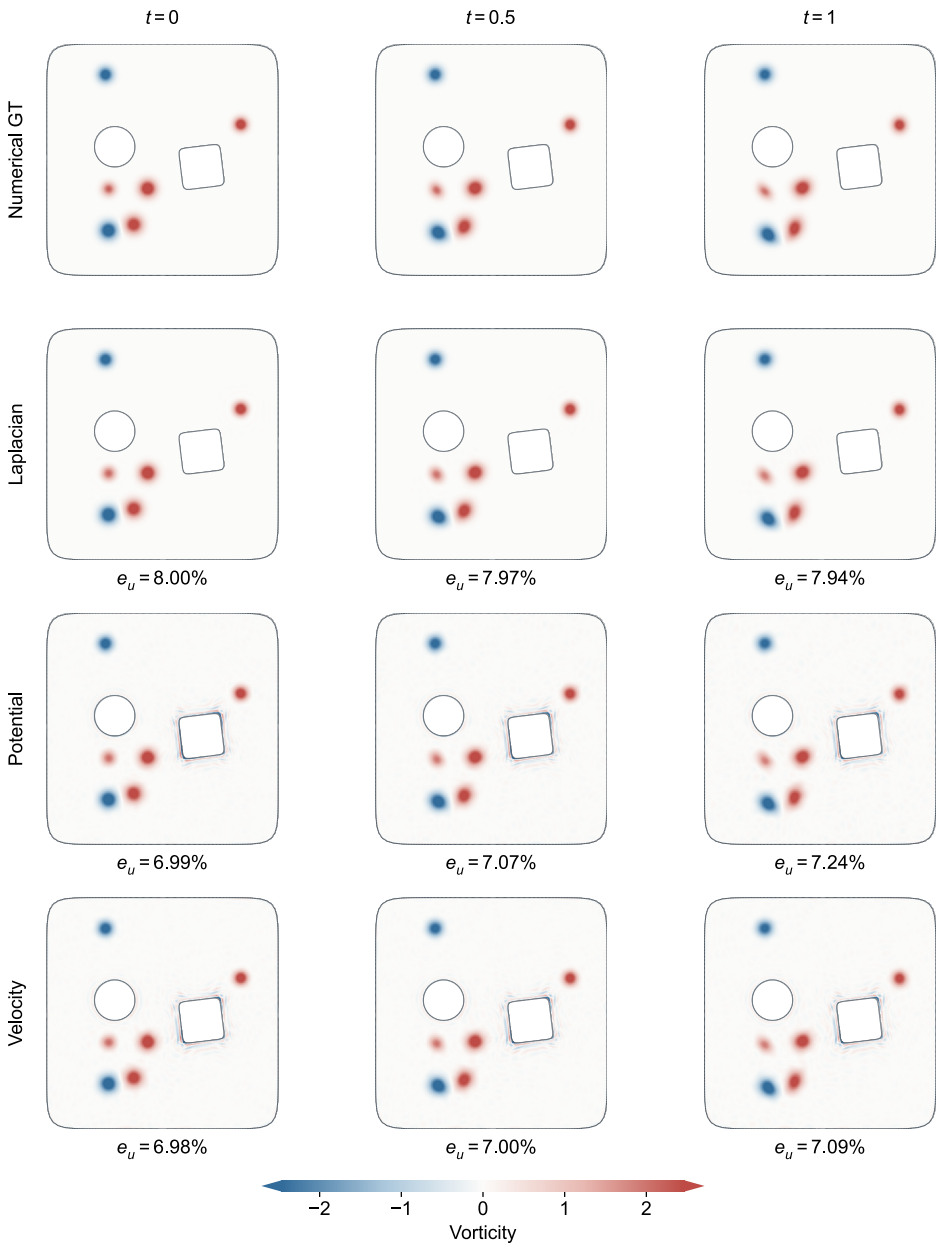


**Figure 23. 2-hole planar evolution at $K = 1024$.** Rows compare Numerical GT, Laplacian, potential-trained, and velocity-trained bases; columns show $t = 0, 0.5, 1$. Unsmoothed signed vorticity shares a symmetric scale, with colorbar extensions indicating saturation. Annotations give full-domain velocity error for seed 1, state 00 against the common level-2 reference.

its Leray projection and normal penalty, onto the NKB span. The periodic and multi-hole comparisons use the same algebraic curl-form operators and integration schemes as the spectral-basis experiments. NKB controls incompressibility and boundary tangency through its penalties. The common Galerkin assessment measures how this spatial representation supports the same reduced evolution used for the spectral bases. The original NKB solver couples its basis to semi-Lagrangian advection and reprojection.

Periodic errors use the common $128^2$ observation grid and all 241 frames through $T = 18\pi$, with vortex separation $d = 1.35$. NKB operator quadrature uses $256^2$ points. The multi-hole assessment uses all original common-domain points, the level-2 reference, 20 initial states, and 51 frames to $T = 1$. The 3D assessment

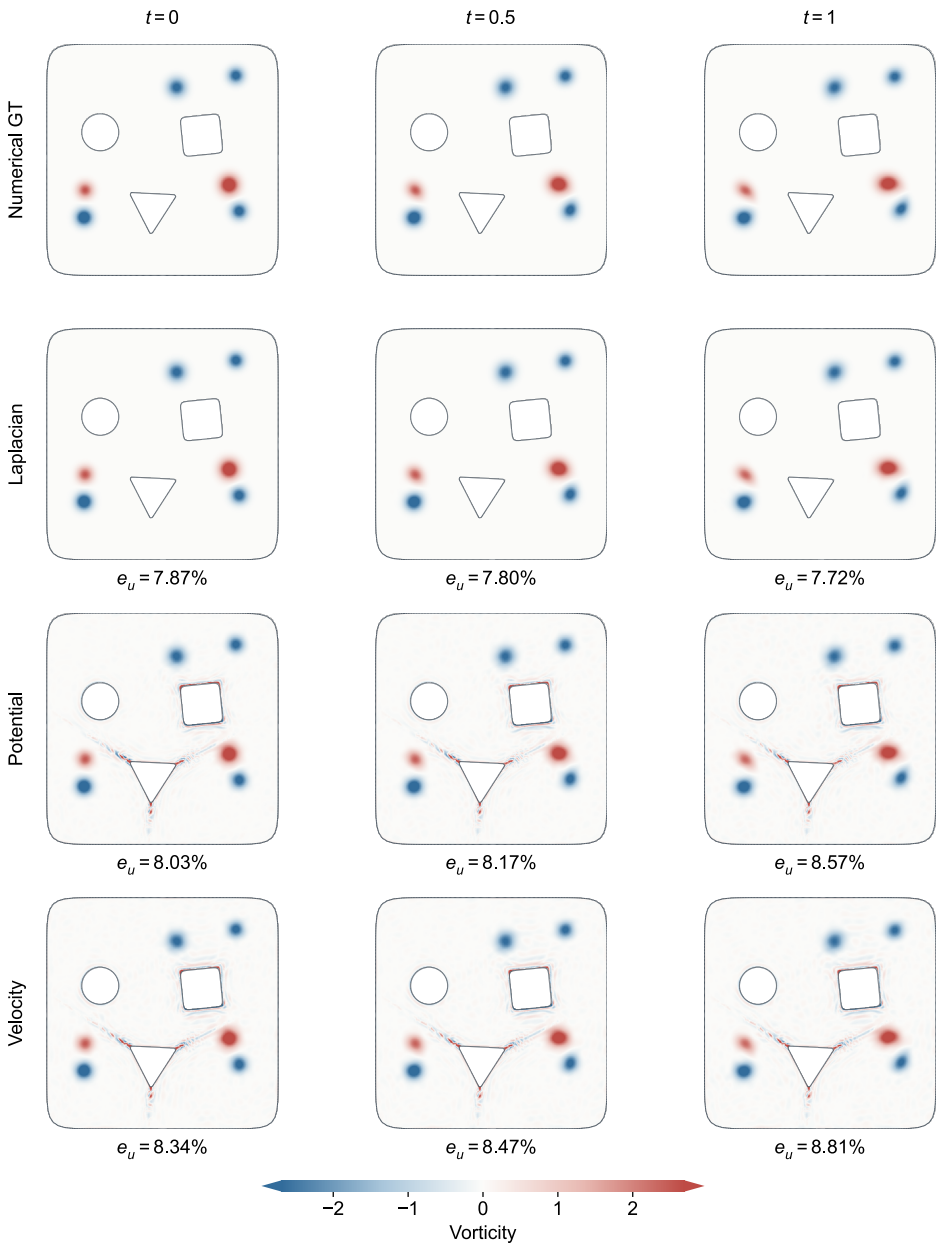


**Figure 24. 3-hole planar evolution at $K = 1024$.** Rows compare Numerical GT, Laplacian, potential-trained, and velocity-trained bases; columns show $t = 0, 0.5, 1$. Unsmoothed signed vorticity shares a symmetric scale, with colorbar extensions indicating saturation. Annotations give full-domain velocity error for seed 1, state 00 against the common level-2 reference.

retains all 1,599,754 fluid nodes and 30 frames to $T = 1.16$. Training, offline assembly, and online integration are separate costs. Table 22 gives the 2D initial projection errors, Figure 27 compares autonomous errors with same-capacity controls, and Table 25 records training costs.

**Kinematic residuals and numerical refinement.** The periodic NKB initial states have a three-seed mean divergence-to-curl norm ratio of 0.195. Their full-mass condition numbers range from $1.236 \times 10^8$ to $1.899 \times 10^8$. The maximum double-time-step trajectory difference is $4.412 \times 10^{-12}$. For seed 0, the $128^2$ to $256^2$ operator-quadrature trajectory sensitivity on this same case is 46.100%; these measurements separately

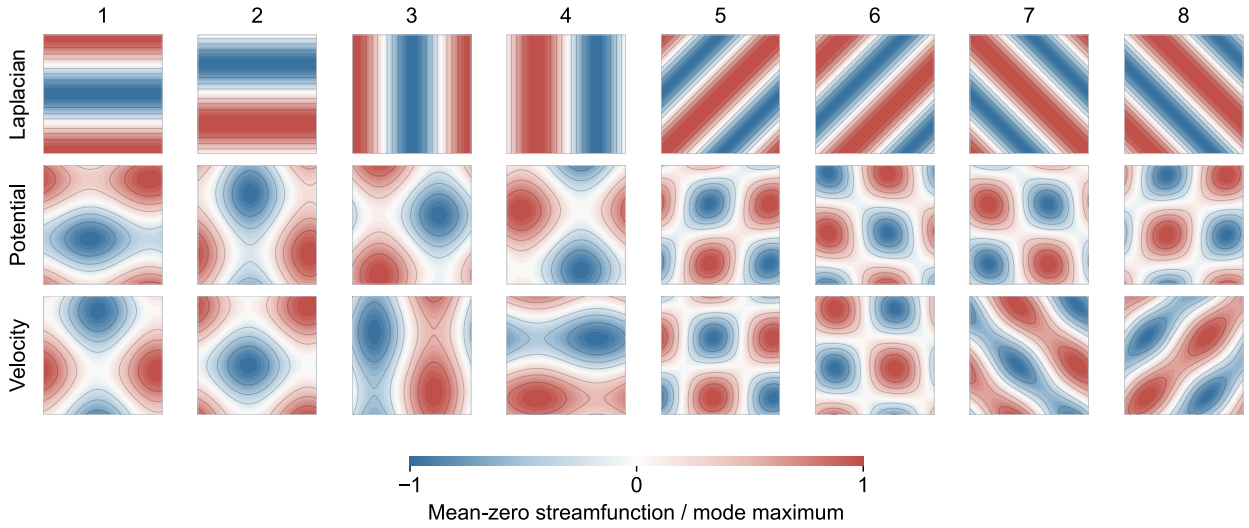


**Figure 25. First eight periodic modes.** Rows compare analytic Fourier modes and generalized Ritz modes from the potential- and velocity-trained $K = 1024$ spans; columns show modes 1–8. Potential Ritz fields use centered potential mass and gradient energy, while velocity Ritz fields use velocity mass and curl energy. Color shows mean-zero streamfunction with per-mode normalization; all 1024 channels contribute to each learned Ritz field.

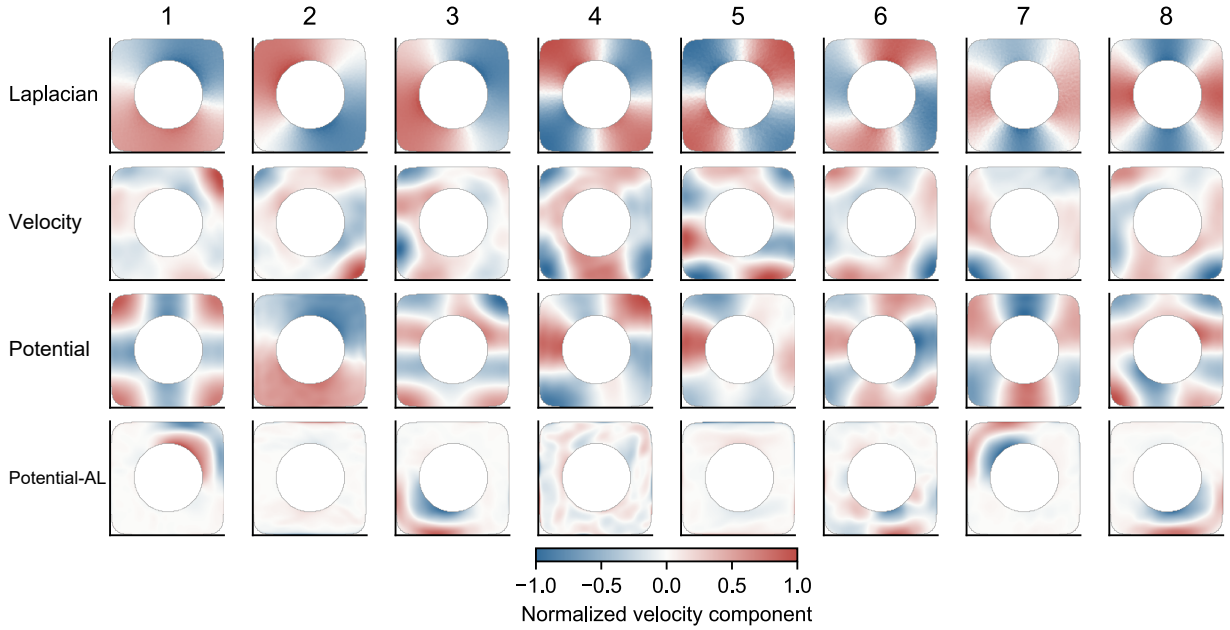


**Figure 26. First eight velocity fields at common $K = 32$.** Rows compare Laplacian, Velocity, Potential, and Potential-AL; columns show modes 1–8. All methods use the same $z = 0.50390625$ slice and per-mode maximum-magnitude normalization of $u_z$. Laplacian fields follow numerical eigenvalue order; learned fields follow their saved channel order, without a display-only Ritz rotation.

characterize spatial quadrature and temporal resolution.

On the one hole domain, the mean initial divergence-to-curl ratio is 0.721, and the sampled boundary-normal root mean square (RMS) relative to domain velocity RMS is 0.170. The maximum time-step and operator-quadrature trajectory differences are $7.03 \times 10^{-6}$ and $1.24 \times 10^{-2}$, respectively.

**Table 22.** Initial full-mass projection errors for the 2D NKB adaptation at $K = 1024$ (%). Periodic entries are mean ± sample SD over three seeds; multi-hole entries average 20 initial states. Trajectory comparisons are shown in Figure 27, 3D initial errors in Figure 10, and training costs in Table 25.

| Case | Initial velocity error (%) |
|---|---|
| Periodic | 2.493 ± 0.138 |
| One hole | 20.760 |
| Two holes | 22.566 |
| Three holes | 22.201 |

On the two holes domain, the mean initial divergence-to-curl ratio is 0.770, and the sampled boundary-normal RMS relative to domain velocity RMS is 0.216. The maximum time-step and operator-quadrature trajectory differences are $1.26 \times 10^{-5}$ and $3.94 \times 10^{-3}$, respectively.

On the three holes domain, the mean initial divergence-to-curl ratio is 0.722, and the sampled boundary-normal RMS relative to domain velocity RMS is 0.231. The maximum time-step and operator-quadrature trajectory differences are $4.15 \times 10^{-6}$ and $2.99 \times 10^{-3}$, respectively.

**Three-dimensional trajectory and kinematic diagnostics.** Tables 23 and 24 supplement the final errors with trajectory means, full-mass conditioning, and initial/final kinematic residuals. The trajectory mean averages all 30 stored frames, including $t = 0$ and $T = 1.16$. The mass condition number $\kappa(M)$ is the largest-to-smallest eigenvalue ratio of the symmetric FP64 mass matrix; all $K$ coordinates are retained.

**Table 23.** Completed 3D NKB trajectories and numerical checks. Mean error is relative velocity $L^2$ in percent. Right-hand-side (RHS) discrepancy compares the assembled coefficient RHS with the projected full-grid RHS at $0.2c_0$ and $c_0$, taking the larger relative Euclidean error. The final column is the maximum relative mass-norm trajectory difference between $\Delta t = 0.00125$ and 0.000625. These checks measure operator agreement and time-step sensitivity on the fixed $128^3$ grid.

| $K$ | Mean error (%) | $\kappa(M)$ | RHS discrepancy | Time-step difference |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 128 | 90.170 | $5.51 \times 10^5$ | $2.37 \times 10^{-10}$ | $9.39 \times 10^{-12}$ |
| 256 | 85.572 | $5.58 \times 10^6$ | $2.04 \times 10^{-9}$ | $2.14 \times 10^{-11}$ |
| 512 | 78.442 | $1.17 \times 10^8$ | $5.33 \times 10^{-8}$ | $3.86 \times 10^{-11}$ |
| 1024 | 66.826 | $4.33 \times 10^9$ | $9.92 \times 10^{-8}$ | $5.00 \times 10^{-11}$ |

For the grid-reconstructed velocity (zero in solid cells), let $\mathbf{k}$ be the grid Fourier wavevector and $\widehat{u}$ its Fourier transform, with $\|\cdot\|_2$ the Euclidean norm over Fourier samples. Let $\langle\cdot\rangle_{\mathcal{B}}$ denote the mean over the original boundary band $\mathcal{B}$, and $\mathcal{P}_h$ the original grid Leray projection with componentwise dealiasing and the zero-mean constraint. The divergence ratio $D$, boundary-normal ratio $B$, and grid-correction ratio $P$ are

$$D = \frac{\|i\mathbf{k} \cdot \widehat{u}\|_2}{\||\mathbf{k}|\widehat{u}\|_2}, \qquad B = \left( \frac{\langle (u \cdot n)^2 \rangle_{\mathcal{B}}}{\langle |u|^2 \rangle_{\mathcal{B}}} \right)^{1/2}, \qquad P = \frac{\|\mathcal{P}_h u - u\|_2}{\|u\|_2}.$$

Here $D$ uses the full velocity-gradient norm, whereas the 2D diagnostic uses the curl norm; $B$ is a band-sampled RMS ratio.

At $K = 2048$, the completed 2000-update NKB model takes 1251.13 seconds including scheduled validation. Its full-mass initial projection on all 1,599,754 fluid nodes has relative error .216462 and captures 95.314% of the initial energy (Table 12). This capacity measurement extends the spatial comparison; autonomous NKB trajectories are assessed through $K = 1024$.

**Table 24.** Initial and final 3D NKB kinematic residuals on the original $128^3$ grid. All entries are dimensionless ratios, using the definitions above.

| | Divergence $D$ | | Boundary normal $B$ | | Grid correction $P$ | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| $K$ | Initial | Final | Initial | Final | Initial | Final |
| 128 | 0.447 | 0.328 | 0.395 | 0.212 | 0.401 | 0.312 |
| 256 | 0.472 | 0.385 | 0.431 | 0.272 | 0.373 | 0.519 |
| 512 | 0.430 | 0.391 | 0.368 | 0.222 | 0.304 | 0.470 |
| 1024 | 0.364 | 0.385 | 0.271 | 0.175 | 0.224 | 0.435 |

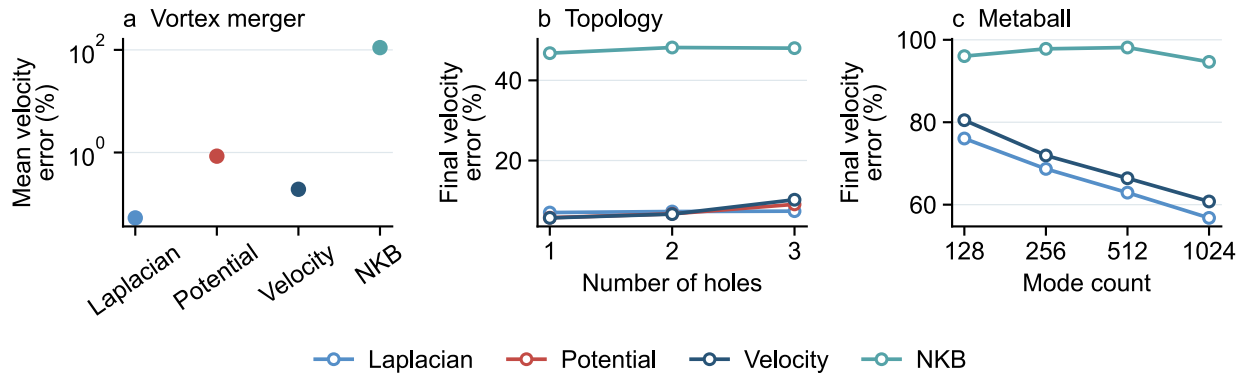


**Figure 27. NKB and Eigenfluid under matched case assessment.** (a) Vortex-merger mean trajectory error over 241 frames, $K = 1024$, three learned seeds with one sample SD. (b) Final errors for the three topologies, averaged over 20 states. (c) Metaball capacity comparison against the same original reference. NKB uses the stated 2000-update, common-Galerkin adaptation. Numerical denotes the same-capacity Laplacian control.

# I Computational cost

We distinguish basis training, offline preparation, online evolution, and field output. The tables collect the recorded costs for the case comparisons and their numerical checks. Times are measured wall times on the RTX 4080 SUPER workstation; each caption specifies the workload and timer boundary. Superscript R marks synchronized complete-workload measurements with all points and modes. Other entries use the recorded stage timers. Entries marked n.r. have no separate timer, excl. denotes a branch outside the stated comparison, and m.f. denotes matrix-free evaluation. Composite workloads are listed as bundles. The analytic Fourier basis is available directly; numerical Laplacian eigensolves belong to offline preparation. Existing Laplacian modes are reused in the reported controls.

## I.1 Training cost and its components

Table 25 groups the completed 2000-update training runs. Periodic entries summarize three seeds. The topology entries measure positive-basis training; the learned harmonic fields are shared by the potential and velocity arms, and their training is outside those timers. NKB learns direct velocity outputs without a separate harmonic stage. The 2D potential entries use Potential. The 3D entries at $K = 128, 256$ use Potential-FG with seed 0 and finite scalar/harmonic gauge projection. These configurations differ from Potential-AL and canonical Potential, whose 3D training costs appear in Appendix E.7. The velocity capacity family has gauge projection disabled and completes full training through $K = 2048$. NKB covers autonomous capacities through $K = 1024$ and initial representation at $K = 2048$.

**Table 25.** Training wall time in minutes for complete 2000-update runs. Periodic entries are mean ± sample SD over three seeds. The 3D totals include all 80 scheduled validations. Topology totals exclude the separately trained harmonic lift shared within each potential/velocity pair. The potential column denotes Potential in 2D and the seed-0 Potential-FG runs in 3D; unavailable measurements are dashes. Canonical 3D Potential costs appear in Appendix E.7. See the text for architecture and gauge settings.

| Case | $K$ | Potential / Potential-FG | Velocity | NKB |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Periodic | 1024 | 106.428 ± 3.196 | 165.760 ± 1.636 | 2.649 ± 0.003 |
| 1 hole | 1024 | 232.61 | 423.97 | 2.68 |
| 2 holes | 1024 | 235.48 | 376.76 | 2.71 |
| 3 holes | 1024 | 233.88 | 388.71 | 2.80 |
| 3D | 128 | 195.80 | 89.36 | 0.84 |
| 3D | 256 | 387.30 | 143.70 | 1.22 |
| 3D | 512 | – | 239.43 | 2.33 |
| 3D | 1024 | – | 466.28 | 6.13 |
| 3D | 2048 | – | 992.93 | 20.85 |

**Table 26.** Instrumented 3D Velocity-training components, in minutes, summed over 2000 committed updates and 80 scheduled validations. Fwd./Rev. include analytic derivatives and the reverse pass includes recomputation. The full wall total also includes initialization, progress logging, cleanup, and other uninstrumented overhead; the listed components identify the principal computational stages. Checkpoints are saved every update through $K = 256$ and every 25 updates at higher capacities.

| $K$ | Fwd. | Rev. | Geometry | Ortho. | Validate | Save | Opt./sample |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 128 | 10.52 | 35.97 | 25.14 | 0.21 | 8.35 | 4.67 | 0.22 |
| 256 | 20.85 | 72.05 | 25.22 | 0.62 | 10.76 | 9.26 | 0.22 |
| 512 | 42.17 | 145.88 | 25.61 | 2.20 | 15.95 | 1.82 | 0.35 |
| 1024 | 89.94 | 298.41 | 29.88 | 8.86 | 28.61 | 3.77 | 0.67 |
| 2048 | 213.77 | 639.38 | 25.37 | 36.19 | 60.81 | 7.87 | 1.21 |

**Architecture and derivative workload.** The 3D velocity implementation assigns an independent width-128, five-hidden-layer sinusoidal representation network (SIREN) (Sitzmann et al., 2020) to each mode: at $K = 1024$ it has 70,126,592 trainable parameters. NKB uses a shared width-256, seven-hidden-layer network with all velocity outputs, totaling 1,188,352 parameters. For Velocity, the neural vector potential $A_\theta$ gives $u = \operatorname{curl} A_\theta$ and the velocity-gradient Rayleigh energy require second spatial derivatives of $A_\theta$ and their parameter adjoints. NKB directly predicts $u$ and its losses use first spatial derivatives. At $K = 1024$, neural forward and reverse account for 83.3% of the 466.28-minute wall time; gauge projection is disabled. The cost breakdown connects the derivative workload and network architecture to the measured training time.

## I.2 Offline basis, projection, and operator preparation

For bounded domains, basis inference evaluates the frozen NKB model on every assessment node and all modes. It is the median of three synchronized passes including coordinate/input transfer and checksum reduction, excluding derivatives and output storage. Projection/preparation contains the recorded full-mass initial projection and reference/error-moment preparation. Derived-field preparation contains the derivative caches and linear operators. Each independently timed pass characterizes its stated workload; production queries reuse the prepared basis and operators.

For periodic flow, basis evaluation includes the analytic velocity and curl fields on all $256^2$ quadrature nodes; projection includes the full mass/curl-stiffness assembly and generalized eigensolve. The rotational nonlinear load is evaluated matrix-free. The synchronized 3D Velocity basis pass evaluates analytic curl on all 1,599,754 nodes in the original FP32 spatial arithmetic, with FP64 checksum accumulation; coordinate/input

**Table 27.** NKB training timers, in seconds. Updates sum the 2000 measured optimization iterations, including sampling, analytic network forward/reverse, losses, Adam, and checkpoint writes within those iterations. Validation sums the 80 scheduled events. Total additionally includes preflight, initialization, and other run overhead. Topology seed is 1 and the 3D seed is 20260823; update totals measure the combined neural forward/reverse and optimization workload.

| Case | $K$ | Seed | Updates | Validate | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Periodic | 1024 | 0 | 151.75 | 3.17 | 159.13 |
| Periodic | 1024 | 1 | 151.59 | 3.19 | 158.98 |
| Periodic | 1024 | 2 | 151.45 | 3.17 | 158.78 |
| 1 hole | 1024 | 1 | 153.04 | 3.28 | 160.96 |
| 2 holes | 1024 | 1 | 154.53 | 3.33 | 162.52 |
| 3 holes | 1024 | 1 | 159.76 | 3.52 | 167.91 |
| 3D | 128 | 20260823 | 41.68 | 4.72 | 50.63 |
| 3D | 256 | 20260823 | 61.90 | 7.01 | 73.30 |
| 3D | 512 | 20260823 | 121.50 | 13.69 | 139.66 |
| 3D | 1024 | 20260823 | 325.27 | 37.50 | 367.58 |

**Table 28.** Offline costs in seconds. Basis gives all-node field-evaluation times; periodic entries include analytic derivatives. Projection includes the recorded reference preparation where bundled. Derived means field/linear-operator preparation, and $Q$ denotes accepted assembly of the quadratic tensor $\mathcal{Q}$. The incl. periodic derivative fields are included in basis evaluation, and their nonlinear loads are matrix-free. n.r. marks components without a separate measurement. The $K = 512$ derived cost covers all 512 modes, basis-cache transposition, and linear-operator preparation. These columns exclude neural training and online integration.

| Case | $K$ | Basis | Basis eval. | Projection | Derived | $Q$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 3D | 512 | Velocity | $454.46^{\mathrm{R}}$ | 18.50 | 3036.39 | 3645.51 |
| 3D | 1024 | Velocity | $679.90^{\mathrm{R}}$ | 41.25 | 10381.08 | 32434.41 |
| Periodic s0 | 1024 | Potential | 143.21 | 1.73 | *incl.* | *m.f.* |
| Periodic s1 | 1024 | Potential | 142.83 | 1.73 | *incl.* | *m.f.* |
| Periodic s2 | 1024 | Potential | 143.98 | 1.63 | *incl.* | *m.f.* |
| Periodic s0 | 1024 | Velocity | 144.22 | 1.63 | *incl.* | *m.f.* |
| Periodic s1 | 1024 | Velocity | 149.66 | 1.72 | *incl.* | *m.f.* |
| Periodic s2 | 1024 | Velocity | 141.75 | 1.61 | *incl.* | *m.f.* |
| Periodic s0 | 1024 | NKB | 1.36 | 1.68 | *incl.* | *m.f.* |
| Periodic s1 | 1024 | NKB | 1.10 | 1.64 | *incl.* | *m.f.* |
| Periodic s2 | 1024 | NKB | 1.09 | 1.63 | *incl.* | *m.f.* |
| 1 hole | 1024 | NKB | 3.55 | 31.34 | $22.58^{\mathrm{R}}$ | 3247.81 |
| 2 holes | 1024 | NKB | 14.02 | 118.76 | $90.01^{\mathrm{R}}$ | 12682.87 |
| 3 holes | 1024 | NKB | 13.88 | 118.83 | $90.00^{\mathrm{R}}$ | 12685.85 |
| 3D | 128 | NKB | 2.99 | 30.18 | 139.57 | 83.94 |
| 3D | 256 | NKB | 3.50 | 95.56 | 311.72 | 576.10 |
| 3D | 512 | NKB | 4.67 | 190.53 | 728.16 | 3841.67 |
| 3D | 1024 | NKB | 7.20 | 322.78 | 1939.69 | 32446.09 |

transfer and checksum reduction are included, and storage is excluded. Its checksum agrees with the original full-mass basis energy to $1.10 \times 10^{-14}$ relative error. The topology basis passes evaluate every field and derivative and assemble the full mass, derivative, and divergence moments on 1,048,576 nodes for one hole and 4,194,304 for two and three holes. Each saved matrix agrees with its original operator to the reported precision.

## I.3 Online evolution, output, and assessment

Table 29 separates coefficient evolution from output costs in 3D. Laplacian controls use the original grid-based reduced generator, whereas the listed Velocity and NKB trajectories use assembled coefficient operators. The NS reference uses its original split viscosity/normal-penalty integrator. The common physical interval and fine time step support comparison of the recorded execution strategies. Flow errors accompany these timings in the capacity plots. Output measures field reconstruction, transfer, storage, and recorded diagnostics.

**Table 29.** 3D online costs in seconds, $T = 1.16$. Coarse/fine steps are $0.00125/0.000625$. ROM output timers cover three selected fields; NS output timers cover its 30 saved fields. Laplacian online timers include the field operations required at every integration step, excluding assessment outside the stepping timer. Repeated NS rows are the measured reference runs for the two capacity experiments; n.a. indicates that NS has no retained-mode count.

| $K$ | Method | Execution | Coarse | Fine | Output |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 128 | NKB | Coefficient | 3.57 | 6.84 | $22.30^{R}$ |
| 256 | NKB | Coefficient | 4.90 | 9.78 | $22.26^{R}$ |
| 512 | Velocity | Coefficient | 3.85 | 7.03 | 20.41 |
| 512 | Laplacian | Grid ROM | 119.45 | 238.71 | $0.26^{R}$ |
| 512 | NKB | Coefficient | 8.29 | 16.58 | 7.98 |
| 1024 | Velocity | Coefficient | 24.30 | 48.59 | 32.72 |
| 1024 | Laplacian | Grid ROM | 130.04 | 260.17 | $0.26^{R}$ |
| 1024 | NKB | Coefficient | 766.10 | 1532.83 | 14.56 |
| *n.a.* | NS (K512 comparison) | Grid NS | $63.71^{R}$ | 124.75 | 7.01 |
| *n.a.* | NS (K1024 comparison) | Grid NS | $63.66^{R}$ | 126.68 | 7.04 |

**Table 30.** 2D measured execution intervals in seconds, $K = 1024$. Each periodic method–seed pair is listed once. Periodic runs reach $T = 18\pi$ with 241 saved fields; topology runs reach $T = 1$ with 20 initial states. Periodic integration timers include synchronized coefficient capture and exclude field reconstruction and file writing. The matched potential, velocity and NKB runs use $256^2$ operator points and $128^2$ observations. Topology entries time their original 20-state batches.

| Case | Method | $\Delta t$ | Time (s) | Timer scope |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Periodic s0 | Potential | 0.005 | 182.62 | Integration + coefficient capture |
| Periodic s1 | Potential | 0.005 | 182.63 | Integration + coefficient capture |
| Periodic s2 | Potential | 0.005 | 182.64 | Integration + coefficient capture |
| Periodic s0 | Velocity | 0.005 | 185.97 | Integration + coefficient capture |
| Periodic s1 | Velocity | 0.005 | 183.62 | Integration + coefficient capture |
| Periodic s2 | Velocity | 0.005 | 181.99 | Integration + coefficient capture |
| Periodic s0 | NKB | 0.005 | 182.99 | Integration + coefficient capture |
| Periodic s1 | NKB | 0.005 | 182.81 | Integration + coefficient capture |
| Periodic s2 | NKB | 0.005 | 182.59 | Integration + coefficient capture |
| 1 hole | NKB | 0.001 | 408.46 | 20-state coefficient batch |
| 2 holes | NKB | 0.001 | 402.47 | 20-state coefficient batch |
| 3 holes | NKB | 0.001 | 418.86 | 20-state coefficient batch |

The one-hole kernel comparison in Appendix D measures 0.393 s per assembled coefficient step versus 153.8 s for streamed field contraction of the same reduced operator (about 391×), with its separately recorded 57.9-minute tensor assembly. These kernel-level intervals differ from the process receipts in Table 31.

## I.4 Numerical checks and auxiliary costs

At $K = 128, 256$, joint Velocity/Laplacian evaluation costs 547.33 and 3449.86 s, covering both methods, both time steps, and their field outputs. The corresponding NKB evaluation bundles take 25.91 and 30.12 s.

**Table 31.** High-capacity Velocity pipeline wall times, in seconds. Process-stage intervals are grouped by purpose for each 20-state topology experiment. They include process startup, I/O, and process monitoring, and are kept separate from the synchronized NKB coefficient timers in Table 30. Shared harmonic training is excluded.

| Stage | 1 hole | 2 holes | 3 holes |
|---|---|---|---|
| Boundary fields and assessment | 60.05 | 70.07 | 70.04 |
| Initial projection | 20.01 | 40.03 | 40.02 |
| Linear/operator preparation | 874.27 | 977.54 | 978.13 |
| Nonlinear tensor | 3484.71 | 3504.59 | 3501.97 |
| ROM execution | 520.06 | 610.08 | 610.08 |
| Reference fields and error assessment | 570.13 | 2250.30 | 2280.28 |

**Table 32.** Additional 3D measured costs in seconds. Velocity check includes full-grid RHS and one-step comparisons; refined projection uses the matched-step NS reference. Velocity/NKB evaluation bundles include both trajectories, checks, and output and overlap the preceding component timers. NKB capacities time evaluation after operator preparation. Laplacian refresh includes both time steps and fresh FP64 projection. Bundle totals and individual components describe their respective timer boundaries.

| $K$ | Velocity load | Velocity check | Refined proj. | Velocity eval. | NKB eval. | Lap. refresh |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 512 | 0.71 | 183.30 | 19.37 | 386.33 | 69.50 | 376.58 |
| 1024 | 3.36 | 438.64 | 35.32 | 761.22 | 2337.10 | 407.83 |

These totals characterize the complete evaluation workloads at the two capacities.

**NKB operator precision.** The accepted K1024 tensor assembly costs 32446.09 s and uses FP64 short-dot products and compensated accumulation. Every online RK4 stage uses compensated products and summation; this implementation is included in its 1532.83 s online cost. Independent full-grid RHS comparisons verify the assembled operator to the reported precision (Table 23).

**Gauge-solver timings.** Table 17 groups setup, forward, reverse, and independent assessment at the frozen checkpoint, with residuals visualized in Figure 16. Table 18 adds source-evaluation times for the precision controls. The workload evaluates 32 frozen columns with reused geometry-dependent MFS factors; the listed timers cover the source evaluation, correction, differentiation, and assessment stages.

## I.5 Inference accounting and reuse thresholds

Continuous basis evaluation and autonomous integration answer different cost questions. A neural basis query evaluates a frozen vector-valued function and its required analytic derivatives, followed by the specified geometry-local normalization and orthogonalization. A numerical basis construction includes the geometry-specific spectral solve and evaluation at the same requested points. Numerical preparation comprises mesh generation, point mapping, factorization, and the spectral solve. The recorded 687.17 s solve/reconstruction on unseen 3D geometry 2 measures the spectral and reconstruction stages after mesh and point-map preparation. Table 28 gives the all-node NKB query benchmarks. The reuse analysis below measures the autonomous integration workload with shared spatial bases and operators.

For a full workload, replace the denominator of Eq. (22) by the difference between complete per-query costs, including initial projection, selected field reconstruction, transfers, and storage. Output costs are assigned according to the requested number of reconstructed fields: the recorded NS workload saves 30 fields, and the ROM workload reconstructs three selected fields.

**Table 33.** Reuse thresholds computed from original wall-time receipts, without rounding inputs. A reuse is one $T = 1.16$, 1856-step trajectory on the same geometry, with the same time step and existing operators. The baseline is the numerical NS integration timer. Training-only counts set $T_{\text{off}} = 0$; adding recorded assembly or derived-field preparation charges those stages once. Derived-field costs include the recovered $K = 512$ preparation timers. Per-query projection/output and separately unrecorded stages lie outside these integration-only thresholds.

| $K$ | Training (h) | NS/ROM | Training only | + $Q$ assembly | + derived fields |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 512 | 3.9906 | 17.74× | 123 | 154 | 179 |
| 1024 | 7.7713 | 2.61× | 359 | 774 | 907 |

For basis generation over a geometry family, write $T_{\text{num}}^{(g)}$ for a fresh numerical basis construction and $T_{\text{query}}^{(g)}$ for the frozen neural map with the same postprocessing. For $G$ geometry queries indexed by $g$, training amortizes when

$$\sum_{g=1}^{G} \left( T_{\text{num}}^{(g)} - T_{\text{query}}^{(g)} \right) \geq T_{\text{train}}. \tag{52}$$

If the per-geometry costs are constant, write them as $T_{\text{num}}$ and $T_{\text{query}}$; then $G_\star = \lceil T_{\text{train}}/(T_{\text{num}} - T_{\text{query}}) \rceil$. This geometry-level threshold requires matched basis-generation timers. Each new geometry also incurs its own operator assembly when autonomous dynamics are requested. Arbitrarily dense neural spatial queries preserve the same learned continuous function; their cost scales with requested points and modes, and their accuracy is that of the learned representation.

**Tensor-product and nonuniform parameter sweeps.** A tensor-product sweep with $m$ values for each of $d$ independent query parameters contains $m^d$ cases. The per-axis break-even resolution $r_\star(d)$ and integer sampling count $m_\star(d)$ are

$$r_\star(d) = n_\star^{1/d}, \qquad m_\star(d) = \lceil r_\star(d) \rceil . \tag{53}$$

Here $d$ counts varied physical or query parameters and $n_\star$ is the integration-only reuse count in Eq. (22).

For a threshold $N_\star$, $m^d \geq N_\star$ is equivalent to $m \geq N_\star^{1/d}$. Table 34 gives two-, three-, and four-parameter sampling densities under the recorded cost boundaries.

**Table 34.** Per-axis break-even resolution $r_\star(d) = N_\star^{1/d}$ for the integration-only thresholds in Table 33. $Q$ denotes reusable quadratic assembly and fields denotes the additionally recorded derived-field preparation. Roots are rounded to two decimals; the integer three-parameter resolution $m_\star(3)$ is computed before rounding. Every row retains its original cost boundary.

| $K$ | One-time cost | $N_\star$ | $r_\star(2)$ | $r_\star(3)$ | $r_\star(4)$ | $m_\star(3)$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 512 | Training | 123 | 11.09 | 4.97 | 3.33 | 5 |
| 512 | Training + $Q$ | 154 | 12.41 | 5.36 | 3.52 | 6 |
| 512 | Training + $Q$ + fields | 179 | 13.38 | 5.64 | 3.66 | 6 |
| 1024 | Training | 359 | 18.95 | 7.11 | 4.35 | 8 |
| 1024 | Training + $Q$ | 774 | 27.82 | 9.18 | 5.27 | 10 |
| 1024 | Training + $Q$ + fields | 907 | 30.12 | 9.68 | 5.49 | 10 |

Unequal axis counts $m_1, \ldots, m_d$ meet the threshold when $\prod_{j=1}^{d} m_j \geq N_\star$; their geometric mean $(\prod_j m_j)^{1/d}$ is the mean per-axis resolution. Sparse, constrained, or correlated sweeps use the actual query count. With per-query savings $\Delta T_i$ and reusable cost $T_{\text{one-time}}$, break-even requires $\sum_i \Delta T_i \geq T_{\text{one-time}}$, including per-case preparation. Fixed-geometry initial-condition sweeps reuse the frozen basis and operators; geometry sweeps additionally charge geometry generation and required operator assembly.